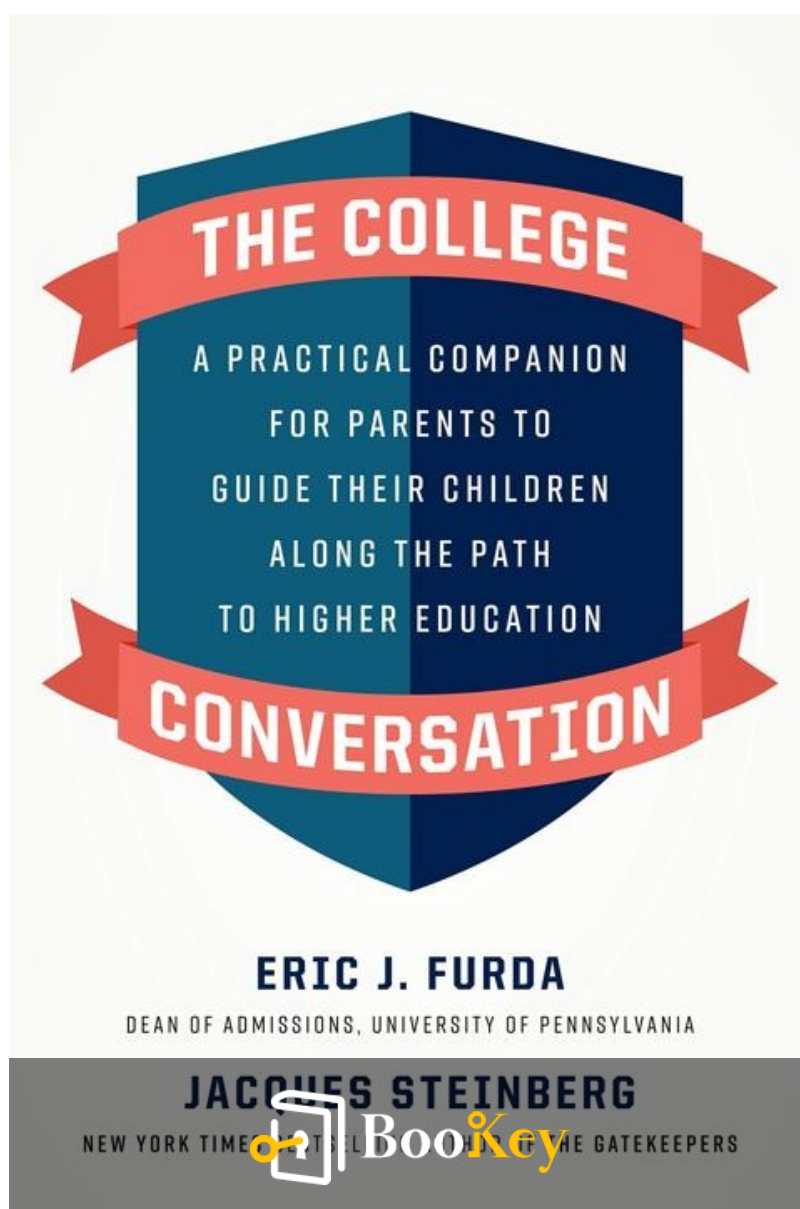


The College Conversation PDF

Eric J. Furda



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About the book

"The College Conversation" by Eric J. Furda and Jacques Steinberg serves as an essential guide for parents supporting their children through the often daunting college application journey. Drawing on the authors' expertise as an Ivy League dean and a college admissions specialist, this book offers a calm, step-by-step framework for navigating crucial conversations about college choices, from initial discussions about interests to making impactful decisions about acceptances and financial aid. Rather than merely adding to the plethora of "how to get in" manuals, it emphasizes meaningful dialogue and perspective, helping families stay grounded and informed throughout the process. Covering everything from essay writing to the transition into college life, "The College Conversation" equips parents and students with the practical insights and reassurance needed for a successful admissions experience.

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About the author

Eric J. Furda is a notable educator and higher education leader with extensive experience in college admissions and student advising. As the former dean of admissions at the University of Pennsylvania, he has dedicated his career to guiding students and families through the complexities of the college application process. Furda is recognized for his commitment to fostering access and equity in education, and he has been a prominent voice in discussions about college readiness and the evolving landscape of higher education. Through his work, he has aimed to demystify the admissions journey, empowering students to make informed choices about their futures. In "The College Conversation," he shares his insights and expertise, providing valuable guidance for navigating one of life's significant transitions.

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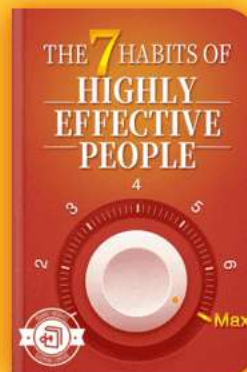
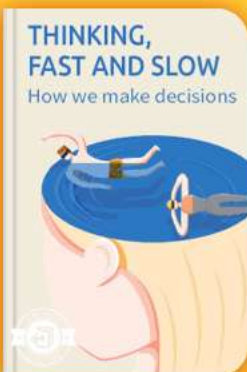


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Chapter 1 Summary : A. The “Why College?” Conversation



Section	Key Points
The “Why College?” Conversation	- Higher education costs are significantly high (up to \$80,000). - Families evaluate return on investment regarding emotional readiness, financial affordability, and career paths.
Bachelor’s Degree	- Bachelor’s degree holders earn approximately \$2.4 million over their lifetime. - Serves as a gateway to advanced degrees and enhances earning prospects. - Promotes critical thinking, communication skills, and social mobility. - College enrollment doesn’t guarantee graduation due to financial and preparedness challenges.
Associate’s Degree	- Community colleges offer lower tuition (~\$4,000/year) and the possibility of credit transfer. - Good option for those not ready for a four-year commitment. - Graduation rates are low; a solid plan is essential.
Aligning Military Service with a College Degree	- Military service provides educational opportunities (e.g., Post-9/11 GI Bill, ROTC). - Service academies offer tuition-free education and military training.
Alternate Paths to a College Degree or Other Postsecondary Credential	- MOOCs allow online degree completion at lower costs. - Dual enrollment prepares high school students for college and job market.

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Section	Key Points
	- Initiatives like UnCollege focus on skills and experiential learning. - UnCollege offers gap-year programs to enhance college readiness.

The “Why College?” Conversation

The landscape of higher education is experiencing considerable disruption, with costs reaching up to \$80,000 at some private institutions, far exceeding the median family income. Families are prompted to evaluate the return on investment for a traditional four-year degree, particularly concerning emotional readiness, financial affordability, and intended career paths.

Bachelor’s Degree

Research supports the lifetime earnings potential of a bachelor's degree, indicating that degree holders can earn approximately \$2.4 million throughout their lives—substantially more than those with only a high school diploma. A bachelor's degree also serves as a gateway to advanced degrees, enhancing earning prospects even further. Beyond monetary benefits, education fosters critical thinking and communication skills essential for personal fulfillment

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and societal function. Furthermore, research shows that a college degree can promote social mobility, providing low-income students with opportunities similar to those from wealthier backgrounds.

However, college enrollment does not guarantee graduation, with many students failing to complete their degrees due to various challenges, including financial burdens and lack of preparedness.

Associate's Degree

Community colleges present appealing economic alternatives for students. With significantly lower tuition costs—around \$4,000 per year—students can obtain an associate's degree while potentially transferring credits to a four-year institution. Emotional and practical reasons also make community colleges viable choices for those not ready for immediate four-year commitments. However, students must create a solid plan, as graduation rates from community colleges remain low.

Aligning Military Service with a College Degree

Military service does not cancel out educational

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opportunities. Programs like the Post-9/11 GI Bill provide financial assistance for veterans, while ROTC programs offer tuition support and a direct pathway to military officer roles. Additionally, attending one of the five service academies provides tuition-free education and military training.

Alternate Paths to a College Degree or Other Postsecondary Credential

Emerging educational avenues, such as MOOCs, allow for online degree completion at a fraction of traditional costs. Programs like dual enrollment in high school enable students to prepare for both higher education and the job market. There are also initiatives like UnCollege that advocate for non-traditional education methods, emphasizing skills and experiential learning over formal degrees. Interestingly, even UnCollege acknowledges the benefits of higher education for certain student populations and offers gap-year programs to enhance readiness for college.

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Example

Key Point: The Importance of Evaluating Educational Pathways

Example: Before deciding on attending college, think about your interests and career goals. Consider if a traditional four-year degree aligns with your passion or if apprenticeships or community colleges better fit your practical and emotional needs. Understand the financial implications of your choice, as enrolling without a clear purpose might lead to significant debt without the corresponding ROI.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The discussion about the value of a bachelor's degree is oversimplified.

Critical Interpretation: While the chapter underscores the monetary advantages of obtaining a bachelor's degree—including higher lifetime earnings—this perspective can be misleading. It does not account for the increasing debt burden that many graduates face or the various socioeconomic factors influencing individual outcomes. For example, research by the Federal Reserve shows that the average student debt in the U.S. has reached approximately \$30,000, which can negate potential financial benefits (Federal Reserve Bank of New York, 2022). Additionally, not all degrees offer the same return on investment, as fields with high demand can vary significantly; thus, the narrative that a degree is always beneficial may need to be tempered with caution and personal context.

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Chapter 2 Summary : Activity #1:

Jotting Down a Few Key Attributes on an Index Card



Activity	Overview	Instructions	Conclusion
Jotting Down a Few Key Attributes on an Index Card	The exercise encourages parents and children to reflect on individual college experience attributes.	Set Up: Use index cards; sit apart to jot down personal thoughts, focusing on the child's experience. Writing the Attributes: Describe ideal college environment; avoid specific schools; consider academics, setting, athletics; acknowledge anxieties. Sharing and Reflection: Exchange cards; identify agreements/disagreements; focus on listening, not resolving issues. Emotional Awareness: Notice emotional triggers; reassure child if the discussion causes discomfort. Future Conversations: Note key points for future discussions as the college list develops.	This activity fosters open dialogue about the college selection process, ensuring both perspectives are acknowledged.

ACTIVITY #1: Jotting Down a Few Key Attributes

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on an Index Card

Overview

The exercise encourages parents and their children to reflect on the attributes of a college experience that may appeal to them individually.

Instructions

1.

Set Up

- Use index cards.
- Sit apart to jot down personal thoughts.
- Keep in mind that this is about the child's college experience, not the parent's.

2.

Writing the Attributes

- Focus on a few key descriptors of the ideal college environment.
- Avoid mentioning specific schools; concentrate on

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general qualities.

- Consider academic interests, setting (rural, urban), and athletic priorities.

- Acknowledge any anxieties regarding college admission or affordability.

3.

Sharing and Reflection

- After writing, exchange cards with your child.

- Identify areas of agreement and disagreement.

- The aim here is to listen and notice, not to resolve conflicts or issues immediately.

4.

Emotional Awareness

- Pay attention to emotional triggers.

- Reassure your child if the discussion causes discomfort.

5.

Future Conversations

- Highlight key points to revisit in upcoming discussions as the college list takes shape.

Conclusion

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This activity serves as a foundational step in fostering open dialogue about the college selection process, ensuring both perspectives are considered for a healthier conversation moving forward.

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Example

Key Point: Understanding individual preferences fosters open communication during the college selection process.

Example: As you sit with your child, you might reflect on what truly makes a college appealing to you both. You could jot down attributes like 'supportive community' or 'strong science programs' on your index card, while they might focus on 'accessible campus life' or 'diverse student body.' This exercise not only helps clarify what you each value but also sparks a necessary dialogue where you can both share your thoughts candidly. Recognizing each other's views without judgment creates a safe space for future conversations about college, ensuring that decisions are made collaboratively and thoughtfully.

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Chapter 3 Summary : C. Rules of the Road: Establishing Guardrails for Your Role as a Parent

Section	Key Points
C. Rules of the Road: Establishing Guardrails for Your Role as a Parent	Setting Up Communication Guidelines: Collaborate on rules for discussions; balance involvement without being overly dominating. Active Listening and Open-mindedness: Listen to your child without judgment; support their aspirations even if their preferences differ. Choosing the Right Time to Talk: Find appropriate moments for discussions; avoid stressful times and consider timing with deadlines. Establishing Privacy Boundaries: Limit sharing about the college process outside the family; respect your child's privacy wishes. Managing Emotional Responses: Recognize your own emotions and seek support when overwhelmed; reflect on concerns about affordability and independence. Caution with Social Media: Advise children to manage their online presence, as it can impact admissions decisions.
D. Around the Kitchen Table: Preparing Parents to Help Children Get to Know Themselves	Engage in meaningful conversations to help students reflect on their identity and aspirations; foster a supportive environment during this important time.

C. Rules of the Road: Establishing Guardrails for Your Role as a Parent

As parents discuss college choices with their child, it's crucial to recognize the complexity and emotional weight of the conversation. To facilitate a productive dialogue,

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establish guardrails and boundaries around the College Conversation to prevent overwhelm while ensuring your child's success.

-

Setting Up Communication Guidelines

Parents should collaborate to create basic rules for discussing college, including agreeing on roles and how to handle disagreements. Writing these rules down can serve as a helpful reference. It is essential to balance involvement without crossing into "helicopter parenting."

-

Active Listening and Open-mindedness

It's vital for parents to listen to their children without judgment and to keep an open mind, particularly when the child's preferences differ from their own. Children should feel heard and supported in their college aspirations.

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Chapter 4 Summary : Activity #2: The Five I's

Activity	Prompts	Description	Purpose
Activity #2: The Five I's	Identity	Explores self-perception and how they believe others view them.	Helps in understanding one's academic identity for recommendations.
	Intellect	Reflects on their approach to learning and enjoyment of research.	Highlights motivation and engagement in the learning process.
	Ideas	Considers personal thoughts and cherished opinions.	Facilitates the development of a personal narrative.
	Interests	Identifies activities they enjoy in their free time.	Shows diverse interests which can be reflected in applications.
	Inspiration	Contemplates motivations and individuals they admire.	Offers insight into character and drive.
Overall Purpose	To serve as a foundation for high school recommendations and college applications.		
Reflection Method	Encourages open, honest self-exploration without pressure; reflections may evolve over time.		
Holistic Admissions Process	Insights from these reflections aid in the holistic review of college admissions.		

ACTIVITY #2: The Five I's

This activity encourages your child to explore self-reflection through five prompts that begin with the letter "I": identity, intellect, ideas, interests, and inspiration.

Identity

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Your child should consider how they see themselves and how they believe others perceive them.

Intellect

This prompt focuses on their approach to learning and knowledge acquisition. Do they enjoy research and lose track of time while reading?

Ideas

Here, they reflect on what they think about and the opinions they cherish.

Interests

This involves identifying what they enjoy doing in their spare time.

Inspiration

Your child should think about what drives and motivates them, as well as individuals they admire.

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The insights gained from this exercise will be valuable in selecting high school teachers for recommendations and in developing a personal narrative for college applications. Different recommendations can highlight various aspects of your child's academic identity, such as motivation, engagement, and perseverance.

Encourage your child to view this exercise as a journal entry without the pressure of right or wrong answers. The reflections should be a living document, allowing for expansions and modifications over time. Sharing these thoughts with you or others is optional; the key is that your child remains open and honest with themselves.

Behind the Admissions Office Door: A Brief Primer on the Holistic Admissions Process

This section will elaborate on how your child's reflections and self-assessments will play a role in the college admissions process.

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Example

Key Point: Reflecting on self through the Five I's shapes one's narrative for college applications.

Example: As you sit down to explore your identity, imagine writing about how your unique perspective as an avid reader influences your passion for history, or how your interest in robotics defines your intellectual curiosity. This personal reflection, captured in your journal, is not just an exercise; it's a tool to help articulate your journey to college admissions. By embracing your individuality through the Five I's, you cultivate a rich self-assessment that can highlight key experiences and values when presenting yourself to colleges, making your application stand out as an authentic representation of who you are.

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Chapter 5 Summary : E. Behind the Admissions Office Door: A Brief Primer on the Holistic Admissions Process (And the Ultimate Audience for Your Child's Application)

Section	Summary
Behind the Admissions Office Door	The admissions process seeks to enroll diverse and motivated students by evaluating holistic aspects of applicants beyond test scores and GPAs, such as personal backgrounds and extracurricular activities.
Understanding Holistic Admissions	Holistic admissions consider academic performance, activities, leadership, and the applicant's citizenship roles along with diverse perspectives shaped by their environment.
Importance of Alignment in College Selection	Parents should help children understand how their academic profiles align with those of accepted students at potential colleges, utilizing resources like rankings and data sets.
Using the Common Data Set	The Common Data Set provides essential admissions data, including test score bands for admitted students and insights into the middle score range of accepted applicants.
Final Advice on Selectivity	Students should apply to schools where their scores exceed the twenty-fifth percentile, but should be cautious about conclusions drawn solely from selectivity data, as many factors influence admissions decisions.

Behind the Admissions Office Door: A Brief Primer on the Holistic Admissions Process

The admissions process aims to identify and enroll a motivated and diverse group of students who will contribute positively to their universities and communities. Admissions officers utilize a holistic approach, assessing a

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comprehensive view of applicants beyond just test scores and GPAs. This includes evaluating personal backgrounds, extracurricular engagements, leadership experiences, and individual perspectives shaped by upbringing and environment.

Understanding Holistic Admissions

Colleges engage in holistic admissions to gather insights into the whole person, considering:

- Academic performance
- Activities and leadership roles
- Role as a citizen within their school and community
- Diverse perspectives influenced by background and environment

Importance of Alignment in College Selection

Parents should assist their children in understanding the alignment between their academic profiles and the profiles of accepted students at potential colleges. Various resources like U.S. News & World Report rankings and the Common Data Set initiative can provide valuable data regarding selectivity and the characteristics of admitted students, including test

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score ranges.

Using the Common Data Set

The Common Data Set offers a universal pool of data about admissions, including:

- Test score bands for admitted students
- Insight into the middle 50 percent of admitted students' scores

Final Advice on Selectivity

As students build their college lists, they should aim for schools where their scores do not fall at or below the twenty-fifth percentile. However, students and parents should remain cautious about making definitive conclusions based solely on selectivity data, as colleges consider a variety of factors beyond scores in their admissions processes.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Holistic admissions processes prioritize diverse perspectives in evaluating students for college admissions.

Critical Interpretation: The author's assertion that holistic admissions encompass personal backgrounds and experiences, while appealing, can be critiqued for oversimplifying the complexities involved. It may unintentionally suggest that personal narratives can adequately compensate for academic shortcomings, undermining the importance of standardized assessments in evaluating student readiness for college-level work. This viewpoint could lead to misconceptions, as research indicates that while holistic admissions foster inclusivity, they can also inadvertently perpetuate biases (Cohen, de la Torre, & Heller, 2020). Additionally, sources like the work of Bastedo and Jaquette (2011) question the effectiveness of holistic reviews in reducing disparities among applicants. Therefore, readers should cautiously navigate the implications of holistic admissions without taking the author's perspective as universally valid.

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Chapter 6 Summary : Activity #3: The Four C's

Category	Description
Culture	Understand the institution's history and mission, ensuring they resonate with the applicant.
Curriculum	Assess course design and purpose, beyond just majors and requirements, for a four-year educational experience.
Community	Identify key people and physical spaces that create the campus environment.
Conclusions	Evaluate the outcomes expected from the college experience, focusing on readiness for further education and job opportunities.
Utilizing the Four C's	Create a customized list of the Four C's as a research guide; use them to frame discussions during campus visits.
Understanding Culture	Research historical context and campus spirit through various resources like student publications and interviews.
Exploring Curriculum	Encourage a broad vision of college classes, focusing on foundational, elective, and major-specific courses.
Assessing Community	Recognize the role of physical spaces and residential experiences in fostering campus culture.
Evaluating Conclusions	Assess retention, graduation rates, and career services as indicators of institutional effectiveness.
Conclusion	Employ the Four C's framework to align potential colleges with the child's aspirations and preferences.

Activity #3: The Four C's

Overview of the Four C's

1.

Culture

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: Understand the institution's history and mission, and consider how these elements resonate with your child as a potential applicant.

2.

Curriculum

: Look beyond the list of majors and requirements to grasp the design and purpose of the courses over the four years.

3.

Community

: Identify the people and physical spaces that comprise the campus environment.

4.

Conclusions

: Evaluate the anticipated outcomes of the college experience, including readiness for graduate school and job opportunities.

Utilizing the Four C's

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Rahul Malviya

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on, and the mind maps help reinforce wh
I've learned. Highly recommend!

Alex Walk

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Chapter 7 Summary : B. A Word About Fit (And Please Note: It Won't Be Perfect)

Section	Summary
A Word About Fit	The college selection process is about finding a fit, but no school will be perfect; manage expectations accordingly.
Ranking College Attributes	Students should identify and rank desired college attributes, similar to home-buying, focusing on essential traits while making compromises.
Location Concerns for Parents	Parents may have strong emotions about their child attending college far from home, fearing for safety and financial implications.
Keeping Options Open	Families should include distant colleges in their lists to avoid letting fears limit opportunities, including financial aid considerations.
Real-Life Example	Monica Mendez, initially against distant colleges, changed her mind after visiting Gettysburg College, where her daughters succeeded.
Encouragement for Parents	Monica encourages parents to support their children in pursuing opportunities at distant colleges.
Building a College List	As families start building a college list, additional resources and cost considerations will be addressed in the next section.

A Word About Fit (And Please Note: It Won't Be Perfect)

The concept of "fit" is crucial in the college selection process, and it's important to manage expectations regarding finding the perfect college. Insights from the initial index card, Five I's exercise, and Four C's give a good indication of potential fit, but no institution will meet every preference.

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Ranking College Attributes

Students should identify and rank their desired college attributes. This process is similar to home-buying, where compromises must be made to find a suitable place within budget. While it's important for students not to settle for the easiest option, they should focus on essential characteristics that matter most to them.

Location Concerns for Parents

Parents may experience a range of emotions if their child considers attending college far from home, especially if they are first-generation college attendees. Concerns may include fear for safety, loss of control, and financial impact due to transportation and living costs.

Keeping Options Open

It's beneficial for families to consider including colleges that are far away in their list. College counselor Chris White advises parents not to let their fears inhibit potential opportunities, including appealing financial aid packages.

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Real-Life Example

Monica Mendez, a mother initially resistant to the idea of sending her daughters to a distant college, was convinced after visiting Gettysburg College. Her daughters ultimately thrived there, illustrating how exploring options beyond local institutions can expand opportunities.

Encouragement for Parents

Monica encourages other parents to allow their children to pursue distant colleges, recognizing it as a significant opportunity in their lives.

Building a College List

As families begin to construct a college list, supplemental resources and considerations regarding the cost of college—referred to as the fifth C—will be introduced in the next section.

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Example

Key Point: Identifying and ranking college attributes is vital for a suitable college fit.

Example: As you start your college journey, think of it like finding your dream home. Imagine you're flipping through listings; the perfect house doesn't exist, but if you prioritize things like location, community, and support systems, you can find a place that aligns closely with your needs. For instance, you might want a vibrant campus life, quality academic programs, and proximity to family, but when you discover a college that meets your top criteria despite being far from home, it could open doors you never considered. Embrace compromise in your search; it may lead you to invaluable opportunities and experiences that one college alone can't provide.

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Chapter 8 Summary : C. Adding Other Voices to the Conversation

C. Adding Other Voices to the Conversation

Broadening Discussions

The College Conversation should expand beyond just parents and children to include various resources and voices, starting with the college counselor at the child's high school.

Establish communication early, ideally by sophomore year, to utilize the counselor's experience effectively.

Role of College Counselors

Engage with the college counselor to clarify expectations and keep track of important dates, such as college nights and application deadlines. Note that counselor caseloads can vary significantly, so it's important to understand the context of their support.

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Utilize Online Resources

Schools often provide online tools like Naviance and Scoir to help manage the college application process. Parents, especially first-generation, can connect with previous families for shared experiences.

Community Resources

Local public libraries may hold valuable college-related resources. Also, community-based organizations (CBOs) offer support for students from underrepresented backgrounds, with examples including Say Yes to Education and QuestBridge.

Media and Online Tools

Numerous online platforms provide guidance for college admissions. Notable resources include College Factual for decision-making tools, BigFuture for college search information, and Common Application for applications and planning resources.

Independent College Counselors

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If additional support is needed, consider hiring an independent college counselor who can offer personalized guidance. Verify their qualifications and ensure transparency regarding fees and services. Maintain ethical standards to ensure the integrity of your child's application process.

D. The Fifth C: Cost

(Transition to discussing cost-related aspects of the college application process.)

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Example

Key Point: Incorporate multiple voices into your college decision-making process.

Example: Imagine sitting down at the kitchen table with your parents discussing college, but instead of just your family's thoughts, you include your high school counselor, whose insight could help you map out your college journey. This collaboration not only opens doors to valuable advice but also connects you with local resources, online platforms, and community organizations that can enrich your understanding of the college landscape.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:Engaging various voices can enrich the college admissions dialogue.

Critical Interpretation:Furda emphasizes the importance of including a wide range of voices in the college conversation, suggesting that early engagement with college counselors and the utilization of online and community resources can offer valuable perspectives. However, this viewpoint may overlook the nuances and challenges specific to individual families, such as varying resource availability or the interpersonal dynamics of seeking external advice. While his recommendations align with best practices in educational counseling, it is crucial for readers to consider that not every family may have equitable access to the same supports or to view counselors as uniformly helpful. Research supports the variability of counselor effectiveness based on school contexts—studies indicate that high caseloads can severely limit the attention a counselor can provide, which may influence how well these voices can integrate into an individual student's college planning. Such discrepancies could lead to a skewed

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understanding of the college application process, demonstrating that while Furda's approach is beneficial, it may not universally apply.

Chapter 9 Summary : D. The Fifth C: Cost

Section	Summary
The Fifth C: Cost	Discuss financial considerations before creating a college list to alleviate financial stress and set realistic expectations.
Initiating the Conversation	Start discussions early in a private, supportive environment. Review finances to establish a clear plan.
Shared Responsibility	Highlight the shared family responsibility in financing education, including the need for potential sacrifices and part-time work by the child.
Calculating Costs and Financial Aid	Use net price calculators to estimate costs post-financial aid and assess available need-based aid while considering merit-based options.
Researching College Policies	Understand institutions' merit aid policies and need-blind or need-aware admissions practices to inform college choices.
Utilizing Financial Aid Resources	Leverage platforms like Frank for insights into college financing and consider the child's major and career goals in college selection.
In-State Options	Include at least one in-state public college to minimize tuition costs and reassure the child about affordable options.
Next Steps	Assist the child in creating a comprehensive college list, factoring in costs alongside other important aspects.

The Fifth C: Cost

Before creating a college list, it's essential for families to discuss financial considerations, including how much they can afford for a college education. This conversation is critical as financial stress is a common source of anxiety for families. Discussing finances may be a new experience, covering savings, anticipated borrowing, and whether the child will work part-time in college or contribute personal

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savings.

Initiating the Conversation

Start the discussion early, before compiling a college list, to set realistic expectations. Families should prepare by reviewing their finances and developing plans to facilitate the conversation. A supportive environment is crucial; choose a time when all parties are focused and free from stress. It's advisable to keep the discussion private among parents and the child to avoid distractions.

Shared Responsibility

Emphasize that the cost of education is a shared family responsibility. Make it clear that education is valuable, but also introduce the potential for family sacrifices and the child's future part-time work to finance their education.

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Chapter 10 Summary : E. Helping Your Child Build a College List

Section	Key Points
Helping Your Child Build a College List	Collaborate with your child on their college search, building trust through discussions about preferences and goals.
Creating a Preliminary List	- Draft a list of about 12-15 colleges in junior year. - Reduce to 8-10 schools to minimize application stress. - Average applications submitted via Common Application is 5.
Categories for College Selection	Sweet Spot: 5-6 colleges fitting child's academic profile. Likely: 2-3 colleges with strong admission chances (top quarter). Aspirational: 1-3 stretch schools aligning with interests.
Managing Expectations	Balance standardized scores and qualitative factors like community involvement in the college list.
Final Considerations	Ensure likelies are appealing; replace non-exciting options with more engaging schools for your child.
Activity	Activity #4: The College List

Helping Your Child Build a College List

As your child navigates their college search, it's essential to collaborate on compiling a list of potential colleges. This process should be built on trust established through previous discussions about college preferences, goals, and expectations.

Creating a Preliminary List

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- Aim to draft a list of about twelve to fifteen colleges during your child's junior year.
- Reduce this number to eight to ten schools, as preparing multiple applications can lead to stress and fatigue.
- Recognize that while some students apply to numerous schools, the average number of applications submitted via the Common Application is five.

Categories for College Selection

To organize the list effectively, sort colleges into three categories:

1.

Sweet Spot

:

- These are colleges where your child's academic profile fits well with the average admits, typically falling within the middle fifty percentile range.

- Aim to have five or six colleges in this category.

2.

Likely

:

- Also known as "safeties," these are institutions where

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your child has a strong chance of admission, usually corresponding to scores in the top quarter of admitted students.

- Include about two or three colleges in this category, ideally one where their scores are notably higher than the seventy-fifth percentile.

3.

Aspirational

:

- These schools may be a stretch for admission, often due to competitive selection processes.

- Encourage one to three aspirational choices, ensuring they align closely with your child's interests and goals despite their lower probability of acceptance.

Managing Expectations

While acknowledging the importance of standardized test scores and grades, remember that admissions decisions also consider qualitative factors such as community involvement and personal background. Therefore, it's crucial to balance the college list to avoid high-risk selections that lack feasible options.

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Final Considerations

When assisting your child, ensure their likelies are appealing and that they envision themselves attending each school. If not, consider replacing them with schools that genuinely excite them. Engaging in this process collaboratively will help your child feel more confident and supported in their college journey.

ACTIVITY #4: The College List

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Balancing College Selection Categories

Critical Interpretation: The author emphasizes categorizing potential colleges into 'Sweet Spot', 'Likely', and 'Aspirational' to effectively manage your child's college applications; however, this may oversimplify the diversity of individual choices and the complexity of college admissions. Such a linear approach could risk neglecting unique personal and academic variables that vary greatly from student to student. Research by organizations like the National Association for College Admission Counseling (NACAC) suggests the admissions landscape is nuanced, and relying solely on this framework may lead to missed opportunities for students whose strengths aren't aligned with typical metrics, such as test scores or grades.

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Chapter 11 Summary : Activity #4: The College List

Section	Details
Activity Title	The College List
Purpose	To collaboratively draft a college list for parents and children.
Preparation Steps	Gather index cards and I's and C's. Use resources like the Fiske Guide to Colleges, and seek input from college counselors.
Creating the Draft List	Organize into three categories: sweet spot, likely, and aspirational. Aim for a list of 12 to 15 schools. Focus on brainstorming rather than specific choices.
Discussion and Evaluation	Discuss alignment of selected schools with child's interests. Consider intellectual challenges, cultural relevance, and impact on anxiety. Evaluate appropriateness of schools in each category.
Next Steps	Create individual worksheets for each college using categories: culture, curriculum, community, conclusions, and cost. Estimate costs using net price calculators on each school's website.

ACTIVITY #4: The College List

This activity is designed for parents and their children to collaboratively draft a college list, either together or

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separately. It is particularly helpful for those who have yet to create a list or are at the beginning of this process.

Preparation Steps

1. Gather index cards and I's and C's.
2. Utilize resources such as the Fiske Guide to Colleges and other college guides alongside input from college counselors and local organizations.

Creating the Draft List

- Organize a legal pad or spreadsheet into three categories: sweet spot, likely, and aspirational.
- Aim for a list of twelve to fifteen schools to refine later.
- Focus on brainstorming without dwelling too much on specific choices.

Discussion and Evaluation

Engage in a dialogue about the lists, using questions to explore how well selected schools align with the child's interests. Considerations may include:

- Alignment of the school community with personal interests.

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- Intellectual challenges offered by the curriculum.
- Cultural relevance and resonance of the school's mission and history.
- Impact of school selection on early process anxieties.
- Appropriateness of the schools in relation to their categories.

Next Steps

If beneficial, create individual worksheets for each college using the five C's—culture, curriculum, community, conclusions, and cost—as headers. Include space for notes from ongoing research and discussions.

For cost assessment, utilize the net price calculator available on each school's website to estimate potential expenses effectively.

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Example

Key Point: Understanding and categorizing colleges is vital in navigating your educational choices effectively.

Example: Imagine sitting down with your parent, surrounded by index cards and various college guides. You both start identifying schools that excite you and fit your values. As you categorize the schools into 'sweet spot', 'likely', and 'aspirational', you realize how this process helps clarify your thoughts. The conversation uncovers what you truly want from a college experience—be it a rigorous academic environment or a diverse community. This collaborative effort not only eases the potential anxiety about selecting the right schools but also strengthens your decision-making skills as you actively engage in shaping your future.

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Chapter 12 Summary : F. Conversations About Learning Style

Section	Summary
Conversations About Learning Style	Understanding a child's learning style is important for selecting colleges that suit their strengths and preferences.
Key Questions to Consider	Consider your child's reading pace, time management skills, and preferred studying environment (solo vs. group, small vs. large classrooms).
College Environment Considerations	Larger colleges may be overwhelming, while smaller ones may feel too intimate. Larger schools can also offer smaller communities and diverse learning experiences.
First-Year Curriculum	Evaluate if first-year courses facilitate a smooth transition to college, focusing on small seminars or introductory courses that reinforce high school learning.
Academic Support Services	Investigate the availability of academic support services like writing centers and tutoring, as these can significantly impact a student's success.
Faculty Accessibility	Inquire about the approachability of faculty during office hours and in informal settings, in addition to student-faculty ratios.
Support for Learning Differences	Colleges vary in their support for students with learning differences. Resources like "The K&W Guide" help students find appropriate institutions for their needs.

Conversations About Learning Style

Understanding your child's learning style is crucial when considering potential colleges. As you observe your child's educational journey, reflect on their strengths and preferences in terms of learning.

Key Questions to Consider

- How naturally does your child grasp reading, and what pace

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do they thrive at?

- How effective are their time management skills?
- Do they prefer studying solo or in a group, and in what type of learning environment do they excel—smaller interactive classrooms versus larger lecture halls?

College Environment Considerations

Mark Allen Poisel highlights the importance of college environments. Larger institutions may overwhelm some students, while smaller ones could feel too intimate. Consider how larger schools might offer smaller communities and opportunities for diverse learning experiences through partnerships with nearby institutions.

First-Year Curriculum

Evaluate if first-year courses help transition your child into

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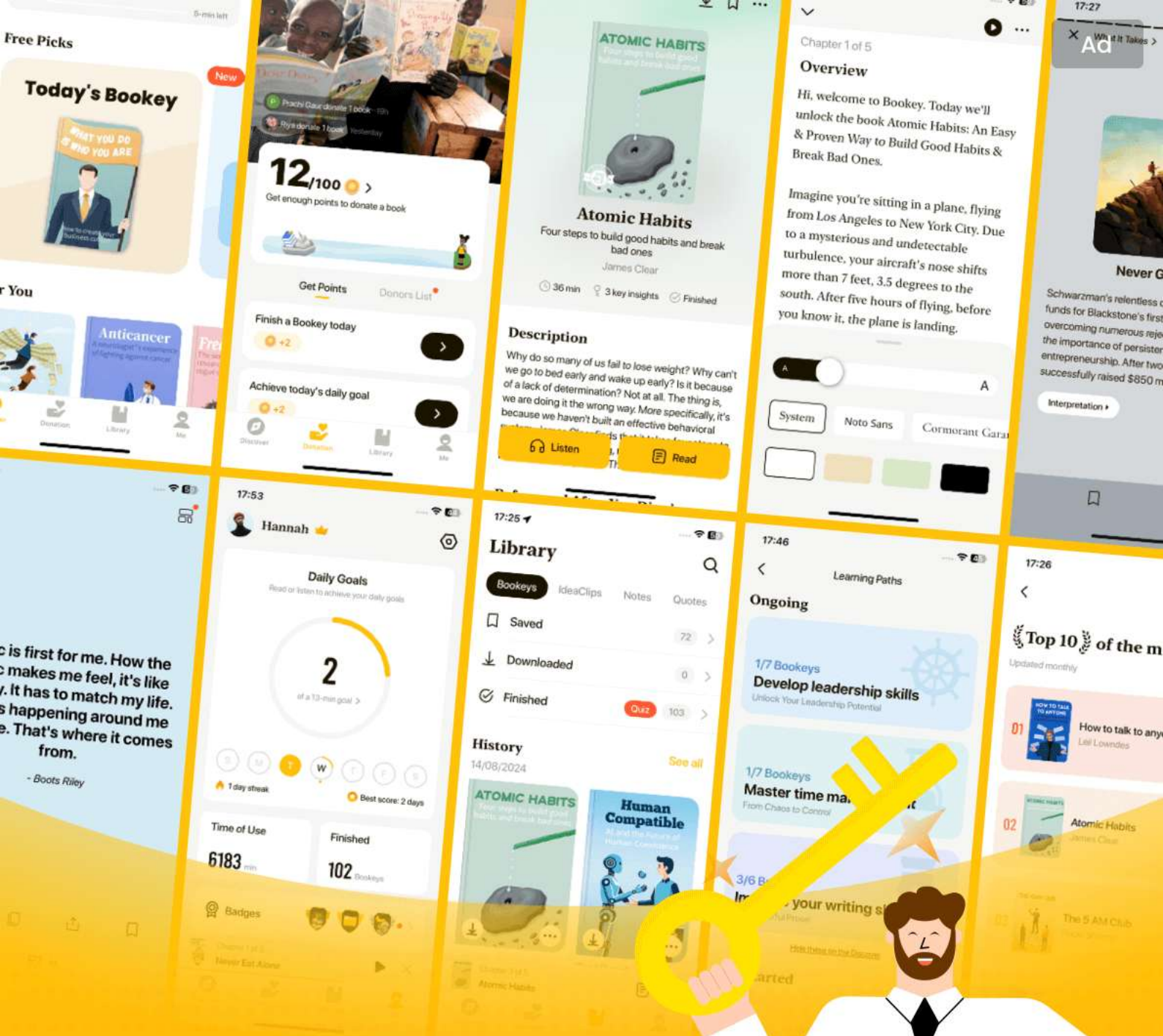
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Chapter 13 Summary : G. Some Thoughts on Standardized Testing

Section	Key Points
Some Thoughts on Standardized Testing	Standardized tests like SAT and ACT are significant in college admissions; importance varies by institution; test-optional policies are increasing.
The Role of Standardized Testing	General Importance: Comparable to high school grades and coursework; predictive of college success. Test-Optional Policies: More colleges not requiring scores to improve access for underrepresented students. Taking the Tests: Recommended to take tests at least once; diagnostic tests like PSAT helpful.
Deciding Between SAT and ACT	Decision based on format, comfort, and costs of prep; free resources available.
Test Preparation	Options: Tutoring, group classes, self-study. More than three attempts may not significantly improve scores.
Retaking Tests	Students may retake for better scores; consider college requirements for essay/writing sections.
Testing Accommodations	Available for students with documented learning differences; ethical concerns regarding misuse should be considered.
Conclusion	Families should evaluate the significance of tests in admissions alongside their child's strengths and challenges.

Some Thoughts on Standardized Testing

Standardized tests, like the SAT and ACT, play a significant role in college admissions, although their importance can vary among institutions. While many selective colleges

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require these scores, an increasing number of schools have adopted a test-optional policy. Understanding which schools require standardized test scores is essential, as it can affect an applicant's chances.

The Role of Standardized Testing

1.

General Importance

- Standardized test scores hold comparable weight to high school course rigor and grades in the holistic admissions process.

- Many colleges have institutional research indicating test scores are predictive of first-year college success.

2.

Test-Optional Policies

- A growing number of selective institutions do not require SAT or ACT scores, often due to concerns about access for underrepresented students.

- Test-optional schools offer opportunities for students to focus more on their coursework and grades.

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Taking the Tests

- Students are encouraged to take standardized tests at least once, even if applying to test-optional schools, to maintain options.
- Preliminary tests like the PSAT and PreACT can serve as diagnostic tools for academic strengths and weaknesses.

Deciding Between SAT and ACT

Students should inform their decision based on the exam format, comfort level, and potential costs associated with test prep and multiple test attempts. Both testing agencies offer free resources for preparation.

1.

Test Preparation

- Options include individual tutoring, group classes, or self-study using online resources.
- Research shows that taking the tests more than three times may not significantly improve scores.

2.

Retaking Tests

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- Some students may choose to retake tests to achieve higher scores, particularly if their initial attempts do not reflect their capabilities.
- Understanding college requirements for essay or writing sections of the test is essential for strategic preparation.

Testing Accommodations

Students with documented learning differences may be eligible for testing accommodations. However, potential misuse of these accommodations can raise ethical concerns. Families should consider the messages they impart regarding integrity and self-advocacy in academic achievements.

Conclusion

When navigating standardized testing, families should weigh the importance of these tests within the broader college admissions landscape, while also considering their child's unique strengths and challenges.

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Example

Key Point: Navigating Test-Optional Policies Can Expand Your College Options

Example: In today's college admissions landscape, understanding the implications of test-optional policies is vital. For instance, as you dive into college applications, you might discover that some of your target schools don't require SAT or ACT scores. This realization can be a game-changer, allowing you to focus more on your coursework and extracurriculars instead of solely on standardized tests. Imagine feeling a sense of freedom as you concentrate on crafting a compelling application that highlights your dedication and unique experiences, rather than just a test score. Recognizing which schools have adopted these policies can enhance your chances of acceptance and give you the confidence to present your true self in your application.

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Chapter 14 Summary : H. Your Child's Background (And How It Might Factor into Their Search)

Your Child's Background and Its Impact on Their College Search

Understanding Diversity in Admissions

Parents often encounter various statistics highlighting a college's diversity, including geographic representation, gender and sexual identity, race, ethnicity, socioeconomic status, and first-generation college status. However, these statistics represent individual stories and experiences that matter in the admissions process.

The Role of Affirmative Action

Affirmative action allows colleges to consider race as part of their admissions strategy, aiming to build a diverse student body. Parents should encourage their children to explore how

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colleges value diverse perspectives and the overall community feel regarding inclusivity for underrepresented groups.

Reflecting on Identity and Community

Students from minority backgrounds, LGBTQ+ identities, or first-generation college students should actively seek information about how welcoming a college community is. This includes understanding the experiences of others from similar backgrounds and assessing support services available on campus.

Financial Considerations and Campus Experience

Colleges often provide travel assistance for prospective students from underrepresented communities to visit campuses. Parents should help their children identify these opportunities and understand financial indicators, such as the percentage of Pell Grant recipients, to gauge inclusivity.

Addressing Non-Majority Backgrounds

Students from diverse backgrounds are encouraged to

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explore the curriculum's inclusivity, looking for programs that reflect a global perspective. Resources like EducationUSA can assist international students in navigating their college search and visa requirements.

Legacy Considerations

For students whose parents attended college, it is important to reflect on how legacy status influences the college search. Parents should balance their emotional attachments to alma maters with their children's personal preferences and aspirations.

Encouraging Independence in College Choice

While parental insights can guide the college search, it's essential to give children space to form their own opinions and make their own decisions about schools, including their alumni experience. Parents should support their children's journey while allowing for individuality in their choices.

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Example

Key Point: Embracing Inclusivity in the College Search

Example: As you help your child navigate their college options, imagine them feeling anxious about fitting in. Encourage them to research colleges that prioritize diversity, ensuring they can connect with peers who share similar backgrounds or experiences. Picture discussing campuses that offer robust support services for LGBTQ+ students, allowing your child to envision themselves thriving in a space that understands their identity. This proactive approach in exploring how comfortable and inclusive a college is can significantly influence their comfort and success.

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Chapter 15 Summary : I. Interests and Talents Developed Over Time

Interests and Talents Developed Over Time

Your child's interests and talents—whether in figure skating, journalism, or science—are often a reflection of their identity and can guide their college search. Encouraging them to connect with faculty or program directors can provide insight into opportunities and expectations. Students should approach this outreach thoughtfully, focusing on one contact within a department to get specific information. They may be required to submit samples of their work, such as portfolios or recordings, at this stage or later in the application process. For prospective athletes, it's important to adhere to NCAA guidelines and register on their website as a student-athlete.

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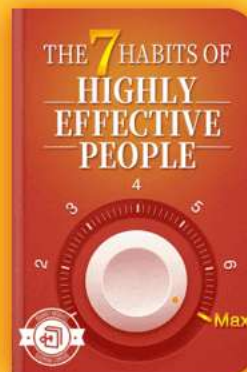
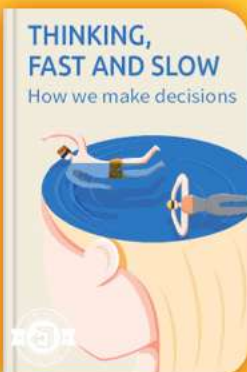


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Chapter 16 Summary : J. The College Visit

The College Visit

Importance of College Visits

As students prepare for college applications, visiting campuses is crucial. College tours—whether virtual or in-person—allow students to envision their future at the institution. Parents should also engage in this process to assess the fit for their child.

Experience the Campus

College visits provide an opportunity to absorb the campus's atmosphere, helping students determine if they can see themselves there. If physical visits are not possible, virtual tours and multimedia experiences can simulate the campus exploration. It's important for students to seek diverse perspectives from online resources and social media, but

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caution against directly contacting admissions personnel.

Planning Campus Visits

Creating a strategic itinerary for college visits is recommended. Registering for visits is a sign of interest, which some colleges monitor in their admissions decisions. Observing the campus during transition times between classes can offer insights into its dynamics. Engaging with alumni from their high school who are currently enrolled can enrich the visit experience.

Tips for Traveling

Families should consider travel logistics and costs. Parents may need to decide on accompanying their child based on mutual comfort. Exploring accommodations, whether through college, local hotels, or family, is advisable. Preparing for travel, including packing tips, can help smooth the experience of college visits.

Local Institutions

Even nearby colleges should not be overlooked as they can

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serve as practice visits and provide relevant insights.

Activity: Planning a College Road Trip

Encourages families to actively plan and prepare for college visits, making the most out of each campus experience.

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Example

Key Point: The necessity of immersive college visits for students.

Example: Imagine stepping onto a picturesque campus with sprawling lawns and historic buildings, feeling the energy of students bustling between classes—this is your moment to truly envision your future. Engaging in college visits, whether physically or virtually, becomes a vital step in determining your fit for an institution, as it allows you to absorb the campus atmosphere, interact with current students, and ask questions that help clarify your aspirations. This firsthand experience not only aids in your decision-making process but also reassures your parents that you've thoroughly evaluated potential schools, making the journey towards your collegiate future feel more concrete.

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Chapter 17 Summary : Activity #5:

Planning a College Road Trip

Planning a College Road Trip

Overview

Planning college visits is an essential aspect of the college selection process. It should involve collaboration between parents and children to create an enjoyable and informative experience.

Timing of Visits

- Begin planning college visits ideally in the summer before the junior year of high school.
- Visits can occur during school vacations or national holidays but be cautious of crowd levels and special programming.

Preparation for Visits

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- Gather necessary tools: high school calendar, navigation tools, rough budget, and printed materials.
- Register for college information sessions and campus tours in advance, considering specific campus schedules and potential restrictions on interviews.

Day of the Visit

- Aim for visits when students are present, avoiding stressful periods like exam weeks.
- Limit visits to two schools per day at most, allowing time for reflection and exploration of the surroundings.

Experience and Reflection

- Take breaks, wear comfortable shoes, and remember that college tours can be intense for both students and parents.
- Bring along materials to record impressions and experiences related to each school, focusing on aspects like culture, curriculum, community, financial considerations, etc.

Questions to Ask

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- Prepare specific questions regarding student support services, campus cultural elements, and academic resources, focusing on depth and detail.

Independent Exploration

- Encourage the child to ask current students about their experiences and perceptions of the campus to gain diverse insights.

Post-Visit Reflection

- After the visit, take time for a moment of reflection, either in silence or shared discussion, to process the college experience.
- Fill out worksheets comparing notes and consider opportunities for returning to campuses in the future.

Final Notes

- Participation in summer programs at colleges can offer further insights into the institution but should not be seen as an admissions advantage.
- Ensure to approach discussions about impressions with

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sensitivity, allowing the child to express their feelings about each visit.

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Chapter 18 Summary : A. Refining the List

Refining the College List

As families engage in the College Conversation, it's essential to focus on refining a child's college list as they approach the critical phase of college applications in the summer before their senior year. This chapter outlines the components of the application process, including transcripts, essays, recommendations, extracurricular records, test results, interviews, and financial aid.

Admissions Calendar

The admissions calendar starts on August 1 when the Common Application becomes available, extending to February of the senior year for some institutions. A well-prepared college list is crucial, ideally narrowed down to eight to ten schools, categorized into aspirational, sweet spot, and likely options.

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Guiding Your Child

To assist in refining their list, families should revisit notes from college visits and assess their choices. Organizing schools into categories can help identify any gaps in the selection process, such as a lack of likely options. This exercise helps children understand that eliminating schools is part of decision-making.

Decision-Making and Values

Children will face tough choices when weighing factors like club sports versus community atmosphere or small class sizes against diverse academic programs. It's important to communicate that no option is perfect, and the appeal of each institution will vary.

Role of Counselors

For those with access to a college counselor, collaboration can enhance this decision-making process. However, families without such resources should feel empowered to navigate the application journey independently.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The significance of a well-refined college list in the admissions process.

Critical Interpretation: This chapter stresses the importance of narrowing down college choices to facilitate decision-making. However, one could question whether such a structured approach truly captures the diverse needs and aspirations of every student. Research (e.g., Kahn et al., 2020 in 'College Admission in the 21st Century') suggests that a more holistic understanding of a student's identity may lead to better-fit outcomes, indicating the author's organized method could overlook unique personal circumstances.

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Chapter 19 Summary : Activity #6: Creating a College Application Requirement and Deadline Tracker

Creating a College Application Requirement and Deadline Tracker

As students begin their college application process, understanding and adhering to deadlines is crucial. Unlike school projects, college admissions deadlines are strict, and being organized is essential for success.

Activity Steps

1.

Choose a Format

: Utilize tools like an Excel spreadsheet, Google Doc, or graph paper for tracking.

2.

List Colleges

: Write down each college that is a finalist.

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3.

Create Columns

: Include headings for application deadlines (rolling, early, regular), fees, requirements (standardized tests, supplemental essays), and admissions office contact information.

4.

Logins

: Note any usernames and passwords for accounts created during the college exploration process.

5.

Reference Materials

: Download the Common Application's "First Year Deadlines, Fees and Requirements" PDF for information on colleges using this application.

6.

Independent Research

: Look up deadlines and requirements for colleges that do not use the Common Application on their individual admissions websites.

7.

Use Calendar Tools

: Consider adding important dates to a digital calendar for reminders, and parents can also track deadlines to help their child stay on task.

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Reflection on the College Application Process

The college application serves as a reporting mechanism and an opportunity for self-reflection. Students should take stock of their goals and aspirations during this time, using the application process to assess their readiness for college life.

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Example

Key Point: Organizing your college application process is essential for meeting strict deadlines and requirements.

Example: Imagine sitting down to tackle your college applications, feeling overwhelmed by the number of schools you're considering. You pull out your laptop and open a meticulously arranged Google Doc that lists each college with its respective application deadlines, fees, and requirements. As you check off completed tasks, you realize how much more confident you feel about the process—having everything organized helps you avoid last-minute stress. With calendar reminders set up for each deadline, you're empowered to manage your time effectively, ensuring you can focus on crafting your personal essays instead of panicking about what's due next. This structured approach not only streamlines your efforts but also provides clarity and direction as you navigate your future.

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Chapter 20 Summary : B. The College Application as a Reporting Mechanism, and a Moment for Your Child to Take Stock

The College Application as a Reporting Mechanism, and a Moment for Your Child to Take Stock

The college application serves both as a necessary form for admission and as a storytelling tool for students. Each component—family background, teacher recommendations, personal statements, and extracurricular choices—provides an opportunity for applicants to express their identity and aspirations. When viewed holistically, these elements create a comprehensive picture of the student, much like a mosaic. Parents are encouraged to establish clear boundaries and allow their children more ownership in the application process. While parental oversight remains important for meeting deadlines, it should not extend to writing essays or dominating the application's narrative. Instead, families should discuss expectations regarding essay feedback and editing, determining whether parents, counselors, or peers

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will provide input.

Students must also monitor their email for important communications from colleges and utilize separate online portals for application updates. Regular check-ins regarding the progress of application submissions, including required materials like transcripts and test scores, are essential for staying organized and on track.

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Chapter 21 Summary : C. Your Child Assembles the Parts: Opportunities to Render Their Experiences

C. Your Child Assembles the Parts: Opportunities to Render Their Experiences

The college application process consists of two main categories: academic components and personal inventory. Academic elements include the high school transcript, standardized test scores, and recommendations, while the personal inventory encompasses activities, portfolios, interviews, and essays.

Admissions Committees

Admissions committees are diverse and comprise individuals from various backgrounds, reflecting a range of experiences and perspectives. They are committed to giving applicants a fair chance and thoroughly evaluating each application, which will typically be reviewed by multiple officers.

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The Transcript

The transcript is a key component of the application, displaying your child's academic performance over the past three years. It is supplemented by a school profile that contextualizes the grades against the school's demographics and curriculum rigor. Parents should review the transcript critically to identify potential narratives regarding your child's academic journey.

Standardized Test Scores

Many colleges require SAT or ACT scores. Students need to decide how to report these scores—which can include self-reporting—and should be aware of individual colleges' policies on score usage, such as superscoring. Students may also consider submitting scores to test-optional schools if their scores are competitive.

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Chapter 22 Summary : Activity #7: Your Child Catalogs Their Activity List

Activity #7: Your Child Catalogs Their Activity List

The objective of this exercise is for your child to inventory their experiences and craft a compelling narrative from that list. They should choose whether to document this on paper or electronically, ensuring it mirrors the activity section of college applications, like the Common Application. This includes details such as years of commitment, hours per week, and continuation interest in college.

Your child should include a comprehensive range of activities and descriptions, focusing on significant experiences marked by importance. This assists in guiding an admissions officer's attention and creating a strong first impression. It is crucial to depict these experiences vividly, using active language and emotional context instead of simply listing facts.

Once they have a draft ready, it should serve as a foundation for entering the final information into the application. There is an advisory against uploading a résumé, as application

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forms are designed for quick information retrieval by admissions officers.

Portfolios and Other Additional Information

While applications usually provide enough space for key information, some students may wish to showcase additional work (like art or performance videos) through a portfolio section. However, creating a portfolio is not necessary for everyone and is mainly relevant for applicants in specific majors.

Some colleges are adopting the Coalition Application for building digital portfolios starting in the ninth grade, but faculty review of portfolio work is not guaranteed.

Applicants can also utilize the "Additional Information" section of the application to elaborate on experiences or circumstances not covered elsewhere, such as explaining significant absences.

Disciplinary Information

College applications might request details about past disciplinary actions. Parents should verify what is on their child's official record, as students are responsible for

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reporting these incidents if required. This transparency allows the child to explain their growth from the experiences. Finally, there is a movement to eliminate questions about disciplinary history in applications, and while the Common Application no longer includes it, individual schools may still inquire.

Conversations About the Essays: Your Child Frames Their Story

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Chapter 23 Summary : D. Conversations About the Essays: Your Child Frames Their Story

Conversations About the Essays: Your Child Frames Their Story

The essay section of college applications is a pivotal opportunity for your child to weave together their experiences into a cohesive narrative. This part is often the final piece they complete prior to submitting their application.

Colleges use essay questions to evaluate two key aspects: first, your child's writing ability, including clarity and organization of thought; second, they are genuinely interested in the personal stories behind the answers.

Here are six essay prompts from the Common Application for the Class of 2025:

1. Share a meaningful background, identity, interest, or talent that your application would be incomplete without.
2. Recount a time facing a challenge or failure and discuss the lessons learned.

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3. Reflect on a time when you questioned a belief or idea; what was the outcome?
4. Describe a problem you have solved or wish to solve, outlining its significance and potential solutions.
5. Discuss an accomplishment or realization that led to personal growth and new understanding.
6. Talk about a topic or concept that captivates you and why it intrigues you.

The seventh prompt is broader: share an essay on any topic of your choice, which could include previously written pieces.

The common thread in these prompts is to encourage reflection on how life experiences have shaped your child's identity and aspirations. This section allows your child to connect directly with the reader, emphasizing the importance of maintaining the agreed-upon boundaries in this process.

ACTIVITY #8: Your Child Looks into Their Rearview Mirror

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The significance of personal storytelling in college essays.

Critical Interpretation: The chapter highlights how college application essays serve not only to showcase writing skills but also as vital reflections of personal identity and experiences. However, one could argue that placing such emphasis on personal narratives may overlook the diverse ways students can demonstrate their abilities and achievements. While Furda advocates for a narrative-centric approach, critics such as Professor K.C. Johnson suggest that admissions can sometimes prioritize other factors over unique personal stories, leading to potential biases in how students are perceived based on their backgrounds or circumstances (Johnson, K.C. "The Fallacy of the Personal Narrative in Admissions" College Admissions Journal, 2020). Thus, while crafting a compelling personal story is essential, parents and students must also consider how holistic admissions processes may evaluate other important metrics.

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Chapter 24 Summary : Activity #8: Your Child Looks into Their Rearview Mirror

ACTIVITY #8: Your Child Looks into Their Rearview Mirror

This exercise is designed to assist parents in helping their children reflect on their past experiences, aiming to identify significant moments for their college essays. These moments need not be grand; even seemingly minor events can reveal much about the applicant to the admissions officers, who typically have little prior knowledge of the student.

Reflection Process

The activity encourages students to act as investigative journalists, exploring their history through prompts such as:

- What is important to you and why?
- What experiences have shaped you?
- Who has influenced you and how?
- How have you changed over time?

This exercise can be spread out over several days, allowing

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students time to reflect deeply, and should be approached thoughtfully to aid in future college applications.

Story and Anecdote Collection

As students reflect, they should aim to gather anecdotes and resonant details that will enhance their narrative. Reading local obituaries can be instructive in understanding how personal details can convey significance about one's life.

Essays as Curated Narratives

Students should understand that their college essays should not be exhaustive memoirs but curated stories that emphasize key themes or assertions. Each story should serve a larger purpose, drawing the reader into a cohesive narrative.

Key Writing Strategies

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Chapter 25 Summary : E. Application Plans

E. Application Plans

This section provides an overview of various college application plans, helping parents understand options such as early and regular applications, along with key definitions and strategies for choosing the best plan for their child.

Rolling Admission

Colleges with rolling admission evaluate applications on a first-come, first-served basis, starting typically on September 1 until the class is filled, which can extend into spring. Many state universities, like Arizona State and Penn State, follow this model. Students often receive admission decisions within two months, with some institutions offering priority deadlines for faster responses.

Early Action (Including Single Choice and Restrictive)

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Early action allows students to submit applications early (usually by November 1) and receive nonbinding admissions decisions by mid-December. Students can generally apply to multiple early action colleges, except for those with restrictive or single choice policies, which limit early applications to only public institutions or specific international schools.

Early Decision

Early decision requires students to commit to attending a college upon acceptance, with a typical November 1 deadline and decisions communicated by mid-December. This plan necessitates signing an agreement that confirms the student will withdraw all other applications if accepted.

Early Decision II

This option mirrors the early decision commitments but offers a later application timeline, typically with early to mid-January deadlines and decisions released by late February, allowing students more time to refine their college choices.

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Regular Decision

Most students apply under regular decision plans, with deadlines ranging between January 1 and February 15. Accepted students have no obligation to attend and usually receive decisions by late March or early April, allowing time to decide before the May 1 National Candidates Reply Date. Note that recent changes may affect deposit deadlines, which vary by institution.

Transfer

This section primarily focuses on application processes for incoming college freshmen, but transfer applications will be discussed in a later section, highlighting that while some aspects remain similar to first-time applications, deadlines and rules vary widely.

F. Assessing Whether an Early Application Plan May Be Best for Your Child

Parents should consider various factors to determine if an early application plan suits their child's interests and objectives.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Understanding the Different College Application Plans

Critical Interpretation: The exploration of college application plans emphasizes the complexities parents face in navigating the choices available for their children's academic futures. While the chapter encourages early applications for potentially advantageous outcomes, it is critical for readers to recognize that the perceived advantages of early decisions, such as increased acceptance rates, may not universally apply. For instance, various studies, such as those by the National Association for College Admission Counseling (NACAC), suggest that early action may not significantly enhance a student's overall admission prospects compared to regular decision candidates. These nuances should prompt parents to critically evaluate whether the strategies outlined genuinely align with their child's unique circumstances and needs, rather than merely following potentially flawed assumptions.

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Chapter 26 Summary : F. Assessing Whether an Early Application Plan May Be Best for Your Child

Assessing Whether an Early Application Plan May Be Best for Your Child

This chapter discusses the considerations for parents and students when deciding whether to submit an early college application. Early applications are defined as those with deadlines prior to January 1. The text provides guidance on how families can navigate this decision-making process effectively by using reflections and exercises previously completed.

Key Considerations for Early Applications

1.

Personal Reflection

:

- Students should align their college preferences with their identity and the culture of potential institutions.

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2.

Utilizing Resources

:

- Parents are encouraged to seek advice from college counseling available at schools or community organizations.

3.

Logistical Checks

:

- It's vital for students to track application requirements and deadlines. They must ensure they have completed necessary standardized tests and be aware of specific deadlines that may allow for late test scores.

4.

Managing Pressure

:

- Students should evaluate whether they can handle the emotional pressure of applying early, especially if it involves additional requirements.

Activity Suggestion: A Preflight Checklist for Those Considering Flying Early

- Implementing a checklist can help students assess their readiness and the strategic fit of applying early. This

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checklist will not only aid in logistics but also help in reinforcing their preparedness for the application process.

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Chapter 27 Summary : Activity #9: A Preflight Checklist for Those Considering Flying Early

ACTIVITY #9: A Preflight Checklist for Those Considering Flying Early

This section discusses a preflight checklist that parents can use to support their child when considering early college applications. It likens the college application process to piloting an airplane, where parents act as copilots, aiding their child in navigating the final stages of decision-making.

Key Questions for Consideration

- Evaluate if the institution aligns with prior assumptions and preferences regarding distance, size, and overall fit.
- Consider the placement of the school on the college list (likely, sweet spot, aspirational) and assess comfort with the risks of early application.
- Reflect on academic performance (grades and standardized test scores) to determine competitiveness as an early

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applicant.

- Ensure adequate time has been given to teachers for recommendation letters and confirm the readiness of application essays.
- Discuss financial aid implications, particularly for binding early decision applications, including the inability to compare offers from other institutions.
- Prepare emotionally for the possibility of committing to a single institution if admitted under a binding early decision plan.

Financial Aid Considerations

- Understand the nuances of early decision agreements regarding financial aid and the importance of entering this commitment in good faith.
- Familiarize oneself with the net price calculator provided by the institution to estimate financial commitments.

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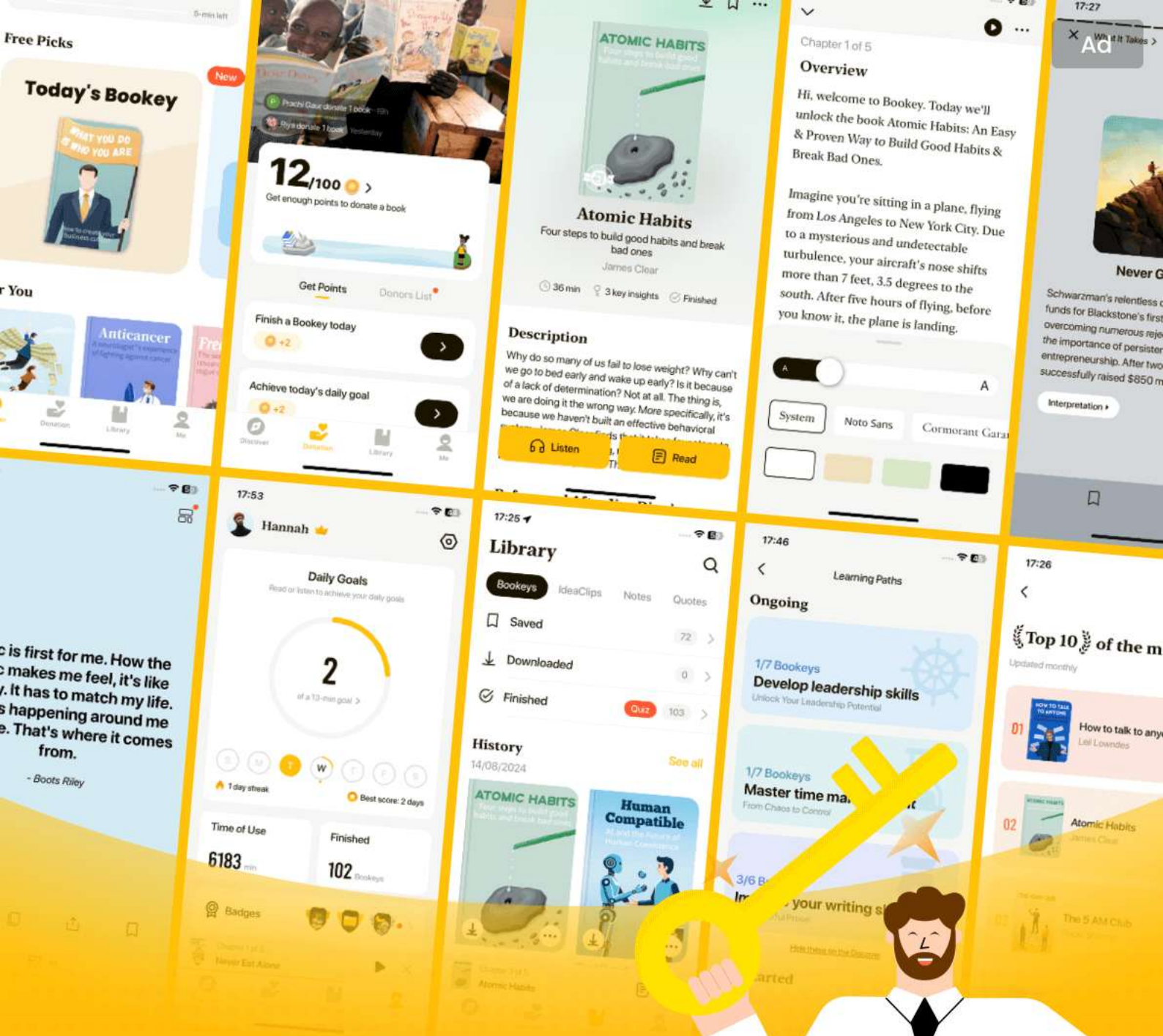
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Chapter 28 Summary : G. The Fifth C Revisited: Managing Cost and Affordability

The Fifth C Revisited: Managing Cost and Affordability

During the application process, parents play a crucial role in helping their children navigate financial questions related to higher education. Key considerations include application fees and financial aid forms.

Application Fees and Waivers

- Some colleges charge application fees ranging from \$25 to \$100.
- Students can request fee waivers, which are assessed based on criteria like existing fee waivers for standardized tests or qualifying for free/reduced lunch.
- College counselors may need to document the need for waivers.

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Financial Aid Applications

When seeking financial aid, families typically need to complete several forms:

-

FAFSA

: The Free Application for Federal Student Aid can be submitted starting October 1 of the senior year and is crucial for determining eligibility for federal grants and loans.

Filling out the FAFSA can be complex and intrusive, but it opens discussions about financial responsibilities. Tips for completing the FAFSA include:

- Answer questions accurately, providing estimates when necessary.
- Include all household members to impact aid calculation.
- Home value is not reported as an asset.
- All required documentation should be organized before starting the application.

-

CSS Profile

: Used by nearly 400 institutions, the CSS Profile incurs a fee and is more detailed than the FAFSA, asking for information about household assets and income. It focuses on institutional aid.

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Institution-Specific Forms

: Some colleges may have additional financial aid forms to complete for more context on family finances.

Outside Scholarships

These funds come from external sources and may include opportunities like the National Merit Scholarship, company-sponsored scholarships, or state programs such as the Hope Scholarship. Students should actively search for scholarships from varied organizations and opportunities.

Essay Sections for Scholarships

Scholarship applications may include essays. Students can leverage their previous college application essays to craft responses, ensuring they address specific prompts carefully.

Tracking Submissions

Both parents and students should ensure all financial aid documents are submitted and received, utilizing college application portals to keep track of required materials and

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follow up on outstanding items.

This chapter emphasizes the importance of financial literacy and proactive management during the college application process to ensure families are well-prepared for the financial commitments of higher education.

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Chapter 29 Summary : H. Some Thoughts on Pacing, Time Management, and the Parallel Universe Where Life in High School Goes On

Some Thoughts on Pacing, Time Management, and the Parallel Universe Where Life in High School Goes On

As your child approaches college application deadlines, it is crucial to pause and reflect on the progress made so far. Ensure that they utilize breaks in their school calendar wisely, whether to advance their applications or to recuperate. Checking in with family members, including younger siblings and partners, helps gauge overall well-being.

Pacing and Managing the Application Process

Encourage your child to view application due dates not as cramming sessions but as milestones. Help them create mini-deadlines leading up to January 1, ensuring they

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allocate tasks evenly over time. Be observant for signs of procrastination, which often stems from fear rather than laziness, and offer a supportive listening ear.

Checklist for Final Application Review

Your child should create a final checklist for regular decision applications, including:

- Conducting a final proofreading of printed applications.
- Revisiting essays with specific objectives in mind to polish them.
- Self-reporting standardized test scores appropriately.
- Requesting recommendations and transcripts from their school.
- Preparing any necessary supplemental materials, such as portfolios.
- Prioritizing early submissions and ensuring a buffer period before deadlines.

Encourage your child to take strategic breaks to maintain control over the process and avoid fatigue-induced errors. Balancing academic responsibilities alongside college applications is essential; thus, logging school deadlines on a master calendar can help manage competing demands. Remember, time for self-care is vital and should be integrated into this busy period.

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Chapter 30 Summary : I. Ready to Submit

I. Ready to Submit

As your child prepares to submit their college applications, a mix of emotions may arise, ranging from relief to doubt. It's important for parents to be supportive and help their child process these feelings while encouraging them to focus on the present.

Emotional Responses

Children may feel elated to complete their applications but may also experience a letdown or second-guess their choices. Parents should listen and offer reassurance during this transition period.

Encouraging Presence

This moment can serve as a valuable teaching opportunity. Parents can guide their children to stay present, encouraging

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them to move past the stressing application phase and embrace the awaiting period.

Strategies for Waiting

Assist your child in managing the long wait for college decisions. Encourage them to return to a more regular routine and reconnect with joyful activities while maintaining their academic responsibilities.

Parental Self-Care

Parents should also take time to reflect and recharge, as the application process can be taxing for them as well. Focus on maintaining a balanced life as new decisions will arise in the future.

Celebrating Milestones

Submitting the last college application is a significant milestone that both parents and children should acknowledge and celebrate together.

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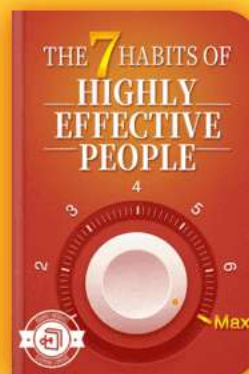
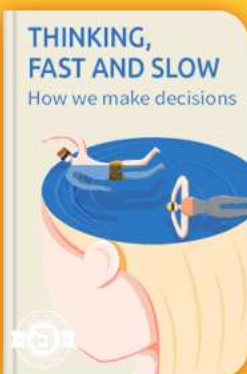


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Chapter 31 Summary : A. Back Inside the Admissions Office: Conversations About the Applicants, and Building a Class

Back Inside the Admissions Office: Conversations About the Applicants, and Building a Class

The college admissions process transitions from students and families to admissions committees after application submission. Unlike centralized admissions in other countries, the U.S. system offers more flexibility, allowing students to apply to multiple institutions. After submission, applicants should regularly check admissions portals to ensure all components are received, while remaining active in their high school performance.

The Application Review Process

Once an application is submitted, it moves swiftly through digital channels to the admissions office. Admissions officers now use technology for evaluation, which allows more time

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for review despite the increasing number of applications. The use of committee-based evaluations enables quicker yet thorough assessments, as multiple officers collaborate in reviewing applications.

Holistic Admissions Approach

Admissions officers evaluate candidates through a holistic process, considering several factors such as academics, recommendations, extracurricular involvement, personal essays, and demonstrated interest. The latter may influence acceptance if an applicant's evaluation is close.

Creating a Diverse Class

Admissions officers aim to craft a diverse first-year community, taking into account a variety of backgrounds, interests, and potential contributions to campus activities. Factors like legacy status may still play a role, though they face scrutiny for perpetuating privilege.

The Conversation on Fairness

There are ongoing discussions about fairness in the

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admissions process, particularly regarding disparities in education and standardized testing. Initiatives like ACCEPT are exploring barriers in admissions for underrepresented groups.

Conclusion of the Admissions Process

As decisions are finalized, admissions offices will notify students of their outcomes—admit, deny, or waitlist—between March and April, summarizing the complexities of the admissions process and the attributes of the incoming class. The statistics reflect a commitment to a diverse and qualified student body but do not capture the full individual narratives beyond numbers.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The emphasis on holistic admissions can obscure significant inequalities in the educational landscape.

Critical Interpretation: While Eric J. Furda advocates for a holistic admissions process that values diverse experiences and backgrounds, one must critically assess whether this truly enhances fairness in college admissions. Holistic assessments might allow admissions committees to present a more well-rounded view of applicants; however, they can also mask systemic inequalities that favor privileged students who may have access to better educational resources and extracurricular opportunities. Critics like Richard Shaffer in 'College Admissions in the 21st Century' argue that holistic evaluations can inadvertently perpetuate a cycle of privilege, where students from affluent backgrounds are better positioned to showcase their strengths. Therefore, while the holistic approach is well-intentioned, the complexities behind access to quality education and resources must remain a focal point of these discussions.

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Chapter 32 Summary : B. Back to the Kitchen Table: Sorting, Weighing, and Analyzing the Colleges' Decisions

Back to the Kitchen Table: Sorting, Weighing, and Analyzing the Colleges' Decisions

If you're a parent of a high school senior, April is a busy time filled with anticipation for college decisions. To ease this process, parents should review key dates in April, including admitted student days, religious holidays, and work commitments, while keeping their calendars organized. Important deadlines, such as May 1 for college enrollment decisions, should also be carefully noted.

Colleges now set specific dates for decision notifications, which can arrive via online portals or traditional mail, often between mid-March and early April. Students may receive "likely letters" indicating a high chance of admission, particularly if they are recruited athletes or stand out academically. Parents are encouraged to support their child during this emotionally charged time by discussing how they prefer to receive the news and being present to help process

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the results—whether they are acceptances or rejections. Rejections can be difficult for both students and parents, who may feel tempted to react defensively. It's crucial to resist that impulse and instead focus on the positives from other acceptances. When good news arrives, celebrate thoughtfully, being mindful of others who may not have received favorable outcomes.

For students placed on waiting lists, understanding the true nature of these lists is vital. Each institution has different policies regarding how many students will ultimately be drawn from the waiting list. Parents should help their children navigate these situations, discussing whether to remain on the list and how to reaffirm their interest.

Your Child Is Back in the Driver's Seat, with Decisions to Make

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Chapter 33 Summary : C. Your Child Is Back in the Driver's Seat, with Decisions to Make

Your Child Is Back in the Driver's Seat, with Decisions to Make

In the aftermath of receiving college admission decisions, your child may feel overwhelmed and uncertain about the next steps. Drawing a parallel to the movie "The Candidate," the moment of victory can often lead to the question, "What do we do now?" It's crucial for students to regroup and assess their options as the decision deadline approaches.

Decision-Making Process

1.

Taking Stock

: Within days of receiving all admission decisions, encourage your child to evaluate their current standing and establish criteria to inform their final college selection.

2.

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Gathering Additional Information

: Remind them to consider any necessary information they need to collect, such as campus visits.

3.

Reflecting on Choices

: As they navigate this process, remind your child of how they arrived at this point by revisiting the materials and exercises completed during their college search.

Utilizing Past Insights

Your child has previously identified their academic and personal priorities through exercises involving their Five I's (identity, intellect, ideas, interests, and inspiration) and the Four C's of college attributes (culture, curriculum, community, cost). Gathering and re-examining this information can aid in making a thoughtful decision.

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Chapter 34 Summary : Activity #10: Your Child Revisits Their Priorities as the College Choice Looms

ACTIVITY #10: Your Child Revisits Their Priorities as the College Choice Looms

This activity encourages your child to reflect on their college preferences by revisiting the index cards created in Activity #1. They should do this without considering specific colleges, focusing instead on validating or updating their priorities.

Purpose of the Activity

The aim is to engage in a moment of meditation and introspection, recognizing that the past few months may have brought significant personal growth.

Instructions for Reflection

1.

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Environmental Factors

: Evaluate the importance of college size, location, and distance from home.

2.

Academic Interests

: Consider interests in specific fields of study and possible alternative paths within those fields.

3.

Student Life

: Identify what social and extracurricular aspects would enrich their college experience.

4.

X Factor

: Reflect on additional priorities such as community involvement, support services, and local culture.

After completing this exercise, your child can reassess the list of potential colleges, using the insights gained from this reflective process.

ACTIVITY #11: Mapping the Choice

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Chapter 35 Summary : Activity #11:

Mapping the Choice

ACTIVITY #11: Mapping the Choice

Overview

This activity encourages your child to create an organized grid to assess college choices. It aims to facilitate clearer decision-making by documenting thoughts and reflections on chosen universities.

Creating the Grid

- Use either a spreadsheet or handwritten format on large paper.
- List accepted colleges alphabetically along the left side, including waiting list schools if applicable.
- Label the top with the Five C's: culture, curriculum, community, conclusions, and cost.

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Filling the Grid

- Instead of the Five I's (identity, intellect, ideas, interests, inspiration), reflect on how these concepts intersect with the Five C's for each institution.
- Use words or phrases for free-flowing reflections, creating a personal guide as they compare choices more holistically than with a simple pro/con list.

Examples of Reflections

- Assess how academic interests align with a college's curriculum.
- Document cultural and community aspects like Greek life and civic engagement under relevant C's.
- Note school outcomes like graduation rates under conclusions and financial aid/anticipated costs under cost.

Emotional Considerations

- Recognize that this process can evoke emotions and should not be purely cognitive.
- Encourage conversations about anxiety factors related to college decisions, encouraging your child to express

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concerns and ask questions.

- Document concerns on the grid and highlight any missing information that needs addressing.

Encouragement and Perspective

- Urge your child to embrace challenges as growth opportunities rather than retreating to comfort.

- Provide reassurance regarding their decision timeline—typically about a month until final decisions are made.

- Highlight the importance of thoughtful decision-making and suggest taking breaks for mental clarity, including time with friends, exercise, and self-care practices.

Final Note

Remind your child that they have the time to consider their options, allowing for a more profound understanding and preparation for their next steps.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Structured Decision-Making is Subjective

Critical Interpretation: The chapter emphasizes creating a structured grid for college choices but may oversimplify the complex, emotional aspects of decision-making involved in this life stage. While organizing thoughts can help clarify priorities, relying heavily on a grid can unintentionally box in perspectives, as important variables such as personal preferences, unique family circumstances, or unforeseen future opportunities may be neglected. It's crucial for readers to question whether such a method fully captures the nuanced and often subjective nature of choosing a college, inviting comparisons with scholarship like Schwartz's "The Paradox of Choice," which suggests that too much structure can lead to decision fatigue. Furthermore, emotional responses shouldn't be reduced to mere entries on a grid; this critical interpretation encourages individuals to seek a more balanced approach, integrating both logical frameworks and emotional well-being in decision-making.

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Chapter 36 Summary : D. Another Round of Due Diligence: Supporting Your Child as They Weigh Their Final Choices

Another Round of Due Diligence: Supporting Your Child as They Weigh Their Final Choices

In this chapter, parents are guided on how to support their children during the critical final stage of selecting a college after acceptance. It highlights the emotional stress students may experience as schools try to attract them. Parents are encouraged to facilitate campus visits to deepen their child's connection to potential schools, while being mindful of the financial implications such trips may incur.

Emotional Concerns for Parents

Parents, especially those sending their first child to college, may harbor fears about their child's independence and safety. Counsel from educators like Omar Monteagudo reassures parents about the importance of allowing their children to

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pursue opportunities, even when it involves distance from home.

Involvement Options for Parents

Parents can engage in this phase of the College Conversation by participating in campus visits or exploring online resources together. If a visit isn't feasible, they can still contribute by seeking information through admitted student portals.

Gathering Information on Support Services

It's crucial for parents to inquire about academic and mental health support services at potential colleges. They should understand how each institution facilitates student well-being and success, as these aspects are increasingly vital for student retention and achievement.

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Chapter 37 Summary : E. Factoring Financial Aid into the Final Decision

Factoring Financial Aid into the Final Decision

When your child receives an admission offer, it typically includes a financial aid package comprising need-based aid (scholarships, grants), work-study opportunities, and loans. Merit-based aid may also be offered to incentivize enrollment from high-achieving students. To effectively compare financial aid offers, families should utilize resources like the Financial Aid Comparison Worksheet from ScholarMatch to document and evaluate the various components of each package.

Families are encouraged to communicate with financial aid offices for clarifications or appeals regarding aid amounts. Sharing relevant financial circumstances can strengthen the appeal for additional assistance. Persistence in follow-ups is essential, as seen in the experience of college student Ariana Campos, who successfully navigated financial aid issues through perseverance and support.

It's important to understand the differing criteria for

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need-based and merit aid when making comparisons between institutions. If a family receives varying merit aid offers, they can inform institutions about discrepancies to explore potential adjustments.

Stress may arise when discussing financial matters, but financial aid staff are there to assist families within the bounds of their policies. An additional tool available is the student loan repayment estimator from the U.S. Department of Education, which can help families understand the financial implications of loans.

As the decision-making process continues, families should also be prepared for a nonrefundable deposit to secure their child's intention to attend. This amount will be deducted from total costs, and families receiving financial aid may request a waiver for the deposit.

If Your Child Remains on a Waiting List

Additional considerations may arise if your child is still on a waiting list or wishes to take a gap year, which should also be addressed during the decision-making process.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Utilizing Resources for Financial Decisions

Critical Interpretation: The chapter emphasizes the necessity of accurately comparing diverse financial aid packages, urging families to utilize tools like the Financial Aid Comparison Worksheet. This standpoint assumes that families have the ability and knowledge to navigate complex financial systems, which may not universally hold true. Not all families have equal access to these resources or the financial literacy needed to effectively negotiate aid, highlighting potential disparities in educational access. It's crucial to approach the author's advice critically, as research indicates significant challenges faced by many low-income families in understanding financial aid (Dynarski & Scott-Clayton, 2013). Therefore, readers should consider that while the author provides useful strategies, these may not apply uniformly across all socio-economic contexts.

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Chapter 38 Summary : F. If Your Child Remains on a Waiting List

If Your Child Remains on a Waiting List

After being placed on a waiting list, your child must continue exploring other college options. It's essential to quickly inform the college of their interest in the waiting list spot. They may need to fill out an online form to update the college with new achievements, such as grades or extracurricular accomplishments, ensuring that this information is added to their application.

While your child might consider sending additional correspondence to the admissions team, such letters may not reach the application file. Instead, they should express their ongoing interest through the provided form or a separate email. Colleges will factor in this expressed interest when deciding if a student will accept an offer if a spot opens up. The waiting list can remain active until the end of June, with most colleges finalizing their first-year classes by July 1, at which point they will notify students if the waiting list is closed. If your child is still on a waiting list by late April,

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they must secure a place at another institution where they have been admitted. If they later receive an offer from a waiting list, they can choose to decline their previous acceptance, though any deposit may be forfeited.

For Those Students Considering a Gap Year

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Chapter 39 Summary : G. For Those Students Considering a Gap Year

For Those Students Considering a Gap Year

A gap year, typically taken between high school and college, may be chosen by students for various reasons, including cultural or religious commitments, military service, community service, entrepreneurial pursuits, financial need, or burnout. Research suggests that students who take a gap year tend to have higher rates of college persistence and graduation.

There is a wealth of resources available online and in literature about gap year options, including programs offered by for-profit businesses and nonprofits like Global Citizen Year, which provides immersion-based international experiences and scholarships up to \$32,500 based on need. To pursue a gap year, students must first accept a college admission offer and then request a deferral of enrollment in writing, stating their reasons and plans for the year.

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Chapter 40 Summary : Activity #12:

Narrowing the Field

Narrowing the Field

In this chapter, the authors guide parents and their children through a structured decision-making process for selecting a college. The exercise takes place in a comfortable, private setting with essential tools: a comparison grid and a financial aid worksheet.

Activity Overview

-

Set the Environment

: Choose a quiet place for discussion, avoiding distractions.

-

Use Visual Aids

: Utilize markers or highlighters (green, yellow, red) to differentiate and rank colleges based on various criteria, particularly focusing on curriculum and financial aid.

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Curriculum Considerations

- Encourage a thorough exploration of academic offerings and how they align with the child's interests.
- Use visual cues to indicate institutions that stand out positively (green), neutrally (yellow), or negatively (red).

Financial Assessments

- Integrate financial factors into the discussion, referencing the financial aid worksheet.
- Address emotional impacts surrounding costs openly, ensuring a supportive environment.

Individual and Joint Exercises

- Both parents and children can complete their versions of the exercise, fostering independence while balancing parental insights.
- Be aware of other adults' opinions and their influence on the child's decision-making process.

Time Management and Stress Reduction

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- Allow ample time for reflection and decision-making, encouraging breaks if stress arises.
- Focus on reducing anxiety to facilitate clear thinking.

Final Decision Making

- Identify colleges with significant red markings for elimination.
- Help weigh the importance of green and yellow indicators in various categories.
- Aim for a well-considered final decision before deadlines, ideally before the rush of nearing the May 1 candidate reply date.

Final Reflection

- Encourage visualization of attending the chosen college to reinforce confidence and excitement.
- Strive for a decision that feels promising and aligned with the child's aspirations, affirming a sound decision-making process.

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Chapter 41 Summary : I. The Moments Immediately After the Decision

I. The Moments Immediately After the Decision

Celebration and Rest

After making a college decision, it's important for both you and your child to take a moment for celebration, alongside some necessary rest. Encourage your child to refrain from posting about their decision on social media immediately, allowing them a time to reflect privately.

Feelings of Letdown

It's common for your child to feel a sense of letdown or anticlimax after such a significant decision, due to the heightened expectations surrounding the college process. Assuring them that these emotions are normal can help ease their concerns.

Second-Guessing

Your child may experience second-guessing regarding their choice. It's crucial to support them by acknowledging that many compelling choices can lead to uncertainty, and remind them that they made a thoughtful decision based on available

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information.

Addressing Regret

In some cases, second-guessing may evolve into deeper regret or anxiety about their choice, particularly if they were denied admission to aspirational schools. In such instances, help them find acceptance and prepare to embrace the opportunities their chosen college offers.

Evaluating Choices

If your child remains convinced they made the wrong choice, you should explore whether their anxiety stems from the decision itself or a general apprehension about starting college. Involving their college counselor in the discussion may provide additional support and clarify any lingering doubts.

Transition Support

The emotional transition to college and other related topics will be further explored in the concluding section of "The College Conversation."

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: Embracing the Emotional Journey
Post-Decision is Essential

Critical Interpretation: The chapter emphasizes the importance of recognizing the emotional rollercoaster that follows a college decision, which includes celebration, feelings of letdown, and potential regret. However, while these feelings are common, the author's perspective may overlook individual experiences, suggesting that not all students react similarly to such transitions. For some, social media can be a tool for connection during this time, rather than a distraction. It's important to consider the broader context of mental health and transition support that various studies have highlighted, such as those from the American Psychological Association, which stress the value of personalized coping strategies in overcoming anxiety related to major life changes.

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Chapter 42 Summary : A. On the Importance of Your Child's Finishing High School Strong

On the Importance of Your Child's Finishing High School Strong

Finishing high school strong is crucial for students as they approach graduation. As the excitement of their college acceptance sets in, students may feel the temptation to relax and lose focus during their final weeks. Parents should encourage their children to remain engaged in academic, extracurricular, and community experiences.

Despite the urge to ease up, it is essential for students to maintain strong focus, as their college admission is often contingent upon the conditions laid out in an enrollment agreement. This agreement typically requires students to stay academically responsible and to uphold good citizenship within their school and community.

Parents should discuss this agreement with their children to reinforce their accountability and commitment to these expectations. It's important to note that the final transcript

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submitted to colleges can affect admission status; any drop in grades or failure to graduate can prompt scrutiny from admissions offices. In the event of significant academic declines without a valid explanation, students risk their college acceptance. Each year, many students receive warnings from admissions offices regarding their status, underscoring the importance of a strong finish in high school.

Decisions and Actions Between Your Child's High School Graduation and Their Arrival at College

This section highlights the significance of the actions taken by students during the transition from high school to college, emphasizing that the efforts put in after graduation can also influence their college experience.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The urgency of maintaining academic standards until graduation is vital, according to Furda.

Critical Interpretation: While Eric J. Furda argues that high school seniors should not ease their standards after college acceptance, it is essential to critically assess this stance, as it may overlook the psychological and emotional states of students transitioning to adulthood. This perspective could lead to undue stress, potentially exacerbating mental health issues among youths during a pivotal life phase. According to the National Alliance on Mental Illness, pressure to maintain academic performance can negatively impact student well-being, suggesting that a balance between academic rigor and mental health support would serve students better. Furthermore, not all colleges impose strict conditions relating to high school performance, as increasingly holistic admission processes prioritize various aspects of student profiles, which may contradict Furda's stringent viewpoint.

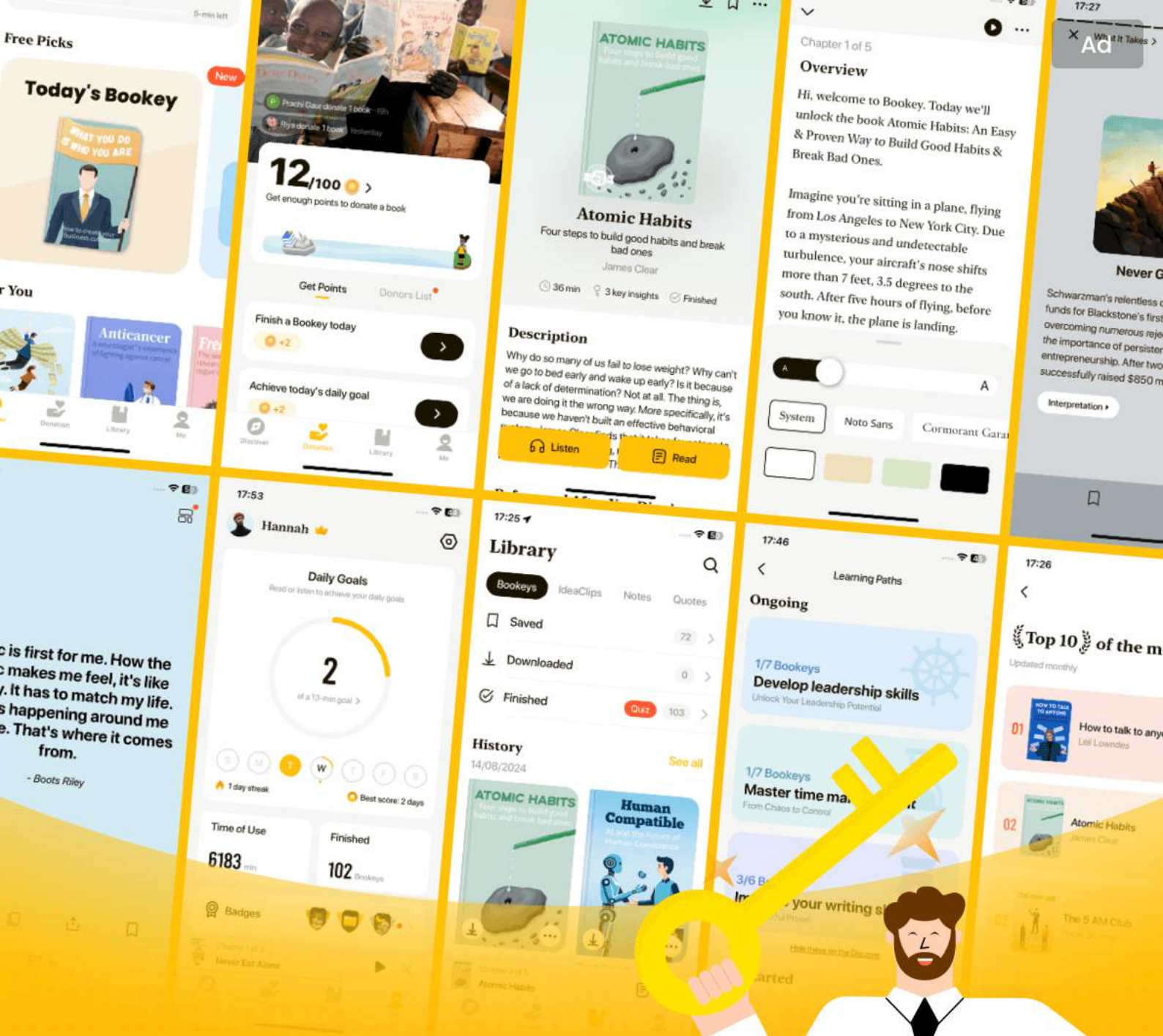
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Chapter 43 Summary : B. Decisions and Actions Between Your Child's High School Graduation and Their Arrival at College

Decisions and Actions Between Your Child's High School Graduation and Their Arrival at College

After high school graduation and college acceptance, numerous campus offices will contact incoming students regarding tasks and choices. This section outlines an extensive to-do list that will help parents support their children during this transitional phase.

Key Tasks for Incoming College Students

1.

Set Up Student Identification and Portal

- Establish access to a student ID and email for communication and service options.

2.

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Join Social Media Groups

- Encourage participation in official and unofficial communities for incoming students to foster connections.

3.

Apply for Housing and Choose a Roommate

- Understand the housing registration process and options for selecting a roommate, including surveys and requests.

4.

Financial Management

- Manage tuition payments and ensure that financial aid is applied correctly. Consider tuition insurance for added security.

5.

Health and Immunization Requirements

- Complete required immunizations and health records to ensure class registration eligibility. Decide on health insurance options.

6.

Familiarize with Support Services

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- Research available health and wellness services, academic support, and required online courses before classes begin.

7.

Engage with Academic Adviser

- Contact assigned academic adviser early to discuss course registration and understand academic policies and deadlines.

8.

Participate in Orientation Activities

- Sign up for orientation events that help acclimate to college life and fulfill any pre-arrival assignments.

9.

Explore Accommodations

- Discuss any necessary learning or physical accommodations with appropriate campus offices ahead of time.

Setting Responsibilities and Communication

As students transition to college life, it's essential for parents and children to establish clear roles and responsibilities.

Open conversations about feelings and expectations will aid

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in navigating the emotional complexities of this significant change.

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Chapter 44 Summary : C. Conversations About Laying a Foundation for Success

Conversations About Laying a Foundation for Success

Engaging in discussions about preparing for a successful college experience is crucial as your child transitions to this new stage. The first year, often referred to as the "Momentum Year" by Complete College America, is a pivotal time for educational continuity. Research indicates that students who navigate their first year effectively are more likely to graduate. It's important to align definitions of success—whether it be grades, friendships, or personal growth.

Building Blocks for Success

-

Advocacy and Outreach

: Encourage your child to forge relationships with professors and peers. Engaging with faculty during office hours can

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foster a sense of belonging and enhance the learning experience. Promote participation in programs that connect students with professors to bolster these relationships.

-

Time Management and Executive Function

: Transitioning from a structured high school environment to a more independent college setting requires effective time management skills. Encourage your child to utilize campus resources for learning these skills to balance schoolwork, socializing, and potential part-time jobs.

-

Forming an Identity and Finding Community Outside the Classroom

: Extracurricular activities are vital for a well-rounded college experience. Encourage participation in student organizations to combat homesickness and build new friendships. Students can also benefit from connecting their studies to practical experiences through volunteering or internships, although formal internships may be better suited for later semesters.

-

Sleep, Nutrition, and Exercise

: Emphasize the importance of maintaining healthy habits. Encourage proper sleep, balanced nutrition, and regular

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exercise for academic success and overall well-being.

-

Stress, Anxiety, and Depression

: Mental health is a significant concern for many college freshmen. Parents should be vigilant for signs of struggle, promote open discussions about mental health, and encourage the use of campus support services.

-

Managing a Student Budget and a Part-Time Job

: Balancing work with academics is crucial. Discuss financial aid options and set realistic work hours to avoid overwhelming your child and potentially harming their academic performance. Regularly review budgets and spending habits together.

-

The Role of Struggling and Failure in Success

: College can be a challenging adjustment, especially for high-achieving students. Encourage resilience in the face of academic setbacks, framing challenges as opportunities for growth. If feelings of inadequacy arise, remind your child of their merits that led to their acceptance and the value they bring to the campus community.

Drop-off, Departure, and Check-in Points

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Regular check-ins with your child as they navigate their college experience can help address challenges and celebrate achievements.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point: The Importance of Healthy Habits in Academic Success

Critical Interpretation: While Furda emphasizes the necessity of maintaining healthy habits such as adequate sleep and nutrition for academic achievement, it is essential to question whether these practices alone are sufficient in the diverse college landscape. Various scholars, like Bonny et al. (2014), suggest that while these lifestyle choices are significant, systemic factors—like institutional support and socioeconomic status—also play crucial roles in student success. Thus, readers should critically assess whether Furda's perspective might oversimplify the complexity of factors influencing a student's college experience.

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Chapter 45 Summary : D. Drop-off, Departure, and Check-in Points Thereafter

D. Drop-off, Departure, and Check-in Points Thereafter

This section primarily offers guidance for parents of college students residing on campus, but also addresses those whose children will commute from home. Parents should understand that their child's college schedule will differ significantly from high school, potentially impacting family routines. Students may need to study late or have irregular hours, making traditional family meals and responsibilities less feasible.

For parents preparing for a college drop-off, recognize the unique feelings surrounding separation and communication. Establish mutual expectations about how to stay in touch during this transition, considering modern communication methods that allow near-constant contact. However, it's essential for parents to set boundaries that encourage their child's independence.

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As a parent, you should check in frequently during the early days of your child's college life to notice any changes in their mood or anxiety levels. Set specific times for communication and be a supportive listener as your child navigates new decisions regarding classes and campus life. Events like family weekends can be valuable opportunities for deeper engagement, providing a chance to meet their friends and gain insight into their college experience.

Thanksgiving break is another time to reconnect. If your child comes home, be prepared for noticeable changes in their opinions, sleep patterns, and demeanor, and approach their newfound independence with calmness and understanding.

E. The (Potential) Transfer Conversation

[Content for this section not provided in the original text, thus unable to summarize.]

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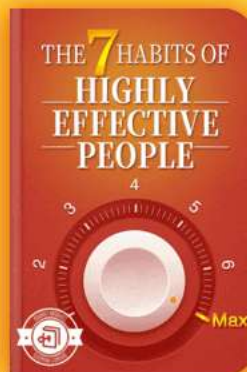
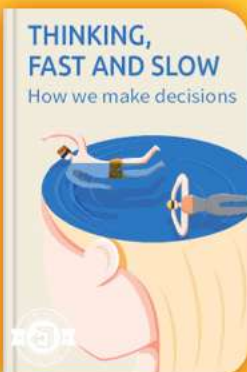


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Chapter 46 Summary : E. The (Potential) Transfer Conversation

E. The (Potential) Transfer Conversation

As students navigate their college experiences, some may express dissatisfaction with their choice, leading them to consider transferring to another institution. This section offers guidance for parents and guardians of students contemplating such a shift. It's crucial for parents to recognize that their child made the best decision possible at the time and may have enrolled in a college that wasn't their top choice.

Understanding the Reasons for Transfer

When discussing the potential transfer with your child, it's important to assess the underlying motivations for their feelings. Parents should ask questions that explore the reasons behind their child's discontent, acknowledging that their preferences and understanding of themselves may have evolved since their initial college choice. The conversation

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should draw upon the priorities established during the college selection process, including:

-

Environmental Factors

: Discuss whether the college's location, size, or type (rural vs. urban) aligns with their expectations.

-

Academic Concerns

: Assess if the academic environment is too competitive or disengaged and whether their academic interests have shifted.

-

Student Life

: Explore the quality of friendships, campus activities, and overall engagement, as well as any cultural concerns such as substance use.

-

X Factor

: Consider whether specific attributes that initially attracted them to the college have lost their appeal.

Timing and Action Plan

It's suggested that these discussions take place during winter break, allowing time for your child to return to campus with

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a proactive action plan. Many colleges have transfer application deadlines in the spring, leaving space for students to address concerns and seek support before considering a transfer. If issues persist despite efforts to engage with campus resources, parents may need to investigate options like leaves of absence or withdrawal, evaluating the implications for financial aid and other aspects.

Final Reflections on Transfer Decisions

For students who have actively explored their current institution yet still wish to transfer, parents should encourage them to reflect on whether they are running away from challenges or seeking new opportunities. This introspection can help guide their decision-making process. Engaging in familiar frameworks from the initial college decision-making can provide valuable insight as they contemplate their next steps.

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Chapter 47 Summary : Activity #13: Back to the Future: Revisiting Those I's and C's from Your Child's First Round of College Decision-Making

ACTIVITY #13: Back to the Future: Revisiting Those I's and C's from Your Child's First Round of College Decision-Making

This activity encourages parents and children to reflect on the college decision-making process by revisiting the "I's" (self-assessments) and "C's" (characteristics of colleges) previously established. Key points to consider include:

1.

Contextualizing Transfers

:

- About 40% of students do not graduate from their initial college, many transferring instead.

- A transfer is not a failure but an opportunity for growth, as noted by former transfer student Marie Bigham.

2.

Guidance for the Transfer Process

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:

- Children should approach this reflection with updated perspectives on what they desire in a college, informed by experiences and personal growth.

- They should assess changes in their priorities and values, both concerning themselves and their current institution.

3.

Creating a Concise College List

:

- The college search for transfers should be streamlined due to time limitations as full-time students.

- Resources from the previous college search process can still apply, alongside outreach to high school counselors and current students at prospective institutions.

4.

Understanding the Transfer Application

:

- Similarities to the high school application process exist, such as needing transcripts, teacher recommendations, and an essay explaining the transfer motivation.

- Reflecting on college courses and grades will be crucial for demonstrating capability and transferring credits.

5.

Deadlines and Decision Making

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:

- Transfers may face tighter deadlines and overlapping responses from multiple colleges.
- Important factors to evaluate are the transferability of credits and how they fit within general education or major requirements.

6.

Outcome Reflection

:

- After receiving responses, students may choose to transfer or remain at their current institution. Either decision should be viewed as valuable, providing insights for future academic engagement.

Through these activities and insights, families can engage in meaningful conversations about the college transfer process, emphasizing the importance of reflection and informed decision-making.

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Chapter 48 Summary : F. Another Potential Transfer Conversation: From Community College to a Traditional Four-Year College or University

Another Potential Transfer Conversation: From Community College to a Traditional Four-Year College or University

Community colleges serve as a valuable pathway to obtaining a bachelor's degree, with 55% of bachelor's degree graduates in the 2014–15 academic year having initially attended a two-year institution. Students can benefit from formal articulation agreements between community colleges and four-year universities, facilitating credit transfer and admission.

Key Considerations for Students and Parents

-

Planning Early

: Students should determine their academic goals early in

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their community college experience to ensure they are taking the right courses for future transfer.

-

Late Decisions

: Some students may decide to pursue a bachelor's degree after a pause in their studies. Researching transfer options becomes crucial.

Research Resources

- Parents and students should contact various resources such as high school counselors, community college transfer coordinators, and admissions offices at potential four-year institutions.

- Suggested resources include the book **Building Transfer Student Pathways for College and Career Success** and websites like the National Institute for the Study of Transfer Students and the Community College Research Center. By leveraging these resources, students can better navigate the transfer process from community college to a bachelor's degree program.

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Best Quotes from The College Conversation by Eric J. Furda with Page Numbers

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Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 58-72

- 1.The bachelor's degree is what the high school diploma used to be ten, twenty, thirty years ago.
- 2.More income doesn't necessarily mean more happiness," she writes. "Education can't buy us loving spouses and joyful lives.
- 3.A college education acts as a leveler, dramatically reducing the correlation between parents' income and the adult incomes of their children.
- 4.Community college is college.
- 5.The whole idea is to get job training or to go the transfer route.
- 6.Students who take a gap year are more likely to graduate than their peers, experience higher job satisfaction, and perform better in their first year at college.

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Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 75-80

1. Remind them that their card should reflect their ideas and acknowledge that the college experience is ultimately theirs, not yours.
2. The point of this exercise is to lay the groundwork for a mature conversation that may involve some discomfort but provide a beneficial amount of transparency.
3. Take note of each other's thinking—the goal at this early stage is simply to notice, to listen, and to begin to learn.
4. Reassure them that discomfort in such discussions is natural, and essential to growth, and that you are in this together.

Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 81-91

1. Parents have to listen to their kids,” said Monica Mendez, a pharmacy technician and the parent of two first-generation students.
2. You need to be able to listen without judgment.
3. It can be hurtful to just be shut down,” she told us. “Listen to me,”” she recalls saying to her mother. “This is

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something I'm passionate about.

4. You should also establish with your child parameters for what you and they will discuss about the admissions process outside of your own family.
5. What we don't want you to do is to practice avoidance of difficult or uncomfortable conversations.
6. As we all have learned, those photos have a permanent life on the internet, which can create additional anxieties down the road, as applications are submitted (or not) and decisions are rendered.
7. ...admissions is contingent on the applicant's maintaining their academic standing, as well as their standing within their communities.

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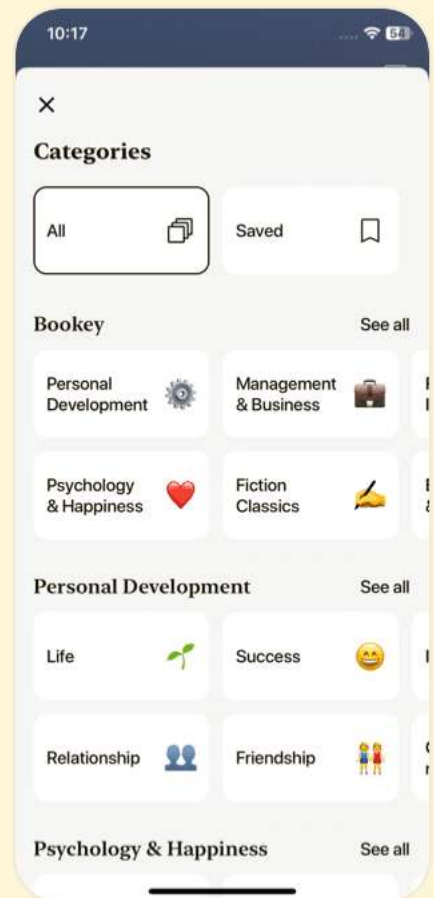
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Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 95-99

1. How do you see yourself, and how do others see you?
2. How do you approach the acquisition of knowledge?
3. What do you think about, and what are some of the opinions you hold most dear?
4. What do you like to do with your free time?
5. What really motivates and moves you, and whom do you admire?

Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 100-105

1. Their goal is to enroll a class of motivated students whom teachers can teach, who can support those professors in their research, and who can ultimately contribute to the social good of the university and the world at large.
2. Most colleges and universities, regardless of their selectivity, engage in the holistic admissions process: a comprehensive review of the college application to gain insight into the whole person, as opposed to narrowing

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candidates down to a single test score or grade point average.

3. Given these criteria, you can see the relevance and importance to an admissions office of your child's responses to the Five I's exercise, as ultimately translated and filtered through a college application.
4. The important point to bear in mind in the early stages of the college process is one of alignment—by which we mean alignment between a student's academic performance and the general profile of an admitted class at a particular university.
5. On the other hand, as we've seen, colleges and universities interpret test scores through complex lenses that may take into account factors other than the scores themselves.

Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 110-121

1. Every institution has a history, sometimes a history that is centuries old, and one of your child's assignments is to determine whether and how that original purpose is sustained through its

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mission today.

2. Both of us are proud recipients of a liberal arts and science education, which has at its core a belief in the virtue of learning for learning's sake and in the power of being trained to ask questions, to think, to write, and to be an active citizen.
3. Your child might consider their college years as a sequence of incremental steps and achievements that build on one another.
4. Equipped with the Four C's, we hope that you and your child are well positioned to take a more critical look at colleges and universities that may soon be potential candidates for your child's college list.

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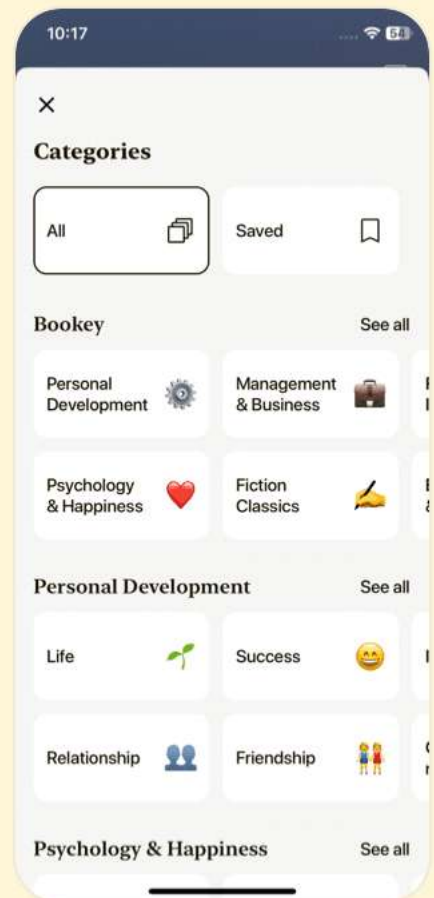
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Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 122-127

1. But for others, we want to make sure that you and your child consider keeping the door open to the possibility of at least including on your college list a few institutions that might be quite far away.
2. Let them do it. Because it opens up everything for them.
3. This is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity.
4. All we are preaching is a managing of expectations.

Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 128-138

1. Make it a point for you both to get to know the college counselor assigned to them and take advantage of every bit of knowledge, expertise, and experience that person has to offer.
2. Encouraging your child to participate in the equivalent of a full-run dress rehearsal... can be extremely helpful in preparing them for what to expect during the real event.
3. 'We just want to be here to inform you,' he stressed. 'And we need your support in this process.'
4. Local public libraries may have a trove of information

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related to the college process, including guidebooks and test-prep workbooks.

5. For first-generation parents in particular, the college counseling office can help connect you with yet another valuable resource: other first-generation parents.
6. No counselor, independent or school based, is in any position to guarantee your child admission to a particular institution...

Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 139-147

1. The cost of their higher education might be a shared responsibility.
2. If you have a plan, I think it's easier to talk about the tougher stuff with your child.
3. You don't want to burden them... but if they understand the degree to which the family has had to sacrifice... this might give them additional motivation.
4. One objective for this particular conversation is to introduce the broad range in sticker prices for four-year colleges.

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5.The overwhelming majority of colleges are in...

need-aware... because of limited resources.

6.The only thing you should care about is basically the

affordability component. And it's a privilege not to care about it.

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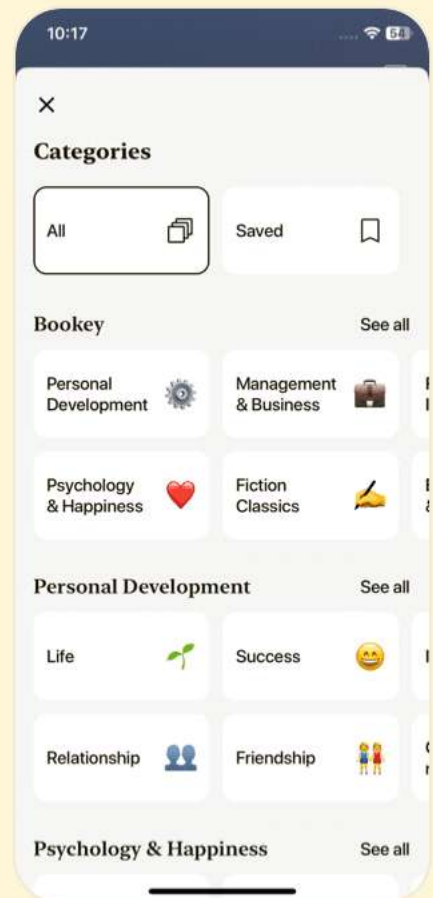
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Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 148-155

1. While some advisers counsel parents to take a backseat through much of this next stage of the college process, we believe it is a healthy time for collaboration.
2. The average number of applications submitted by each applicant through the Common Application portal is five, a number that has remained consistent over time.
3. To that end we recommend sorting the colleges on your child's list into three categories: sweet spot, likely, and aspirational.
4. For applicants, colleges in the sweet spot exhibit a harmony between admissions alignment and the attributes you're seeking in a college.
5. These schools may turn away upward of ninety-five of every one hundred applicants.
6. The qualitative parts—the person who your child is, the level of their community engagement, their life experience, what they value—all contribute to the decisions made by

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admissions officers.

7. We strongly caution against assembling a college list that is light on schools in the sweet spot, or likelies.

Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 156-159

1. This stage is meant to establish a framework for the next phase of research.
2. How does this school's community align with your interests and offer opportunities to widen your circle?
3. Are you inspired by the school's culture, including its founding mission and history, and do you consider those values to be relevant to you and resonant today?
4. In the case of that fifth C, cost, we remind you that each college has a net price calculator somewhere on its website.

Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 160-164

1. Students can get lost in a large-school environment.
2. We know that students with different cognitive traits can do well in college and succeed at work and life, often at very high levels of accomplishment.

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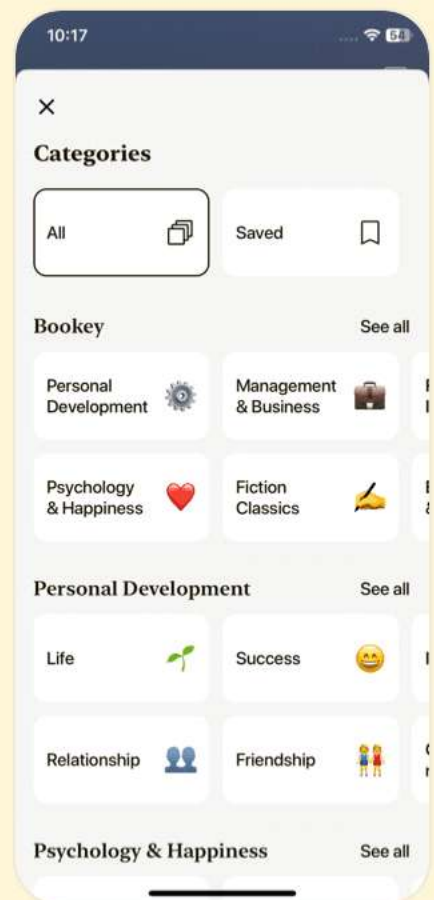
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Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 165-176

- 1.It depends,” but that happens to be true.
- 2.Bear in mind that ‘test optional’ schools still do report the range of scores submitted for the admitted class.
- 3....these preliminary standardized tests can identify areas of academic strength and weakness.
- 4.Whether to opt in is a personal decision, but you might use it as a moment to have a conversation with your child about their feelings (and yours, too) regarding privacy.
- 5.And thus for most students they are considered practice tests or a source of diagnostic information.
- 6.Some colleges and universities may temporarily suspend testing and other admission requirements in times of crisis.
- 7.Finally, research indicates that scores can level off or even decline with repeated sittings.
- 8.If you are weighing whether to support your child in seeking a testing accommodation, take a moment to ask yourself what larger lessons you might be teaching them.

Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 177-183

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1. Behind each of those statistics is a seventeen- or eighteen-year-old with a unique, nuanced story to tell.
2. What we're suggesting here is that your child reflect on how one of the Five I's—identity—might align with or connect to one of the C's—community—at a college or university they're considering.
3. One barometer is the number and percentage of students in a recently admitted class who qualify for the Federal Pell Grant, typically those whose annual family income is considered among the lowest in the nation.
4. A critical question is whether a family member's experience or history at a particular institution is reason enough to include it on a college list.
5. While it may be easier said than done, we encourage you to separate your own emotions... in favor of allowing your child the space to come to their own conclusions.

Chapter 15 | Quotes From Pages 184-187

1. Your child may have interests and talents that are

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the product of a deep-seated passion.

2. Your child can put to someone at the institution who has helpful perspective and insight to offer.
3. If you are the parent of an athlete, the process may be far more proscribed and governed by the rules of the National Collegiate Athletic Association (NCAA).
4. Some children who competed in a sport at the varsity level in high school may wish to continue their participation in college, though not with the same degree of commitment.
5. We also note that such interests may wane over time and become less of a priority not only during the search, but while attending college as well.

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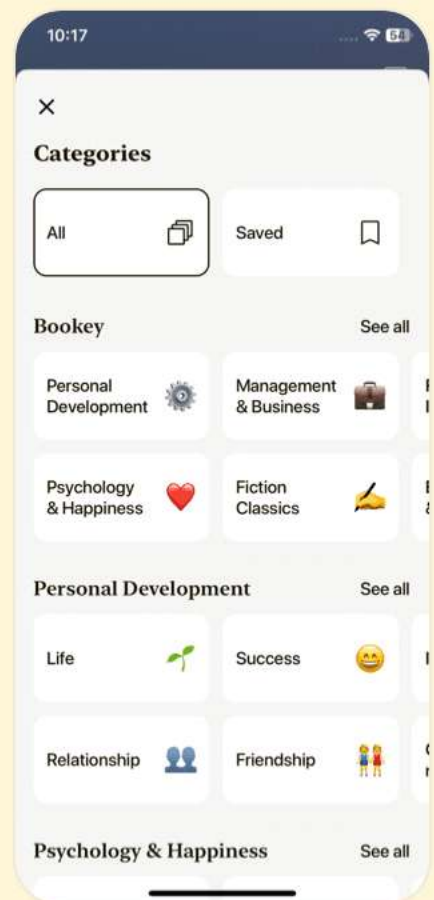
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Chapter 16 | Quotes From Pages 188-195

1. 'This is going to be your home for four years,' said Matthew Boyd, a High Tech High graduate, who decided to apply to the University of Richmond in Virginia after traveling across the country to visit it and discovering the appeal of its open spaces.
2. While we believe there is no substitute for the experience of actually visiting a particular campus to experience all those intangibles, time, distance, money, and life events outside your control can be limiting factors.
3. We recommend, if it is at all possible, that you and your child create a game plan or itinerary for college visits.
4. Chloe suggests that you and your child draw up an itinerary covering not only all your college visits, but the activities within each day, 'because kids, especially me, like to know what is going to happen next.'
5. Even if that school is not on your child's list, it might still be worth a visit as something of a dry run, provided it has at least some similarities to schools that may actually be on

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their list.

Chapter 17 | Quotes From Pages 196-208

1. At an appropriate point in the process, you find a way to do this activity together.
2. While there are no firm rules here, we do encourage you to consider whether you are planning a college visit too early in your child's development, with the risk of perhaps scaring or overwhelming them.
3. Ultimately, your child's comfort—not only in what they are wearing for an interview, but how they are feeling at that moment—is what is most important.
4. As you're packing for your trip, remember to take along the individual index cards, worksheets, or spreadsheets for each school.
5. As you and your child walk around campus, be mindful to observe your surroundings.
6. Keep your poker face, as best you can, and avoid trying to tip the scales with observations...

Chapter 18 | Quotes From Pages 211-215

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- 1.... eliminating an option is, in fact, making a decision.
2. There are no perfect choices here, although some may have more appeal than others.
3. This could be a broader teaching moment, in which you could impart to your child that eliminating an option is, in fact, making a decision.

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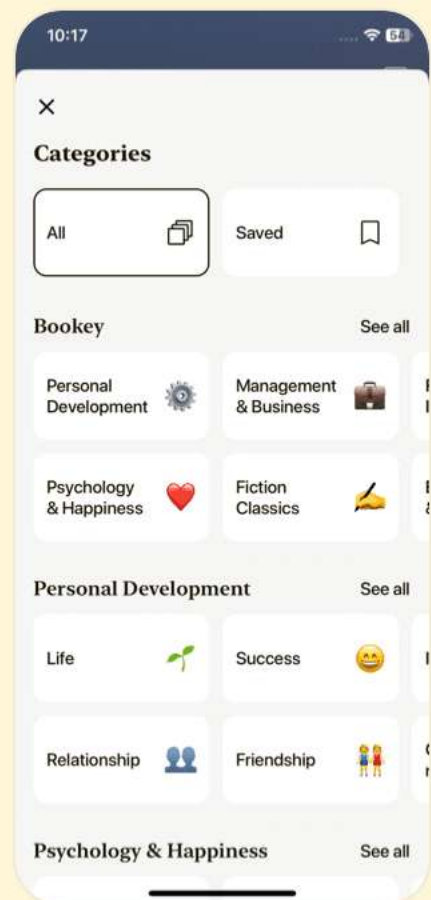
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Chapter 19 | Quotes From Pages 216-219

1. Unlike the soft deadline for a project that may have been established by a lenient high school teacher, your child should consider the deadlines that govern the college admissions process to be hard and fast.
2. For this activity we suggest you consider using an Excel spreadsheet, Google Doc, or a piece of graph paper, depending on how you have completed prior exercises.
3. They may also wish to include contact information for the admissions office.
4. Your child might even be able to expand or adapt the list they began in Activity #4 in the previous section of this book.
5. If at any stage your child created a login—such as when they registered for their college tour—they may wish to note the user name and password here, as they may be used in the application process as well.

Chapter 20 | Quotes From Pages 220-224

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1. Every one of its elements—family background; what their teachers say about them; what they have to say about themselves; the choices they have made, academic and extracurricular—is a storytelling opportunity for the applicant.
2. Think of the application as a mosaic, a work of art in which small pieces of various materials are arrayed to form a grander pattern or picture. The emerging figure is your child.
3. Make it clear that you are not going to write their college essays for them, nor is anyone else.
4. These conversations require planning and will yield dividends throughout your child's senior fall.
5. Your child needs to grant this permission, and even then, you can view their application on a read-only basis.

Chapter 21 | Quotes From Pages 225-245

1. While recognizing that counselor caseloads vary dramatically—from a few dozen to as many as a thousand—we nonetheless hope your child has

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proactively sought to give their counselor opportunities to get to know them.

2. What is powerful is the authenticity, care, and thoughtfulness that students have put into the application process.
3. Colleges and universities have very specific guidelines regarding their willingness to review submissions of recommendations beyond those of the counselor and two teachers.
4. If your child chooses for whatever reason not to report their scores to test-optional institutions, you might take solace in the thought that by establishing such a policy, those schools are sending a message about the relative value they place on test scores in assessing and predicting your child's ability to do well at their institutions.
5. Those little lines are not as powerful as parents might make them out to be.

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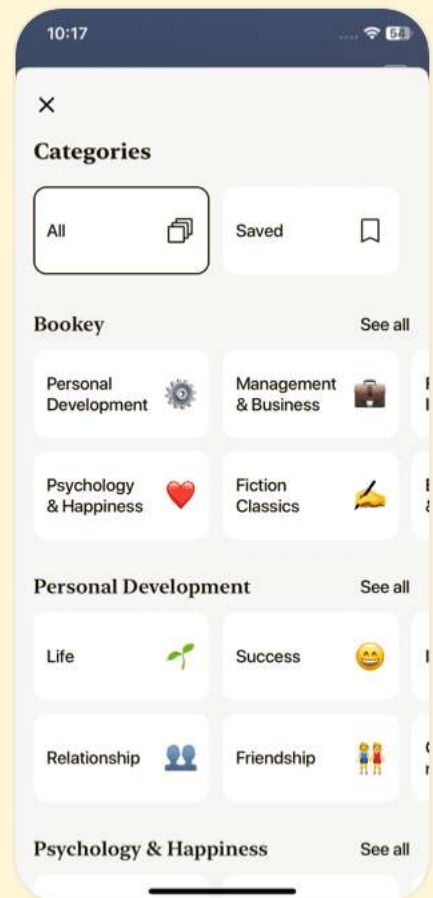
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Chapter 22 | Quotes From Pages 246-253

1. 'The goal here is not to create a formal résumé, but to instead begin to experiment with how to describe their experiences.'
2. 'By giving thought to those activities they wish to amplify, and in which order, your child has an opportunity to direct an admission's officer's eyes in ways that will make a strong first impression.'
3. 'Whatever information they might be tempted to include in a résumé can probably be more efficiently and effectively transmitted within the confines of the activity section of the application itself.'
4. 'If there is a need to provide additional information or commentary, this is the space to do so.'
5. 'Taking proactive ownership in this way, your child will also be able to provide background information and explain how they may have grown from that experience as well as what they might have learned from it.'

Chapter 23 | Quotes From Pages 254-257

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1. We turn now to the essay section of the college application, which represents a critical opportunity for your child to combine the pieces of their mosaic into a coherent picture.
2. The lessons we take from obstacles we encounter can be fundamental to later success.
3. Regardless of which option your child chooses, the thread that runs through all these prompts is a desire by the admissions committee to encourage them to reflect on their lives and experiences and how those moments have shaped who they have become and who they aspire to be.
4. It is also an opportunity for them to do so without a filter or intermediary—which is our not-so-subtle reminder to you to honor the guardrails and boundaries upon which you and your child agreed early on.

Chapter 24 | Quotes From Pages 258-274

1. What is important to you, whether in school or out, and why?
2. Each of these prompts requires a look backward, as well as

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inward.

3. Your child's college essay should not be a brag sheet, but it should serve as a vehicle for them to convey pride in their accomplishments and growth.
4. Sometimes one story or experience can stand alone in supporting your college essay, if explored with depth and sufficient reflection.
5. The point here is that human beings are multidimensional, and your college essay should try to capture that.
6. Ultimately, the essay your child writes needs to be a united whole, with a narrative or thematic line extending from the beginning through the body to the end.

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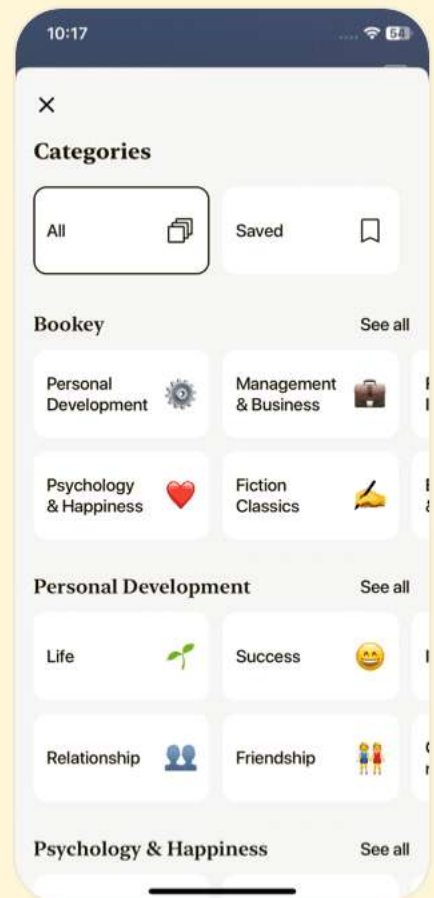
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Chapter 25 | Quotes From Pages 275-281

- 1.Colleges take that advance commitment seriously.
- 2.The opportunity to know, early in the calendar, that they have already secured an appealing option for where they might go to college.
- 3.All three signatories on the form also acknowledge: 'If you are accepted under an Early Decision plan, you must promptly withdraw the applications submitted to other colleges and universities.'
- 4.Your child should... be aware of the deadlines for submitting a deposit, for the purpose of holding a place, at every institution to which they are admitted, as those dates may now vary.

Chapter 26 | Quotes From Pages 282-285

- 1.For example, if your child is contemplating making a binding commitment to an institution up front, there should be strong alignment between their initial index card (characteristics of the college environment they are seeking), along with

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their I's (including their reflections on their identity) and C's (that institution's culture and community).

2. This juncture in the process is so critical that you should be sure to draw upon all the guidance available.
3. They can't apply early, for example, if they haven't taken the necessary standardized tests for those schools that require them.
4. A Preflight Checklist for Those Considering Flying Early

Chapter 27 | Quotes From Pages 286-296

1. If you and your child haven't already had this conversation, this may be one of the final opportunities to do so.
2. But we caution that you, like the colleges, should enter into such an agreement in good faith.
3. Don't let strategy supersede a thoughtful and reflective discovery and search process.
4. For those who are interested in receiving an early signal—without the pressure of an immediate

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commitment—single choice or restrictive early action, if offered at a school of interest, could be an appropriate path.

5.If that answer is yes, then your child may be ready to push 'submit.'

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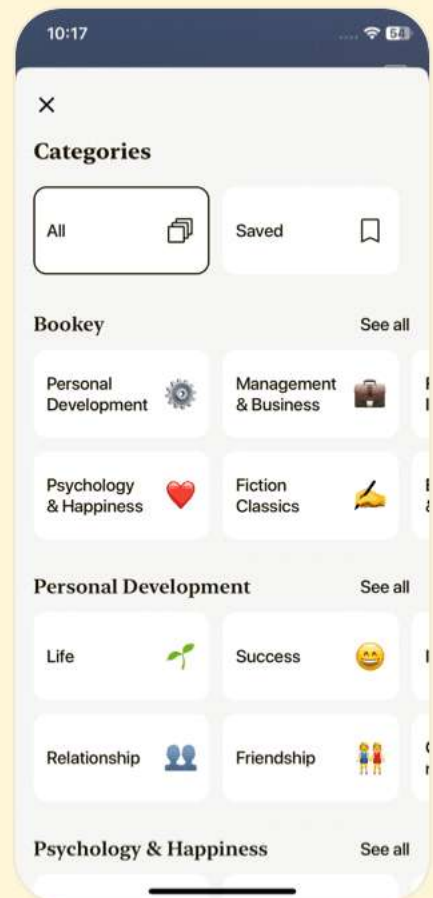
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Chapter 28 | Quotes From Pages 297-307

1. Even families that feel certain they will not qualify for need-based aid should still seriously consider filling out the FAFSA.
2. Once they've enrolled, they may even recall these conversations as they weigh whether to get out of bed for that early morning class—not with a sense of guilt about your financial sacrifice (and theirs, too), but with a sense of ownership.
3. Some institutions may also use the forms as part of the process for determining merit aid, which will be directly related to your child's academic or other achievements and talents.
4. For those parents who may not have filed taxes—and there are any number of reasons why that may be the case—you could still file your FAFSA, though it may be subject to enhanced verification.
5. Your child may also wish to explore whether outside scholarships are available from your employer or a union;

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from national talent search competitions, such as those administered by the Gates and Jack Kent Cooke foundations.

Chapter 29 | Quotes From Pages 308-313

- 1.If your child will allow you to play such a role, you might offer yourself up as something of an executive coach—not to plan this frenetic period of their lives, but to help them create some interim deadlines and milestones throughout the concluding stretch.
- 2.Encourage them to put those dates on the calendar and in the college application requirement and deadline tracker from Activity #6.
- 3.As you both populate and revise their fall calendar, your child could assemble a final checklist that is similar to the one we suggested earlier in this section for submitting early applications.
- 4.A cup of coffee with friends, a movie, a nap, or time to just do nothing can be rejuvenating.

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Chapter 30 | Quotes From Pages 314-317

1. Your job is to be supportive and reassuring and to help them begin to let go and to move on with their lives.
2. Waiting is hard, particularly for this digital generation, and you may need to assist them with strategies for shifting gears.
3. For the first time in a long time, they can take control of their own calendars, with the intention of reconnecting with those things that give them joy.
4. Now can be the time to reorient and focus on other priorities.
5. But the last of your child's college applications going out the door is most certainly a milestone. And it is a milestone that we hope you, as a parent, will acknowledge and celebrate.

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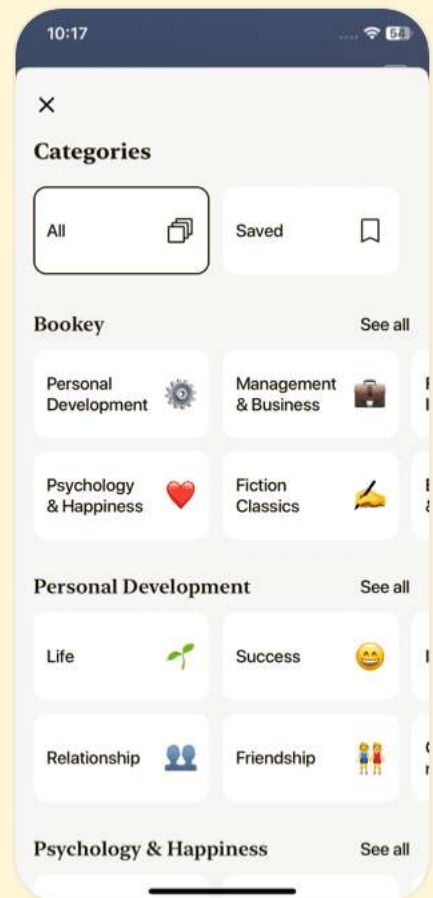
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Chapter 31 | Quotes From Pages 320-336

- 1....the responsibility for decision-making shifts to the admissions committees of the schools to which they have applied.
- 2.the American college admissions process may be maddening—and even inscrutable—to many because of its lack of predictability... it does provide students and families with a degree of flexibility and choice that would be inconceivable in other parts of the world.
- 3.an admissions officer's job is not merely to ensure there is a critical mass of students interested in a particular department or major... Just as your child sized up potential colleges and universities... admissions officers also consider how an applicant will participate in, and ultimately lead, those activities on their campuses.
- 4.Would it be based exclusively on standardized test scores?... the performance on such tests correlate, at least in part, to their parents' level of education... admissions officers attempt to look at an applicant within the context



of the environment in which they grew up.

5.to facilitate a national, evidence-based dialogue... to critically analyze systemic pathways and barriers in college admissions, particularly for students of color and low-income students.

6.a series of cases, including those challenging affirmative action, were making their way through various levels of the U.S. judicial system.

7.it is the admissions office's turn to push 'submit'—typically throughout March and into early April.

Chapter 32 | Quotes From Pages 337-351

1.If you're the parent of a high school senior, April is likely to be a hectic month.

2.Those of you who received your own college decisions via the U.S. mail...will recall that those envelopes may have landed in your mailbox sporadically.

3.Bring that perspective to help your child process whatever results they receive.

4.Celebrate with dignity.

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5.This process is not predictable, and it should never be viewed as a report card on your parenting or your child's self-worth.

Chapter 33 | Quotes From Pages 352-355

- 1.Within a few days of your child's having received the last of their admission decisions, they will want to begin the process of taking stock of where they stand, as well as establishing the criteria for how they will make a final decision.
- 2.All the materials that they, with your help, have prepared through the activities in this book are worth gathering and re-examining now.
- 3.One goal of this exercise is to guard against snap decisions, which may be based on any number of human emotions, including an understandable desire just to be done.
- 4.While your child doesn't have a lot of time, they likely have the better part of a month for their deliberations, and we want to encourage you to encourage them to use that time wisely.

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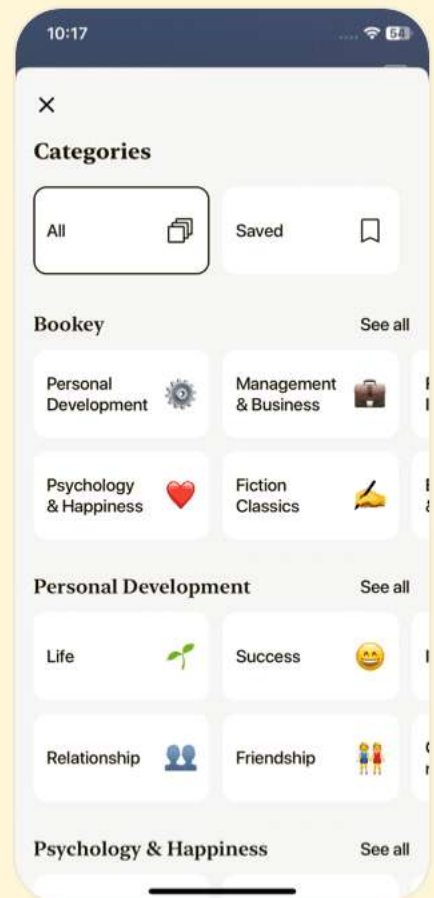
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Chapter 34 | Quotes From Pages 356-359

1. While we are labeling this an activity, it is actually more of a meditation or moment for reflection.
2. Six to nine months in the life of a teenager can be a period of intense growth, introspection, and change.
- 3....so much so that what they valued earlier in the process may not necessarily be the case now.
4. What about the availability of support services, such as tutoring, counseling, or proximity to specialized medical care?
5. Is doing nonprofit work a priority, particularly work that would enable you to feel like a member of the community of which the college is a part, as opposed to feeling like a mere tenant or visitor?

Chapter 35 | Quotes From Pages 360-367

1. This should be a free-flowing exercise, almost meditative, and consist of just words or phrases.
2. Be on the lookout for any clues and cues from your child, not only in what they're saying but how they're behaving.

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3. Embrace the college experience as one of growth, and assure them that a certain amount of anxiety is natural.
4. Reassure your child that they do have time—in all likelihood the better part of a month—to make a final decision.
5. Use this opportunity to engage in your own thoughtful, deliberative decision-making, and share with them the value of taking a break and having some separation and distance from the decision at hand.

Chapter 36 | Quotes From Pages 368-379

1. You've hit the lottery," is what he tells anxious parents to reassure them.
2. I would just say you have to trust in your kid," she said. "I mean, they love you. You love them. And if something happens, there's always a way to communicate.
3. Ask yourself whether you are open to their doing so, and to the extent you have concerns whether they can be addressed.
4. Potential enrollees should allow themselves the time to



look around, and to do so with an open mind and a critical eye.

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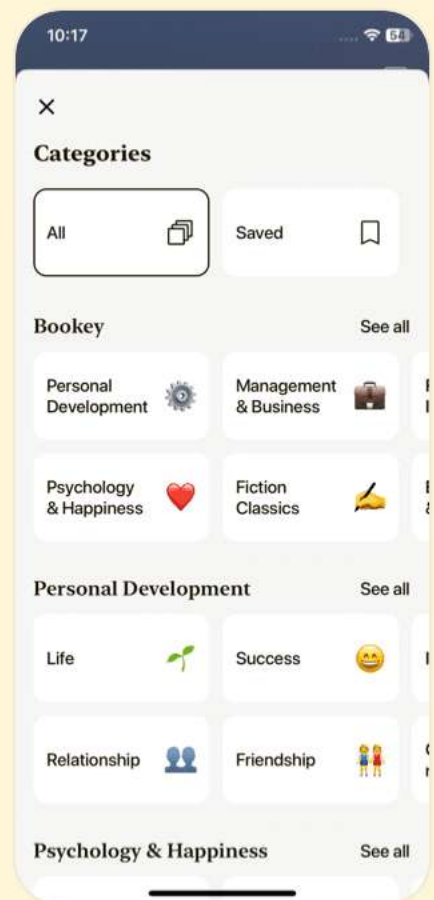
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Chapter 37 | Quotes From Pages 380-386

- 1.Keep on calling,’’ she recommended. “It really makes it more personal and makes someone really want to help you.
- 2.It’s like kickboxing, but with knees and elbows,’’ Ariana explained, laughing as she asserted that it made her feel prepared for anything that college might throw at her.
- 3.You should feel comfortable calling a financial aid office to seek clarification or to appeal an award you feel is insufficient... it is also an opportunity to make another point of contact on campus—specifically, an adult who can become part of your child’s support network for the next four years.
- 4.But be aware of the fact that the people in financial aid offices are there to help you, to the extent that they can do so under their policies, guidelines, and available resources.

Chapter 38 | Quotes From Pages 387-389

- 1.‘After securing a spot on a waiting list, your child will find themselves in a holding pattern while still

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needing to move forward with other choices.’

2. ‘...your child should feel confident that whatever reports they provide will be uploaded directly to their application.’
3. ‘...they should be sure to convey the level of their ongoing interest, as the college will factor into its decision-making whether your child is likely to attend if offered a seat in the class.’
4. ‘...if in the coming weeks they do come off a waiting list and wish to attend that institution, they can inform the previous institution that they no longer wish to attend...’

Chapter 39 | Quotes From Pages 390-392

1. A growing body of research indicates that students who take a gap year have higher rates of advancing from the first to second year of college, as well as progressing to graduation.
2. In many instances your child can use the same FAFSA form that they completed for college financial aid as a means to be considered for aid to take a gap year.

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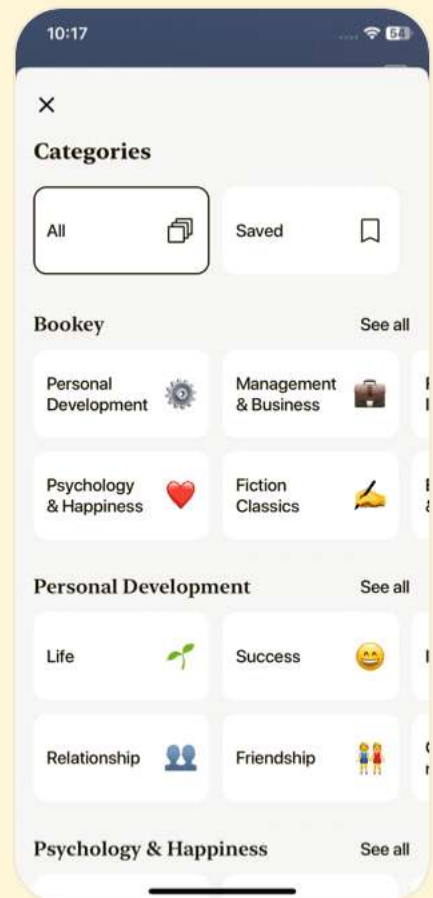
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Chapter 40 | Quotes From Pages 396-403

1. Each institution themselves should be viewed as distinct academic journeys that your child might take, effectively creating an academic road map.
2. The goal here is that their shadings in particular categories will make it easier for your child to weigh their options—and to ultimately decide which variables in a college they value over others, and which become determinative in their decision.
3. Encourage them to pause, and explain to them that high stress or anxiety can be an impediment to clear decision-making.
4. If there is another parent, partner, or spouse involved in this final decision, be conscious of the potential effect that their opinion may have on your child's decision—and whether those views conflict with, or are consistent with, your child's and your own.
5. Block out a cushion period in which they can make that decision and let it sit for a while before they press the

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Chapter 41 | Quotes From Pages 404-407

1. Even in our fast-paced, let-it-all-rip-online world—or perhaps as an antidote to it—your child might want to let that decision be their own, if even for just a short period of time.
2. It is important to let your child know that such emotions are normal.
3. There are no perfect decisions, and that they made the best choice possible given the information at hand and the time allowed.
4. You will want to ask them some pointed, even probing, questions.
5. They will bear responsibility for embracing the opportunities that await them, and to prepare over the coming months to make the most of that experience.

Chapter 42 | Quotes From Pages 454-457

1. But you need to not only help them keep their focus during these final weeks of high school but

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also encourage them to engage in a series of culminating academic, extracurricular, and community experiences, with the hope, of course, that these events come off as planned.

2. You may or may not be aware that when your child committed to enroll at the college they will attend, they likely signed an agreement in which they acknowledged that their admission was contingent upon certain expectations being met during the balance of their senior year.
3. The admissions office seeks this supplemental information to gain insight into what may be happening below the surface—such as a family emergency—and to make sure your child is in the best position to succeed.

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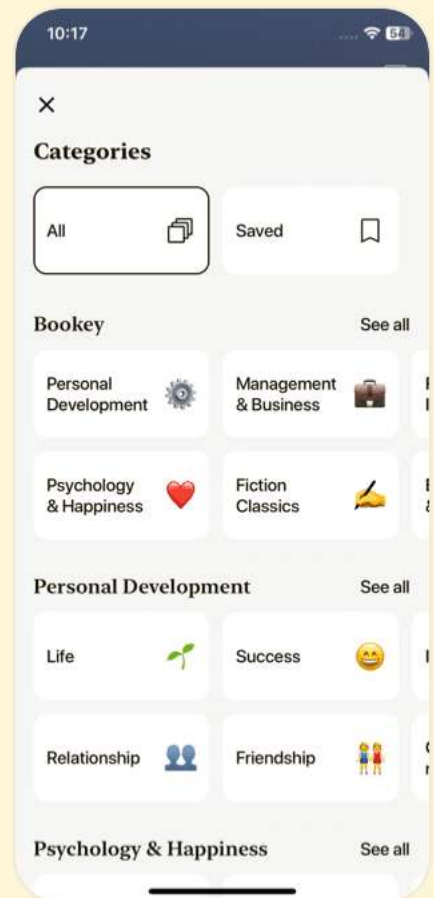
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Chapter 43 | Quotes From Pages 458-468

1. Your child is going to need your support.
2. Familiarize themselves with the college's health and wellness and other support services.
3. In assembling our description of such a list on the following pages, we were informed by, among other sources, a framework known as the Penn10...
4. Revisit—and likely revise—the ground rules and boundaries you established with your child early in the College Conversation.
5. There will be no shortage of emotions associated with this transition process—for your child as well as for you.

Chapter 44 | Quotes From Pages 469-483

1. Studies have shown that students who succeed in advancing from the first to second year of college are more likely to go on to complete their education and earn a degree.
2. By engaging with their teachers in academic settings outside of class, students also reported feeling that they

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were being taught by an individual who 'cares about me as a person.'

3. Encourage your child to get involved in something with the modest objective of becoming engaged in an outside pursuit to counterbalance what may be a fairly intense academic experience.
4. Students who pay attention to their sleep (seven to nine hours most nights) as well as eating a balanced diet and exercising tend to not only be successful in college but also lead healthier lifestyles.
5. Assure them that by doing so, they will grow—a message that they may well greet with skepticism.

Chapter 45 | Quotes From Pages 484-490

1. Understand that they may need to be in the library until ten at night to finish a paper, or are sleeping in because their first class is not until noon.
2. Our strong advice is that you each give thought to how—and how often—you want to be in touch during this time of transition.

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3. Your most valuable contribution might be simply to listen, at least initially, and to reassure them that they are capable of making decisions like these on their own.
4. But if you can do so, events like these can provide a follow-up to the orientation that you and your child may have participated in earlier in the semester.
5. Thanksgiving break can also be a moment to touch base—again, depending on distance and resources, since it may not be possible for your child to come home then.

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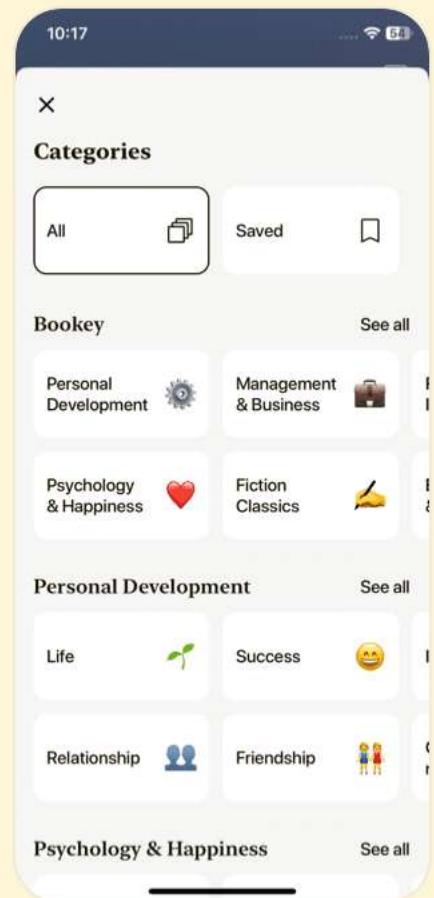
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Chapter 46 | Quotes From Pages 491-497

1. But the fact remains that they—supported by you—made the best decision they could, with the information and options available to them at the time.
2. Children change over the eight months or more since they made their college decision.
3. One option, of course, is to have them return to campus for the next term with an action plan.
4. If that is the case, then you may need to take the lead in researching the options that are available.
5. Consider guiding them through a framework that may seem familiar to you both, but with the greater awareness you now have than you did at the outset of the College Conversation.

Chapter 47 | Quotes From Pages 498-506

1. Transfer is not failure.
2. What do I know now that I didn't know a year or so ago?
3. As I contemplate a change, what is it that I am really

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looking for and what am I trying to fix?

4.The transfer application process was hardly a waste of time, but that it instead yielded information and insight that served to provide new context for their future work at their current college.

Chapter 48 | Quotes From Pages 507-510

- 1.Many of those students were enrolled at two-year schools... that had formal articulation agreements with four-year schools, providing a dedicated pathway not only for admission but the transfer of credits.
- 2.If you are the parent of a child with community college credits considering a transfer application... you and they will have to do some research, as the necessary information may not exist in a one-stop-shop place or format.
- 3.We also recommend the book Building Transfer Student Pathways for College and Career Success (2018)... along with the website of the National Institute for the Study of Transfer Students.

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4....the Community College Research Center, housed at Teachers College at Columbia University. It, too, is designed for an audience of teachers, administrators, and counselors but also has helpful links for students, including to additional sources.

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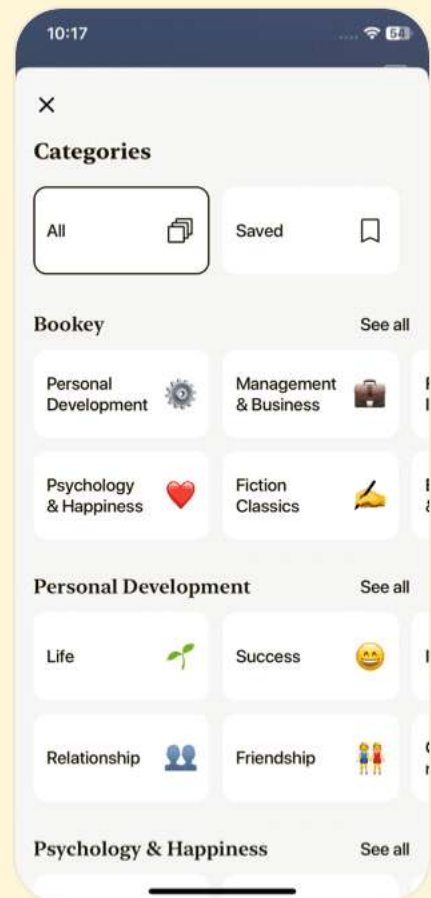
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The College Conversation Questions

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Chapter 1 | A. The “Why College?” Conversation| Q&A

1.Question

What are the fundamental questions parents should ask themselves and their children regarding college education?

Answer:1. Is my child emotionally ready for the transition to a four-year college experience? 2. Can we afford the cost of a bachelor’s degree, considering various tuition options? 3. What is the main goal of attending college for my child – is it to gain knowledge, build networks, prepare for a career, or pursue graduate school?

2.Question

How does a bachelor’s degree impact lifetime earnings compared to other education levels?

Answer:Individuals with at least a bachelor’s degree earn roughly \$2.4 million over their lifetime, about \$1 million

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more than those with only a high school diploma and \$600,000 more than those with an associate's degree.

3.Question

Why is pursuing a bachelor's degree considered valuable beyond just financial returns?

Answer: Beyond financial gains, a bachelor's degree fosters critical thinking, effective communication, and the ability to contribute positively to society. It can also provide social mobility opportunities, particularly for those from low-income backgrounds.

4.Question

What are some alternatives to starting a higher education journey at a four-year college?

Answer: Starting at a community college is a more economical option, with lower tuition costs. There are also dual enrollment programs, online courses (MOOCs), and vocational training programs that align with student interests and career goals.

5.Question

What role does community college play in a student's

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education pathway?

Answer:Community college can serve as a stepping stone for students who may not yet be ready for a four-year institution, offering lower costs, local flexibility, and the opportunity to earn an associate's degree that can often transfer to a bachelor's program.

6.Question

What are the advantages of military service for students interested in higher education?

Answer:Military service can facilitate college education via programs like the Post-9/11 GI Bill, which offers financial support, and ROTC programs that help cover tuition costs while training students for officer roles in the military.

7.Question

What is the significance of the UnCollege movement?

Answer:The UnCollege movement advocates for self-directed learning and alternatives to traditional college paths, emphasizing skill acquisition and real-world experiences. It also illustrates the growing recognition of the

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value of college education amidst new educational philosophies.

8.Question

How can parents evaluate whether a bachelor's degree is necessary for their child's career goals?

Answer:Parents should consider their child's career aspirations and whether these goals require a bachelor's degree or if alternative education paths, such as vocational training or an associate's degree, would be more appropriate.

9.Question

What are the emotional factors influencing a student's decision to pursue a community college instead of a four-year institution?

Answer:Students may feel more prepared for community college due to its less intense environment, the ability to remain close to home, and a chance to mature academically without the pressures of a four-year commitment.

10.Question

What does research say about the completion rates of students who begin at community colleges?

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Answer: Research indicates that only 13% of community college students earn a bachelor's degree within six years, highlighting the importance of having a purposeful educational plan if a student starts at a community college.

Chapter 2 | Activity #1: Jotting Down a Few Key Attributes on an Index Card| Q&A

1.Question

What is the purpose of the index card exercise for parents and their child?

Answer: The purpose is to encourage introspection about the attributes of a college experience that would best suit the child, while also opening a pathway for dialogue between parents and their child about their visions for higher education.

2.Question

How can parents ensure the college environment reflects their child's interests?

Answer: Parents should promote open-mindedness and independence by encouraging their child to jot down personal preferences regarding subjects, campus settings, and

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extracurricular activities without pressing them towards specific schools or choices.

3.Question

What should parents do if their child is resistant to participating in the exercise?

Answer:Parents can still engage in the exercise independently or with another adult to gain insights into their own preferences and concerns, with the hope that their child will become more open to discussing the topic in the future.

4.Question

What are some intangible attributes to consider when discussing college?

Answer:Intangible attributes to consider include the energy level of the campus, the size of the institution, and the overall atmosphere—whether the child would thrive in a lively environment or a more subdued setting.

5.Question

Why is it important for parents to identify areas of agreement and disagreement with their child?

Answer:Identifying areas of agreement can build a

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foundation for teamwork, while recognizing disagreements fosters communication and understanding, allowing both parties to express their views and concerns without seeking immediate solutions.

6.Question

How should parents approach topics that may trigger strong emotions during these discussions?

Answer:Parents should be sensitive to their child's body language and emotional responses, offering reassurance that discomfort in these discussions is a natural part of growth and a collaborative journey.

7.Question

What is the significance of keeping the index cards close by after the exercise?

Answer:Keeping the index cards serves as a reference point to revisit thoughts and feelings as the college conversation evolves, marking the development of ideas and concerns throughout the college planning process.

8.Question

How does the timing of the exercise matter based on the

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child's high school year?

Answer:For younger students, a broader and more flexible brainstorming approach is suitable, while seniors require more focused and precise discussions due to the urgency of the admissions timeline.

9.Question

What role do parents play in creating an open dialogue about college aspirations?

Answer:Parents should facilitate a safe space for conversation, actively listen, and observe their child's responses, ensuring the dialogue remains supportive and collaborative without imposing their preferences.

10.Question

What should the focus be on during the initial stages of college discussions?

Answer:The focus should be on noticing and listening to each other's perspectives, acknowledging the complexities of the conversation rather than attempting to resolve disagreements immediately.

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Chapter 3 | C. Rules of the Road: Establishing Guardrails for Your Role as a Parent| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of establishing guardrails when talking about the college process with my child?

Answer:Setting up guardrails ensures that conversations about college remain constructive and respectful. It helps both parents and children to navigate this emotionally charged topic by defining how, when, and where to talk about college, allowing for a calmer and more focused discussion.

2.Question

How can parents balance their involvement in their child's college process without becoming overbearing?

Answer:Parents should discuss openly with their children about the level of support needed, recognizing when to step in and when to let their child make independent decisions. This collaborative approach fosters trust and encourages autonomy.

3.Question

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Why is it important for parents to truly listen to their child during the college conversation?

Answer: Listening allows parents to understand their child's feelings, preferences, and concerns, fostering an open dialogue that respects the child's passions and perspectives. As highlighted, children may feel hurt if they're dismissed, so active listening builds empathy and connection.

4.Question

What are some effective times or settings to discuss college-related topics with my child?

Answer: Consider family dinners, casual walks, or late-night conversations where everyone feels comfortable. The goal is to create a relaxed atmosphere where your child can express thoughts freely.

5.Question

How can parents manage differing opinions regarding the college process?

Answer: It's crucial to discuss and determine how to present diverse viewpoints to the child. A unified front, with some

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flexibility, fosters a supportive environment. Writing down these agreements can serve as a reference to manage disagreements constructively.

6.Question

What should parents be wary of in regards to online sharing during the college process?

Answer:Parents should caution their child against oversharing on social media about the college search, as posts can have lasting implications. Colleges review applicants' online footprints, and inappropriate content could jeopardize admission offers.

7.Question

What role do the established rules of engagement play in the college conversation?

Answer:Rules of engagement help clarify expectations and boundaries during discussions about college, ensuring a smooth dialogue and reducing potential conflicts. They act as a framework for parents and children to manage this complex topic.

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8.Question

How can parents help their child navigate anxieties regarding college admissions?

Answer:Parents should encourage open conversations about fears and concerns related to college. Seeking advice from other parents or professionals can also provide support and help parents process their own anxieties.

9.Question

Why is it essential to consider siblings in the college conversation?

Answer:Being mindful of the presence and involvement of siblings is important, as it helps maintain a supportive family dynamic. Ensuring that siblings are included or excluded based on the situation can promote understanding and reduce jealousy.

10.Question

What is a critical takeaway regarding the college admissions process shared in this chapter?

Answer:Parents must recognize that their participation should be supportive rather than controlling. Each family's

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approach to discussions should be tailored to their unique dynamics to foster a successful college application experience.

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Beautiful App



This app is a lifesaver for book lovers with
busy schedules. The summaries are spot
on, and the mind maps help reinforce wh
I've learned. Highly recommend!

Alex Walk

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Chapter 4 | Activity #2: The Five I's| Q&A

1.Question

What does 'identity' mean in the context of this activity?

Answer:Identity refers to how an individual perceives themselves and how they believe others perceive them. It encompasses both self-image and the external perceptions of one's character and values.

2.Question

Why is it important for a student to reflect on their 'intellect'?

Answer:Reflecting on one's intellect helps students understand their learning styles and approaches to acquiring knowledge. Recognizing how they engage with challenging material informs their academic identity and can aid in selecting teachers who will best highlight their strengths in applications.

3.Question

What kinds of 'ideas' should a student consider according to this exercise?

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Answer: Students should think about their core beliefs, values, and opinions on various topics that matter to them. This could include social issues, personal philosophies, and topics they feel passionate about, which can help shape their narrative in college applications.

4.Question

How do 'interests' play a role in shaping a student's profile?

Answer: Interests highlight what students enjoy doing in their free time, showcasing their personality and potential extracurricular contributions to a college community. This aspect can demonstrate their engagement and commitment beyond academics.

5.Question

What is the significance of reflecting on 'inspiration' in this activity?

Answer: Understanding what inspires a student—be it a person, a cause, or a personal experience—can provide deep insight into their passions and motivations. It helps to build a

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compelling personal story that resonates with college admissions committees.

6.Question

How can the reflections on the Five I's assist in the college application process?

Answer:The reflections will inform the selection of teacher recommendations, guiding which strengths to highlight in applications. It also aids in crafting a personal narrative that resonates during interviews and admissions essays, making the application stand out.

7.Question

Why should students view this exercise as a 'living document'?

Answer:Viewing it as a living document encourages continuous self-reflection and growth. It allows students to update their thoughts as they evolve over time, ensuring that their applications reflect their most current selves.

8.Question

What approach should parents take when guiding their children through this exercise?

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Answer: Parents should be facilitators, encouraging open and honest dialogue without imposing their own expectations. It's important to create a relaxed atmosphere where children feel comfortable sharing their thoughts.

9.Question

How can insights from this activity be used later in the college application process?

Answer: Insights gained can enhance recommendation letters, support essays, and provide meaningful talking points for interviews. They serve as foundational knowledge about the student's unique characteristics and journey.

10.Question

What is the overall goal of the Five I's activity?

Answer: The overall goal is to foster self-discovery and self-awareness in students, enabling them to articulate their identity, passions, and intellectual engagement as they prepare for college.

**Chapter 5 | E. Behind the Admissions Office Door:
A Brief Primer on the Holistic Admissions Process
(And the Ultimate Audience for Your Child's**

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Application)| Q&A

1.Question

What is the ultimate goal of admissions officers in the holistic admissions process?

Answer:The ultimate goal of admissions officers is to identify and assemble a group of motivated students who will learn from the institution and from one another, contributing to the university and society at large.

2.Question

How does a holistic approach to admissions differ from traditional assessments of candidates?

Answer:A holistic approach evaluates the entire individual, considering academic performance, extracurricular activities, leadership roles, and personal backgrounds, rather than focusing solely on test scores or GPAs.

3.Question

What factors are considered by admissions offices when evaluating a student?

Answer:Admissions offices consider a student's identity as a

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learner, their participation in activities, their leadership skills, and their perspectives shaped by personal experiences and circumstances.

4.Question

What advice is given to parents regarding data sources for understanding college selectivity?

Answer:Parents are advised to consult data sources like U.S. News & World Report rankings and the Common Data Set, but to exercise caution regarding simplistic comparisons and focus instead on the underlying raw data.

5.Question

Why is it important for students to be aware of the selectivity data when creating a college list?

Answer:Students should be aware of selectivity data to ensure their test scores and academic profiles align with the institutions they are considering, helping them set realistic expectations and choices.

6.Question

What does the Common Data Set provide that is useful for evaluating colleges?

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Answer: The Common Data Set provides a clear, universal pool of data including the range of test scores and GPA of admitted students, helping families understand the competitive landscape of admissions.

7.Question

How should students and parents interpret selectivity data when considering college applications?

Answer: They should not draw hard lines based on selectivity data alone but rather use it as a guide to understand the admissions landscape while recognizing the complexity of how colleges assess applicants.

Chapter 6 | Activity #3: The Four C's| Q&A

1.Question

What are the Four C's and how can they help in evaluating colleges?

Answer: The Four C's stand for Culture, Curriculum, Community, and Conclusions. They serve as a framework for parents and students to assess colleges by examining the institution's history

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and mission (Culture), the design and depth of courses offered (Curriculum), the people and physical spaces on campus (Community), and the outcomes such as graduate readiness and career opportunities (Conclusions). This structured approach allows families to tailor their college search to fit their child's specific preferences and aspirations.

2.Question

How can one determine the culture of a college campus?

Answer: To gauge a college's culture, students should investigate its history and current mission. This can involve examining how the institution honors its founders and how its original purpose translates into today's educational practices. Additionally, students can use journalistic techniques, such as reading student publications and conducting informal interviews with current students and alumni, to gain insights into campus spirit, social dynamics, acceptance levels, and overall student life.

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3.Question

What should students consider when exploring curriculum options at colleges?

Answer:Students should ask what they will learn and how that learning prepares them for future careers. It's helpful to envision their college education as comprising general courses, electives, and a major. They should explore department websites to understand course offerings and look for worksheets that help map out their academic journey. Attending classes as prospective students can also provide a practical view of the curriculum.

4.Question

Why is community important in the college experience and how can it be assessed?

Answer:Community encompasses the relationships and interactions among students, faculty, and staff, as well as the physical spaces where these interactions take place. To assess it, students should consider the campus layout, shared spaces, and resources tailored for diverse groups. Engaging with

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current students in various settings, like dining halls or lounges, can provide a real sense of the campus community.

5.Question

What are the key outcomes to consider regarding conclusions about a college?

Answer:Prospective students should consider factors such as retention rates (students moving from their first to second year), graduation rates, and the types of careers pursued by alumni. They can look up statistics on the college's website and inquire about the support services available to help students succeed academically and prepare for the job market or graduate school.

6.Question

How does the concept of 'fit' play into the college selection process?

Answer:Fit relates to how well a college meets the values, needs, and aspirations of a student. It encompasses both academic and social aspects. While it is emphasized that fit may not be perfect, finding a college that resonates with a

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student's goals and allows them to thrive is crucial for a fulfilling college experience. Families should discuss how different colleges align with their child's identity and future ambitions.

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Chapter 7 | B. A Word About Fit (And Please Note: It Won't Be Perfect)| Q&A

1.Question

What is the main insight about finding a college fit according to Eric J. Furda?

Answer: Finding a college fit is about acknowledging that no institution will be perfect; it involves making informed choices based on what's most important to you and your child and managing expectations.

2.Question

How does the analogy of buying or renting a first home relate to choosing a college?

Answer: Just like when choosing a home, one must prioritize certain attributes or qualities over others while accepting that every option will have its compromises. It emphasizes the importance of ranking needs such as size, location, and community.

3.Question

What emotional challenges might parents face when their child considers attending college far away?

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Answer:Parents may feel fear of the unknown, concern for their child's safety, anxiety about losing control, and worry about economic impacts like potential costs of transportation and accommodation.

4.Question

What advice does college counselor Chris White give to parents of first-generation college students?

Answer:Chris advises parents to recognize and manage their own fears that may limit their children's opportunities, especially by considering colleges that seem far away but may offer better financial aid options.

5.Question

What transformation did Monica Mendez undergo regarding her daughter's college choice, and what advice does she have for other parents?

Answer:Monica Mendez initially resisted the idea of her daughters attending college far away but was convinced after they visited Gettysburg College. Her advice for other parents is to let their children explore these opportunities, as it can greatly expand their horizons.

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6.Question

What is the overarching message in this chapter about the college selection process?

Answer:The overarching message is to keep an open mind about college options—especially those that are not local—and to prioritize what truly matters while understanding that the path to finding the right fit will involve some trade-offs.

7.Question

How can parents assist their children in finding the right college fit according to the chapter?

Answer:Parents can assist by engaging in open discussions about their child's values and priorities, encouraging exploration of diverse options, and supporting them emotionally through the decision-making process.

8.Question

Why is it important for students to be aware of their expectations in choosing a college?

Answer:Awareness of their expectations helps students avoid disillusionment and encourages them to look for institutions

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that align with their essential needs, rather than settle for the easiest or most convenient option.

Chapter 8 | C. Adding Other Voices to the Conversation| Q&A

1.Question

What role do college counselors play in the college application process?

Answer:College counselors provide valuable knowledge, expert advice, and resources regarding the college application process. They help students and their families understand timelines, deadlines for standardized tests and applications, and organize events such as college fairs and financial aid nights. They also offer tools to track applications and provide guidance tailored to individual student needs.

2.Question

Why is it important for families to connect with college counselors early, such as during sophomore year?

Answer:Connecting early with college counselors allows

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families to set clear expectations and prepare well in advance for the college application process. This proactive approach enables families to understand the necessary steps, important dates, and resources available, thus reducing last-minute stress and increasing chances of success.

3.Question

How can first-generation college parents benefit from the college counseling office?

Answer:First-generation college parents can gain emotional support and practical advice from college counseling offices, which often facilitate connections with other first-generation parents who have successfully navigated the college process. This peer support can inspire confidence and provide valuable insights into the challenges and opportunities of higher education.

4.Question

What are some community resources available to assist with college access?

Answer:Local public libraries often have resources like

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guidebooks and test-prep materials. Community-based organizations (CBOs) also provide support, especially for students from low-income or historically underserved backgrounds. Examples include Say Yes to Education and College Track, which offer programs aimed at helping young people access higher education.

5.Question

What online resources are recommended for students during their college search and application process?

Answer: Useful online resources include College Factual, which offers decision-making tools; BigFuture by the College Board, which helps students explore college options; and the Common Application, which provides planning tools for college preparation. These resources demystify the college application process and facilitate informed decision-making.

6.Question

What should families consider when thinking about hiring an independent education counselor?

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Answer:Families should evaluate the counselor's qualifications, such as membership in professional organizations, and thoroughly discuss fees and services provided. It's crucial to ensure that the engagement maintains the integrity of the college application process and that the student's authentic voice remains in their applications.

7.Question

Why is it essential to discuss ethical considerations in the college admissions process?

Answer:Ethical considerations are vital to ensure that the college admissions process remains fair and genuine.

Temptations to cut corners can undermine the integrity of a student's application and have long-term repercussions.

Adhering to ethical standards encourages authenticity and prepares students for future challenges.

Chapter 9 | D. The Fifth C: Cost| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important to discuss college costs early in the college planning process?

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Answer: Discussing college costs early sets realistic financial expectations for both parents and students. It helps families make informed decisions about which colleges to include in the list, ensuring that they align with their financial capacity. As stated, tackling this topic before the college list assembly allows for proactive planning and emotional readiness, mitigating anxiety about finances later.

2.Question

What are some financial responsibilities that may be shared between parents and students when paying for college?

Answer: Some shared responsibilities can include parents discussing their willingness to sacrifice certain luxuries or vacations to fund education, while students may contribute by taking summer jobs or working part-time during college. This partnership not only manages costs but also prepares the student for financial independence.

3.Question

What is the significance of understanding need-based vs.

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merit-based financial aid?

Answer: Understanding the difference between need-based and merit-based financial aid is crucial because it impacts how families approach college applications and decision-making. Need-based aid is determined by a family's financial situation, while merit-based aid is awarded based on academic or extracurricular achievements. This knowledge helps families identify colleges that align with their financial and academic aspirations.

4.Question

How can parents prepare for the financial conversation with their child about college?

Answer: Parents can prepare by conducting a financial review of their income, expenses, savings, and investments, allowing them to provide an honest picture of their financial situation. Crafting a plan and seeking resources, such as college financial aid platforms, can empower parents to confidently discuss their goals and the importance of affordability with their child.

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5.Question

What role do a child's intended major and career aspirations play in college planning?

Answer:A child's intended major and career can significantly influence the affordability discussion because fields with higher job prospects may justify higher tuition investments. By considering potential future earnings, families can determine their tolerance for debt and make informed decisions about selecting colleges that meet both educational and financial needs.

6.Question

What initial steps can help a family begin the college list based on cost?

Answer:Families should start by including at least one in-state public college on their list as it typically offers lower tuition rates. They should also begin to utilize net price calculators online to gauge the approximate costs after potential financial aid, ensuring affordability as a cornerstone in the college selection process.

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7.Question

Why is it suggested to have a clear understanding of financial aid before visiting colleges?

Answer: Having a clear understanding of financial aid policies helps guide discussions with college admissions representatives, allowing families to ask specific questions about aid available, application processes, and how the institution handles need during admissions. This foresight empowers families to target institutions that fit both academic and financial criteria.

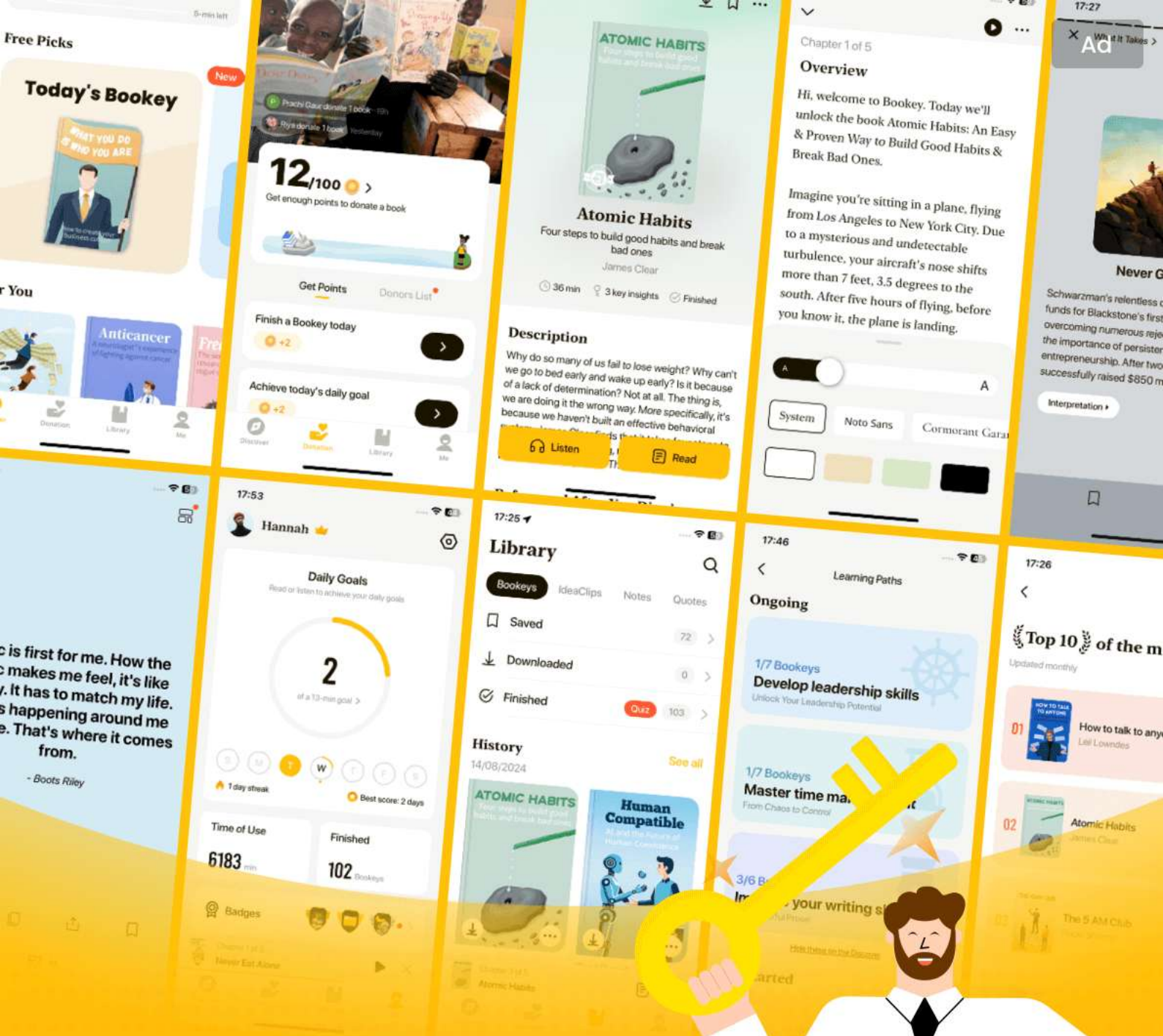
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Chapter 10 | E. Helping Your Child Build a College List| Q&A

1.Question

What is the ideal number of colleges for my child to apply to?

Answer:While there's no hard and fast rule, it is recommended to aim for 8 to 10 schools after narrowing a rough draft list. This helps manage application fatigue.

2.Question

How can I support my child in building their college list?

Answer:Engage in collaborative discussions, ensuring both your child's aspirations and your insights are included as you explore college options.

3.Question

What are the categories to consider when sorting colleges on a list?

Answer:The colleges should be divided into three categories: sweet spot (target schools), likely (schools you feel confident your child can get into), and aspirational (reach schools that

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align closely with your child's goals but may be harder to get into).

4.Question

Why is it important to have schools in the sweet spot category?

Answer: Sweet spot schools balance admissions alignment with your child's criteria, thus providing a realistic chance of acceptance while matching their college aspirations.

5.Question

What is the distinction between likely schools and safeties?

Answer: Unlike safeties, which imply a guaranteed admission, likely schools are those where your child's academic profile suggests a high probability of acceptance, without the assumption of certainty.

6.Question

How should my child treat aspirational schools?

Answer: Aspirational schools are those your child is excited about, even if the acceptance rates are low or their scores might not be in the top range, encouraging them to aim high

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while managing expectations.

7.Question

What role do standardized test scores play in the admissions process?

Answer:Standardized test scores provide a quantifiable measure of a student's academic standing but are only one of many factors considered in the admissions process.

8.Question

How can personal qualities impact college admissions?

Answer:Qualitative factors such as community engagement, personal values, and life experiences shape the applicant's profile and greatly influence admissions decisions.

9.Question

What should we do if my child's likely schools don't excite them?

Answer:If your child is not enthusiastic about their likely schools, replace them with others that inspire excitement and enthusiasm for attending.

10.Question

How can I explain the idea of risk in college applications

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to my child?

Answer: You can liken it to financial decisions: investing in college options with a realistic chance of admission (like a savings account) is safer than only applying to aspirational schools (like lottery tickets).

11.Question

Why is family alignment significant during the college selection process?

Answer: Family alignment fosters trust and collaboration throughout the college selection process, helping to create a supportive environment for your child's decisions.

Chapter 11 | Activity #4: The College List| Q&A

1.Question

What are some important factors to consider when creating a college list?

Answer: When creating a college list, key factors to consider include:

1. ****Community Alignment****: Assess how the school's community aligns with your interests and

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how it can help you expand your social circle.

2. ****Curriculum Challenge****: Evaluate if the curriculum will challenge you intellectually and encourage broader thinking.

3. ****Cultural Inspiration****: Reflect on whether the school's culture, mission, and values resonate with you and inspire you.

4. ****Anxiety Mitigation****: Consider how attending a particular school may impact any anxieties you have regarding the college transition.

5. ****Categorization****: Ensure that you feel each school is appropriately categorized into sweet spot, likely, and aspirational based on your research and feelings.

2.Question

Why is it important to start with a rough draft of the college list?

Answer: Starting with a rough draft of the college list is crucial because it establishes a framework for the next steps

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in the research process. It allows for exploration and encourages open discussion about various schools without overthinking every choice. This initial brainstorming phase can highlight interests and priorities that will be critical in refining the list later on.

3.Question

How can parents and students effectively collaborate on the college list?

Answer:Parents and students can effectively collaborate on the college list by setting aside time to discuss their ideas openly. They can share their index cards, where each has noted schools of interest, and compare notes after independently brainstorming. Discussing questions that address the alignment of the candidate schools with the student's preferences can deepen understanding and strengthen the collaboration.

4.Question

What role does research play in developing a college list?

Answer:Research plays a pivotal role in developing a college

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list as it provides essential information about each school's attributes such as culture, curriculum, cost, and community. Engaging with resources like college guides and websites, along with insights from college counselors, helps ensure that each school on the list aligns with the student's personal and academic goals.

5.Question

What is the significance of categorizing schools into sweet spot, likely, and aspirational?

Answer: Categorizing schools into sweet spot, likely, and aspirational helps students and parents clarify their ambitions and expectations. The 'sweet spot' represents schools that are a perfect fit, 'likely' schools are those where the student has a good chance of acceptance, and 'aspirational' schools are those that may be more competitive. This framework aids in goal setting and encourages realistic discussions about the college application process.

6.Question

What can families do if they have difficulties answering questions about choice alignment at this stage?

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Answer: If families have difficulties answering questions about choice alignment, they can revisit each school's literature and resources, engage in further discussions with college counselors, or visit the schools if possible. They can also keep a journal or worksheet for each school, where they document thoughts, feelings, and research findings, allowing for a clearer assessment as the process evolves.

Chapter 12 | F. Conversations About Learning Style| Q&A

1.Question

How can understanding my child's learning style influence our college search?

Answer: Recognizing your child's learning style can help identify colleges that support their unique needs. For example, if they thrive in smaller, interactive classrooms, colleges with smaller class sizes or discussion-based courses may be more beneficial. Conversely, if they enjoy larger environments but feel overwhelmed, looking for institutions that foster smaller communities within

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larger campuses can bridge the gap.

2.Question

What are some critical aspects to consider regarding first-year curriculum?

Answer:When evaluating colleges, it's essential to investigate how the first-year curriculum is structured. Look for colleges that emphasize smaller seminars and courses designed to build on high school knowledge, as these can ease the transition to college life and academic rigor, setting a strong foundation for future success.

3.Question

What support services should I inquire about when visiting colleges?

Answer:During college visits, ask about available support services such as writing centers, tutoring options, and academic advising. It's also beneficial to learn how accessible professors are to students, as this can significantly impact your child's ability to seek help and foster understandings of course material.

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4.Question

What is the importance of a college's approach to learning differences?

Answer:Understanding a college's approach to students with learning differences is crucial as it reflects the institution's overall culture and commitment to inclusivity. Colleges that actively support students with varied learning styles may offer tailored resources that can enhance your child's academic journey and personal growth.

5.Question

Why might a college's environment matter in relation to my child's identity and learning needs?

Answer:A college's environment can profoundly impact a student's educational experience. Your child may feel more comfortable and engaged in an environment that aligns with their identity and learning preferences, whether that be a more intimate campus culture or a larger institution that offers diverse communities and interactions.

6.Question

What reassurance can be derived from understanding the

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success of students with learning differences in college?

Answer: The observation that students with different cognitive traits can succeed in college and beyond offers significant reassurance to parents and students alike. It emphasizes that success is attainable and that many institutions are equipped to help students leverage their unique strengths in a supportive environment.

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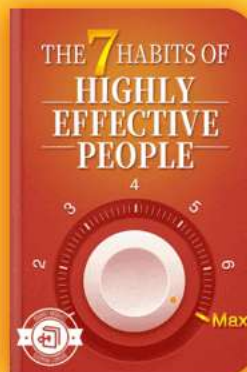
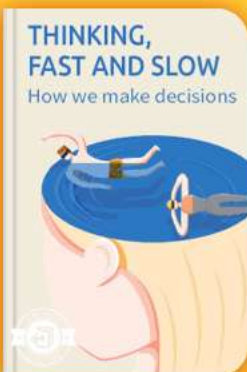


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Chapter 13 | G. Some Thoughts on Standardized Testing| Q&A

1.Question

How important are standardized tests in the college admissions process?

Answer:Standardized test scores are considered important, often equating to the rigor of high school courses and grades. Their weight varies across institutions, but many selective schools require at least one SAT or ACT score.

2.Question

What are some reasons colleges might go test-optional?

Answer:Colleges may adopt test-optional policies to eliminate barriers for promising students, recognize other predictors of success, or in response to crises, like the COVID-19 pandemic.

3.Question

Why should students consider taking standardized tests at least once, even if applying to test-optional schools?

Answer:Taking standardized tests can preserve options for

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students, allowing them to submit scores if they do well, while also helping those who might feel more competitive in the admissions process.

4.Question

What is the role of preliminary tests like the PSAT or PreACT?

Answer: These preliminary tests serve as practice and provide diagnostic information to identify academic strengths and weaknesses without affecting college admissions.

5.Question

How can students prepare effectively for standardized tests?

Answer: Students can use free resources available online, take practice tests, or hire tutors if needed, while considering their learning styles and the financial costs involved.

6.Question

How often should students take standardized tests?

Answer: It is recommended that students limit themselves to three sittings for the SAT or ACT, as research shows scores tend to plateau or decline with excessive repetition.

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7.Question

What are considerations regarding test accommodations for students with learning differences?

Answer: While students can seek accommodations based on documented needs, parents should reflect on the ethical implications of this choice and the lessons it teaches about self-advocacy versus taking shortcuts.

8.Question

What is the potential impact of seeking testing accommodations on a child's development?

Answer: Legitimate accommodations can empower students to overcome challenges, while unethical practices may impart negative lessons about integrity and fairness in their academic and personal lives.

Chapter 14 | H. Your Child's Background (And How It Might Factor into Their Search)| Q&A

1.Question

How do a child's background factors into their college search?

Answer: A child's background, including their race,

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ethnicity, socioeconomic status, and if they are the first in their family to attend college, significantly impacts their college search. Parents can guide their children to assess how inclusive and supportive a potential college community is of varied backgrounds, particularly for underrepresented minorities and students from lower socioeconomic brackets.

2.Question

What should parents encourage their children to consider regarding diversity at colleges?

Answer:Parents should encourage their children to reflect on how their identity connects with the community at a college. This involves understanding the climate for students from similar backgrounds and how included they feel, especially for first-generation college students or those from diverse sexual orientations.

3.Question

Why is understanding the culture of a college important for students from non-majority backgrounds?

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Answer: Understanding the culture of a college helps students from non-majority backgrounds determine if they will feel welcome and supported. It is crucial for ensuring that they can thrive socially and academically within the campus environment.

4.Question

What are 'fly-in' programs, and how can they benefit prospective students?

Answer: 'Fly-in' programs are initiatives where colleges provide travel assistance to prospective students from underrepresented backgrounds, allowing them to visit campus and experience life there firsthand. This can significantly enhance their understanding of the school and its community.

5.Question

How can a student's legacy affect their college admission process?

Answer: A student's legacy status, if they are applying to a family member's alma mater, may influence their

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application. However, it's important for parents to balance their own experiences with their child's preferences, allowing the child to make independent decisions about their choices.

6.Question

What resources can support international students in their college search?

Answer:Resources like EducationUSA provide guidance for international students on the steps to studying in the U.S., including how to apply for a student visa and understand the academic landscape.

7.Question

What role does curriculum play when considering colleges for diverse students?

Answer:The curriculum should reflect a broad and inclusive perspective that includes various cultures and global studies. This helps ensure that the education delivered is relevant and acknowledges the diversity of the world.

8.Question

What important step should parents take if their child is interested in a 'legacy' school?

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Answer: Parents should help their child explore specific resources for legacy applicants, including attending information sessions during major campus events and differentiating between their feelings and their child's aspirations for attending that school.

Chapter 15 | I. Interests and Talents Developed Over Time| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of identifying interests and talents when refining a college list?

Answer: Identifying interests and talents helps students focus their college search on programs that align with their passion, potentially leading to more fulfilling college experiences. These attributes guide them to seek out specific professors or coaches, allowing for meaningful outreach that can provide insights about the commitment required and the current accomplishments of students in those programs.

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How should students approach professors or program directors during their college search?

Answer: Students should be thoughtful in their outreach, focusing on one individual within a department rather than contacting multiple people at once. They should also respect the busy schedules of these professionals and be prepared for the possibility that they may not receive a response.

3.Question

What should student-athletes do when considering playing sports in college?

Answer: Student-athletes should register on the NCAA website and be aware of the recruitment rules that govern interactions with coaches. They may need to fill out questionnaires regarding their academic and athletic performance to provide coaches with relevant information.

4.Question

What should students consider if they are interested in continuing a sport in college, but not at a varsity level?

Answer: Students can explore club or intramural levels of

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their sport as an option, gauging their commitment by referencing how prominently they mentioned the sport in their initial interest assessments.

5.Question

Why is it important to submit a portfolio or samples when reaching out to programs?

Answer: Submitting a portfolio, writing samples, or recordings helps to better inform the professor or program director about the student's skills and commitment level, demonstrating seriousness about their interest in the program.

6.Question

How can college visits complement the process of refining interests and talents?

Answer: College visits provide students with direct exposure to the programs they are interested in, allowing them to assess fit and connection with faculty and current students, which can further shape their college decision-making process.

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Chapter 16 | J. The College Visit| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of college visits in the application process?

Answer:College visits serve as a crucial bridge between the search and application phases, allowing students to visualize their potential future at a university, engage with its culture, and assess whether it aligns with their academic and personal aspirations.

2.Question

How can parents and students prepare for college visits?

Answer:They can create an itinerary that covers all college visits and activities, set expectations about accompanying each other, and consider engaging with alumni for firsthand insights. Collectively, they might also research virtual tours if in-person visits are not feasible.

3.Question

What should students focus on during their college visits?

Answer:Students should absorb the campus environment by

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observing its dynamics, interacting with current students, and participating in academic information sessions to get a well-rounded perspective.

4.Question

Why is it important to demonstrate interest in a college during visits?

Answer: Demonstrating interest, such as by attending campus visits or engaging with the admissions office, can positively influence the admissions process, as some colleges factor this into their decision-making.

5.Question

What advice does Chloe Rodriguez give regarding planning college visits?

Answer: Chloe suggests creating a detailed itinerary for each day of college visits to help manage expectations and ensure a structured approach to the experience.

6.Question

How can virtual tours complement physical college visits?

Answer: Virtual tours simulate the experience of exploring a college campus and can provide students who are unable to

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visit in person with valuable insights about the institution's environment and facilities.

7.Question

What practical travel tips does Chloe share for preparing for college visits?

Answer:Chloe recommends watching videos on packing and travel tips, checking baggage restrictions, and leaving room in luggage for college merchandise.

8.Question

Why should students consider visiting local colleges?

Answer:Visiting local colleges, even if they're not on a student's list, can offer practice in touring campuses and provide insights into what aspects they prefer in a college environment.

9.Question

What are some ways to enhance the college visit experience?

Answer:Engaging with current students, scheduling information sessions on academic interests, and reaching out to alumni from their high school who attend the college can

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greatly enhance understanding and comfort with the institution.

Chapter 17 | Activity #5: Planning a College Road Trip| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important to plan college visits together with your child?

Answer:Planning college visits together encourages open communication and collaboration, allowing both parent and child to share their perspectives and feelings about potential schools. This shared experience also helps to ease any anxiety your child may have about the process.

2.Question

What should you consider when deciding the timing of college visits?

Answer:Consider your child's developmental stage; visiting too early may overwhelm them. It's generally advised to begin planning visits during the summer before junior year to ensure they are mature enough to thoughtfully engage in the

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experience.

3.Question

What resources should you have on hand when planning college visits?

Answer: You should have high school calendars, navigation tools like Google Maps, access to college admissions websites, and a rough budget to guide your planning.

4.Question

How can you make the most out of college visits?

Answer: It's beneficial to schedule information sessions, campus tours, and perhaps interviews while ensuring the visits occur during times when students are available and the campus is lively, rather than during breaks or busy times. Additionally, clustering visits to nearby colleges can save time and energy.

5.Question

What should you do during a campus visit to get a true sense of the student experience?

Answer: Take time to explore the campus environment, talk to current students, and observe campus life, paying attention

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to flyers and events to gauge the culture.

6.Question

How should you approach the conversation about impressions after a college visit?

Answer:After visiting, it's vital to allow some silence before discussing impressions. This way, both parent and child can reflect on their experiences independently before sharing, fostering a more honest and open dialogue.

7.Question

What can your child gain from getting involved in high school-sponsored events at colleges?

Answer:Participating in events like Model United Nations or summer programs can provide your child with independence, a taste of college life, and a chance to engage with peers with similar interests.

8.Question

Why is it advisable for your child not to show bias about colleges during visits?

Answer:Encouraging your child to form their own opinions about colleges helps ensure they make an informed and

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authentic choice rather than simply following parental expectations.

Chapter 18 | A. Refining the List| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of refining a college list during the college application process?

Answer:Refining a college list is crucial because it allows students to focus on schools that truly align with their academic and personal goals. By categorizing schools into 'likely', 'sweet spot', and 'aspirational', students can create a balanced application strategy that increases their chances of admission while also ensuring they consider their preferences and values in a college.

2.Question

How can parents assist their child in refining their college list?

Answer:Parents can assist by encouraging open discussions about what qualities are most important to the child in a

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college, helping evaluate the list based on specific criteria, and reminding their child that the decision to eliminate an option is valuable in the decision-making process.

3.Question

What should families do if their list is too heavy in the 'sweet spot' category?

Answer:If the list is too heavy in the 'sweet spot' category, families should engage in discussions to identify what makes each institution unique and inspiring reflections on the pros and cons of each to determine which schools resonate best. This could involve ranking them based on specific criteria such as community, programs, or extracurricular opportunities.

4.Question

What broader lesson can be learned from the college list refinement process?

Answer:A broader lesson from this refinement process is that making difficult choices and eliminating options is a necessary part of decision-making. It teaches children to

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prioritize their values and empowers them to own their choices better.

5.Question

What is a potential challenge students may face when refining their college lists?

Answer:Students may struggle with deciding between two appealing options, such as prioritizing a vibrant athletic culture over a strong academic community, which could lead to feelings of uncertainty and anxiety about making the right choice.

6.Question

How essential is the role of a college counselor in the application process?

Answer:While the role of a college counselor can be critical in guiding students through the process and providing personalized advice, it is also completely feasible for students and families to navigate the application process independently with structured methods and thoughtful discussions.

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7.Question

Why is it important to engage in campus visits before finalizing the college list?

Answer:Engaging in campus visits is important as it provides firsthand experience of the college environment, allowing students to gauge the atmosphere and culture of a school, which can significantly influence their final decision on where to apply.

8.Question

What mindset should students adopt regarding perfection in their college choices?

Answer:Students should adopt the mindset that there are no 'perfect' choices, acknowledging that while some schools may align better with their aspirations, each choice will have its strengths and weaknesses that are worth considering.

9.Question

How can the process of reviewing and refining the college list deepen a student's understanding of their own values?

Answer:This process can deepen a student's understanding of their values by forcing them to prioritize what aspects of a

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college are most important, leading them to reflect on their personal goals, interests, and what kind of community they want to be part of in their college experience.

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Chapter 19 | Activity #6: Creating a College Application Requirement and Deadline Tracker| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important for students to treat college application deadlines as hard deadlines?

Answer:College application deadlines are firm and non-negotiable, unlike some lenient deadlines students may have encountered in high school projects. Treating these deadlines seriously instills a sense of responsibility and prepares them for the structured demands of college and post-college life.

2.Question

What tools can students use to track their college application requirements and deadlines?

Answer:Students can use various tools such as Excel spreadsheets, Google Docs, graph paper, or online tools like Naviance and Scoir to create a tailored tracker for their college application process.

3.Question

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How can parents support their children in managing college application deadlines?

Answer: Parents can support their children by encouraging them to stay organized, helping create a deadline tracker, monitoring deadlines on their calendars, and providing reminders as necessary.

4.Question

What should students include in their college application requirement and deadline tracker?

Answer: Students should include a list of finalists, application deadlines for rolling, early, and regular admissions, fees, standardized test requirements, supplemental essays, and contact information for the admissions office.

5.Question

Where can students find necessary information for filling out their application tracker?

Answer: Students can download annual PDFs from the Common Application that detail deadlines, fees, and requirements for nearly nine hundred colleges, and can also

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procure this information directly from individual college admissions websites.

6.Question

How can organization impact a student's college application process?

Answer:Being organized allows students to navigate the often overwhelming college application landscape more effectively, ensuring they meet deadlines, submit required materials, and ultimately reducing stress during the application phase.

7.Question

What role does the college application serve beyond just submitting requirements?

Answer:The college application process serves as a reflection for students to take stock of their achievements, aspirations, and readiness for the next stage of their educational journey.

Chapter 20 | B. The College Application as a Reporting Mechanism, and a Moment for Your Child to Take Stock| Q&A

1.Question

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How can the college application be viewed as more than just a formality?

Answer: The college application is not just a ticket for admission; it serves as a mosaic that tells your child's unique story. Each component, from family background to personal reflections, contributes to a larger narrative of who they are and who they aspire to become.

2.Question

What role should parents play in the college application process?

Answer: Parents should serve as support and guidance, helping their child navigate deadlines and ensuring communications are checked, but should ultimately allow the child to take ownership of the application, especially in writing their essays.

3.Question

Why is it important for parents to establish boundaries with their child during the application process?

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Answer: Establishing boundaries helps respect the child's autonomy in the application process, encouraging them to fully engage and reflect on their experiences, while also ensuring parents remain involved in a supportive, non-intrusive way.

4.Question

What lesson can be learned from Matthew Boyd's story regarding email communication during the application process?

Answer: Matthew's experience underscores the critical importance of being diligent about checking emails during the application timeline, as missing communications can lead to missed opportunities, emphasizing the necessity of timely responsiveness.

5.Question

How can the college application process serve as an opportunity for personal growth for students?

Answer: The process encourages students to reflect on their past experiences, choices, and aspirations, fostering self-awareness and a deeper understanding of their identity,

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which ultimately contributes to their development into young adults.

6.Question

What strategies can be used for effective collaboration between parents and children during the application process?

Answer:Parents and children should have early discussions to establish which parts of the application the child will own, set parameters for feedback on essays, and agree on how involved parents will be in tracking deadlines and materials.

7.Question

What should parents remind their children about confirming application materials with colleges?

Answer:Parents should regularly remind their child to use each college's online portal to verify that all required materials, such as test scores and transcripts, have been received, highlighting the importance of double-checking for a smooth application process.

Chapter 21 | C. Your Child Assembles the Parts: Opportunities to Render Their Experiences| Q&A

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1.Question

What should parents keep in mind about the involvement of admissions committee members?

Answer:Parents should understand that admissions committees are diverse, ranging in age and experience, and are genuinely committed to giving each applicant a fair consideration. They should picture a group of individuals with broad perspectives rather than a narrow or critical view.

2.Question

How can students effectively communicate their experiences in their college applications?

Answer:Students should carefully consider how to present their activities, focusing on the quality and significance of their engagement rather than merely listing experiences. Thoughtfulness and authenticity in writing will resonate more with admissions officers than simply filling the application spaces.

3.Question

Why is a high school transcript a crucial element in the

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college application?

Answer: The transcript is often the first document reviewed by admissions officers, providing a quantitative measure of a student's academic performance over three or more years, including trends, improvements, or challenges that can help contextualize the student's experiences.

4.Question

What should students do about standardized test scores when applying to colleges?

Answer: Students should familiarize themselves with the specific requirements of each college regarding standardized test scores. They can choose to self-report their scores where allowed, and they should only report scores that genuinely reflect their abilities, considering if they enhance or detract from their application.

5.Question

What role do recommendation letters play in the admissions process?

Answer: Recommendation letters provide vital insights into a

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student's character, work ethic, and contributions to the school community, as seen through the eyes of teachers and counselors who know them well. These letters can highlight aspects of a student's academic journey and personal qualities that aren't captured elsewhere in the application.

6.Question

What advice is given for choosing teachers for recommendation letters?

Answer:Students should select teachers who can speak to their strengths across different subjects, including those who may have seen challenges in the classroom. Having varied perspectives from different disciplines demonstrates breadth and depth in the student's learning experiences.

7.Question

How can parents support their child in the college application process?

Answer:Parents should engage in supportive conversations, helping their child reflect on their experiences and aspirations while respecting the student's autonomy in

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crafting their application and expressing their voice.

8.Question

What is the importance of the additional information section in applications?

Answer:The additional information section offers students a chance to explain any unique circumstances or challenges they faced, providing a fuller picture of their experiences and potential to admissions officers.

9.Question

What is the value of extracurricular activities in a college application?

Answer:Extracurricular activities are valuable as they showcase a student's interests, commitments, and personal growth outside the classroom, allowing admissions officers to get a sense of the student's passions and how they spend their time.

10.Question

How should students approach writing their application essays?

Answer:Students should ensure their essays reflect their

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authentic voice and experiences, conveying personal and meaningful narratives that will engage those reading their applications.

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Chapter 22 | Activity #7: Your Child Catalogs Their Activity List| Q&A

1.Question

What is the purpose of having your child catalog their activity list?

Answer: The purpose is for your child to take an inventory of their experiences in a structured way, allowing them to shape and convey their unique story through their activities, which will later play a crucial role in their college applications.

2.Question

How should your child approach describing their activities in their inventory?

Answer: Your child should be comprehensive in including activities and descriptive in making them compelling. They should use active language that highlights their contributions and evokes emotion, transforming their experiences into a narrative rather than a simple list.

3.Question

What is the difference between a résumé and the activity

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list on college applications?

Answer: A résumé is a formal document, while the activity list is a tailored section meant to provide specific, concise information that helps admissions officers quickly understand the applicant's experiences and impacts without distraction.

4.Question

Why might a portfolio or additional information section be useful in a college application?

Answer: A portfolio allows applicants to showcase their work and creativity, which can be essential for programs requiring such evidence. The additional information section offers space for applicants to explain experiences or challenges not covered elsewhere, adding depth to their application.

5.Question

What should your child do if they have past disciplinary actions?

Answer: Your child should verify their official record and take proactive ownership of their past actions in the

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application. By providing context and explaining how they've learned and grown from these experiences, they demonstrate personal responsibility and resilience.

6.Question

How can your child effectively direct an admissions officer's attention to specific activities?

Answer:By thoughtfully choosing which activities to highlight based on significance and impact, your child can frame their story in a way that aligns with their personal goals and the qualities they wish to showcase to admissions officers.

7.Question

Why is it important for your child to familiarize themselves with the Common Application format before drafting their activity list?

Answer:Familiarizing themselves with the Common Application format ensures that their inventory aligns with the specific information requested, such as commitment levels and descriptions, making it easier for them to integrate this information efficiently into their application later.

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Chapter 23 | D. Conversations About the Essays: Your Child Frames Their Story| Q&A

1.Question

Why are college essay prompts important for applicants?

Answer:College essay prompts serve a dual purpose:

they assess a student's writing ability and provide a glimpse into their personal story, interests, and experiences. They encourage self-reflection and help admissions committees understand how a student's background and challenges have shaped who they are.

2.Question

What key qualities do colleges look for in a student's writing through these essays?

Answer:Colleges look for clarity of expression, effective organization of thoughts, and genuine insight into the student's personality and experiences. They want to see how well students can articulate their stories and convey their unique perspectives.

3.Question

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How can a student choose the right essay prompt to respond to?

Answer: A student should choose a prompt that resonates personally with them, allowing them to share a meaningful experience or insight. They should consider which story or aspect of their life they feel most passionate about and believe will best showcase their character and growth.

4.Question

What does the statement 'the lessons we take from obstacles we encounter can be fundamental to later success' imply about personal challenges?

Answer: This statement highlights that overcoming challenges not only builds resilience and character but also provides valuable lessons that contribute to personal growth and future accomplishments. It encourages students to embrace difficulties as growth opportunities.

5.Question

Why is it significant for students to reflect on their experiences when writing their essays?

Answer: Reflection allows students to articulate their journey,

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understand their motivations, and connect their past experiences with their future aspirations. It is a chance to convey authenticity, demonstrate self-awareness, and engage the reader on a deeper level.

6.Question

In what ways can parents support their children during the essay-writing process?

Answer:Parents can support their children by encouraging open dialogue about their experiences, providing a safe space for brainstorming and reflection, and respecting the boundaries set for the process. They should also help them stay true to their voice and avoid imposing their expectations.

7.Question

What is the purpose of the open-ended essay prompt that allows students to write on any topic?

Answer:The open-ended prompt encourages creativity and freedom, allowing students to explore topics that genuinely interest them. This encourages authenticity and can lead to unique and engaging narratives that highlight aspects of their

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identity not covered by other prompts.

8.Question

Why should students avoid filters in their essays?

Answer:Writing without filters allows students to present their true selves, conveying honesty and vulnerability. This direct approach fosters a genuine connection with admissions committees, as they appreciate sincere narratives that reflect the applicant's individuality.

9.Question

How do college essays serve as the final piece of a student's application mosaic?

Answer:The essays tie together various elements of the application, creating a holistic view of the student. They complement academic records and extracurriculars by adding personal depth, highlighting passions, values, and the unique story that defines the applicant.

Chapter 24 | Activity #8: Your Child Looks into Their Rearview Mirror| Q&A

1.Question

How can reflecting on personal experiences aid in crafting

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a college essay?

Answer: Reflecting on personal experiences allows students to identify meaningful moments in their lives that shape their identity and values. These reflections help in curating stories that showcase who they are to admissions officers, making their essays more compelling and authentic. Personal anecdotes can be vivid and striking, capturing the reader's attention—similar to how a journalist selects impactful details to tell a story.

2.Question

What prompts could help a student reflect on their past experiences?

Answer: Some useful prompts include: 'What is important to you, and why?' 'What experiences have shaped you, and how?' 'Who has influenced you, and in what ways?' and 'How have you changed over time?' These questions encourage introspection, helping students uncover significant moments that can be woven into their college narratives.

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3.Question

Why is it important for a college essay to have a strong opening?

Answer:The opening of a college essay is crucial because it sets the tone and engages the reader. Admissions officers read numerous essays daily, so an evocative hook, whether it's an intriguing question or a vivid detail, invites them in and makes them want to continue reading. A strong introduction can differentiate a student's essay from others.

4.Question

What should students keep in mind regarding the structure and length of their essays?

Answer:Students should focus on clarity and precision while being mindful of the word limits—650 words maximum for the Common Application. Since space is limited, every word should serve a purpose, avoiding tangents, while still thoroughly developing key ideas to convey personal growth and insights.

5.Question

How can students ensure their authentic voice comes

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across in their essays?

Answer: To convey their authentic voice, students should write candidly and reflect who they truly are, avoiding clichés or overly polished language that might misrepresent them. Emphasizing personal experiences and emotions helps the admissions committee see their individuality rather than a manufactured persona.

6.Question

What role do anecdotes play in a college essay?

Answer: Anecdotes provide concrete examples that illustrate a student's experiences, values, and growth. They make the narrative relatable and memorable, allowing admissions officers to connect with the applicant on a personal level. Each story should serve a larger thematic purpose, contributing to the overall message of the essay.

7.Question

How can reading obituaries serve as an inspiration for writing personal narratives?

Answer: Reading obituaries can inspire students to

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understand how impactful details about a person's life are conveyed through storytelling. By examining how writers celebrate someone's legacy through vivid imagery and significant moments, students can learn to craft their own narratives that highlight their experiences and identities.

8.Question

What is the significance of involving others in the essay writing process?

Answer:Involving others, like teachers or peers, provides valuable feedback and can enhance the clarity and effectiveness of the essay. External perspectives help identify areas for improvement and ensure that the essay accurately reflects the student's character and intentions.

9.Question

What should students be cautious about when choosing their essay topics?

Answer:Students should avoid the illusion of formulaic writing that follows common clichés. Instead, focusing on unique aspects of their lives or the complexities of their

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experiences can create more nuanced essays that stand out. They should remember that even common themes can be significant if explored with depth and personal insight.

10.Question

How does understanding the audience of a college essay influence how students write?

Answer: Recognizing that admissions officers are looking to understand them as individuals motivates students to be genuine and insightful in their writing. They should assume their readers know little about them and tailor their essays to reveal their true selves, interests, and aspirations—making each detail relevant and engaging.

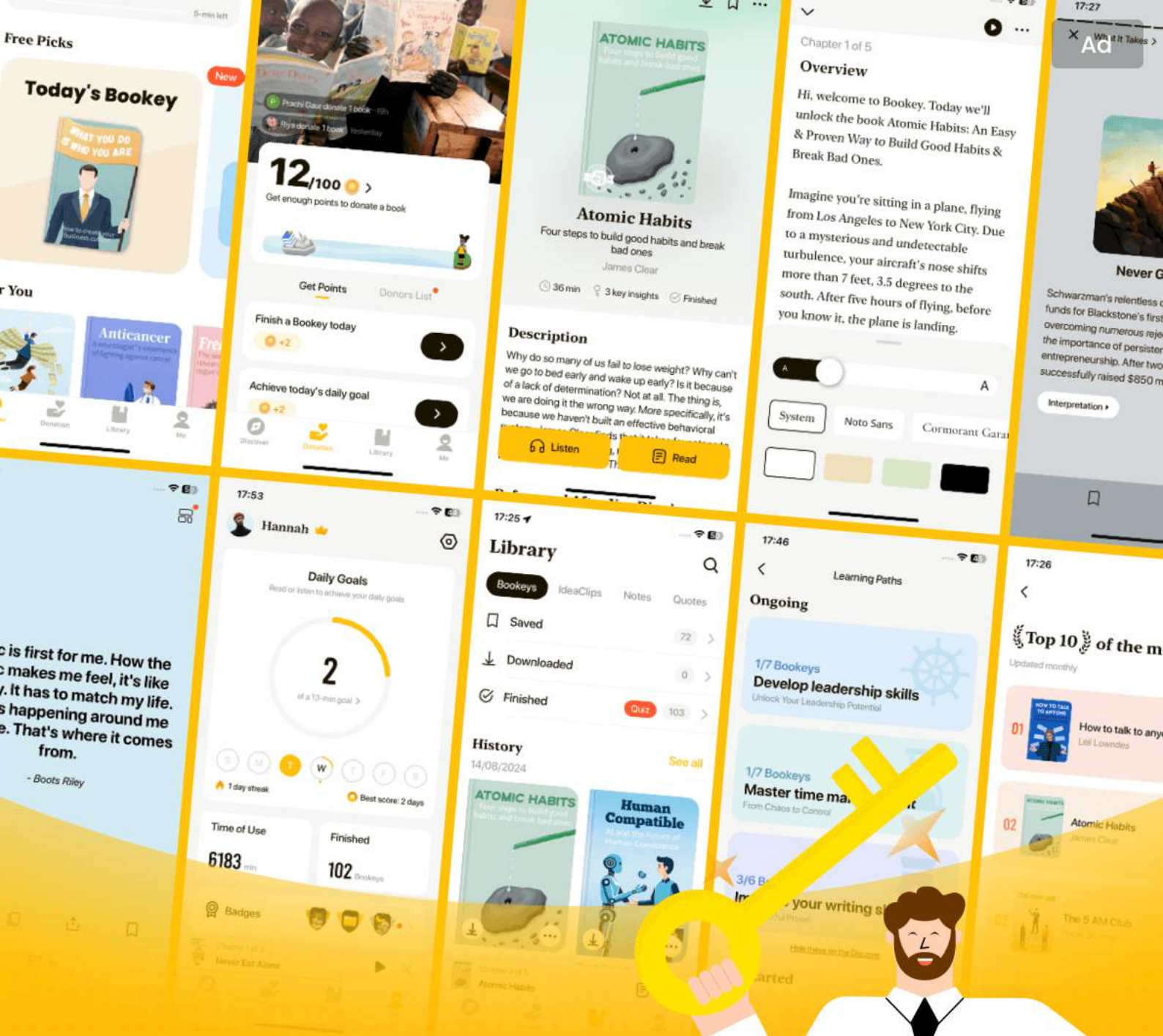
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Chapter 25 | E. Application Plans| Q&A

1.Question

What is the benefit of applying under a rolling admission plan for college?

Answer:The primary advantage of rolling admission is that it allows students to receive admission decisions sooner, typically within two months of applying. This can reduce anxiety and provide students with the opportunity to secure a college spot early in the process, freeing them to refine or narrow down their college choices.

2.Question

How does early action differ from early decision in college applications?

Answer:Early action allows students to apply early and receive a nonbinding decision, meaning they are not obligated to attend if admitted. In contrast, early decision requires students to commit to attending the school if accepted and to withdraw applications from other colleges.

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3.Question

What should a student consider before choosing an early decision application plan?

Answer:Students should consider whether they are truly committed to attending the school if accepted and have evaluated their other college options. They should also discuss their choice with their parent or guardian and school counselor, as it involves signing a contract that obligates them to withdraw other applications.

4.Question

What changes have occurred regarding application deadlines for college decisions?

Answer:Recent changes have altered the rigid May 1 decision deadline. Colleges can now set their own deadlines for students to respond to offers of admission and deposits. This shift allows more flexibility for students but requires them to keep track of various deadlines.

5.Question

Why is it important to be aware of different application plans?

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Answer: Understanding the differences in application plans helps students make informed decisions and select the options that align best with their college aspirations, timelines, and personal circumstances. Knowing these distinctions can guide their approach to applications and their overall college strategy.

6.Question

What role does family support play in a student's college application process?

Answer: Family support is crucial as it can provide emotional encouragement, help in decision-making, and ensure that students are adhering to timelines and requirements. Parents can assist in discussing options, reviewing choices, and preparing necessary documents, creating a collaborative and motivating environment for the student.

7.Question

How can students prepare to make a decision after receiving regular admission offers?

Answer: Students should create a comparison of accepted

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colleges based on factors like program offerings, campus culture, financial aid packages, and personal preferences. They should also consider visiting campuses and talking to current students to inform their final choice.

Chapter 26 | F. Assessing Whether an Early Application Plan May Be Best for Your Child| Q&A

1.Question

What factors should students consider when deciding to apply early to college?

Answer:Students should align their college characteristics with their identity and the institution's culture, along with being fully prepared logistically, including standardized test completions and application requirements.

2.Question

How can parents help their children in the early application process?

Answer:Parents can engage in discussions that encourage self-reflection, guide their children in consulting application guidelines, and provide support through organizational tools

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like an application requirement tracker.

3.Question

What is the importance of emotional readiness in the early application process?

Answer:Emotional readiness is crucial as the process can be stressful, especially for those applying to schools with tight deadlines. Students must assess whether they can handle the pressure of early commitments.

4.Question

How can existing college counseling resources benefit the early application decision?

Answer:Utilizing college counseling resources ensures that students receive informed advice tailored to their situation, which can help clarify whether early application aligns with their goals.

5.Question

Why is alignment between a student's self-reflection and the college's environment significant?

Answer:Alignment is significant because it ensures the student's selection fits their needs and aspirations, ultimately

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enhancing their college experience and satisfaction with their choice.

6.Question

What checklist should students follow when considering an early application?

Answer:A preflight checklist should include confirming all application requirements, ensuring standardized tests are completed, assessing emotional readiness, and matching their values with the institution's environment.

Chapter 27 | Activity #9: A Preflight Checklist for Those Considering Flying Early| Q&A

1.Question

What are the key considerations a student must reflect on when applying under an early decision plan?

Answer:Students need to evaluate whether their assumptions about a college, such as its distance from home and size, align with their current preferences. They must also assess the institution's category on their college list (likely, sweet spot, or aspirational) and their comfort level with the

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associated risks. Grades and test scores should indicate competitiveness as an early applicant, and students should confirm that their teachers can meet recommendation deadlines and that their essays are ready. Financial aid implications are crucial, especially if applying under a binding decision, as students will miss out on comparing offers from other colleges.

2.Question

Why might early decision applications have higher admission rates compared to regular rounds?

Answer:Early decision pools tend to consist of self-selecting candidates who often display highly competitive academic credentials. Their commitment to a binding agreement signals a strong match with the college, indicating their genuine interest. Additionally, early decision pools are smaller, which can result in higher acceptance rates.

3.Question

What should a family do if their child is uncertain about applying under an early decision plan?

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Answer: If there's uncertainty, families should consider whether other options, like early action or rolling admissions, might be more suitable. They should reflect on the child's feelings about the college, the potential for other offers, and evaluate if early decision aligns with their overall college goals. An open conversation to reassess the college list and priorities is advisable.

4.Question

How should a student respond to being deferred in the early application round?

Answer: If deferred, a student should follow any instructions from the admissions office, which typically includes submitting an update letter by mid-January detailing academic achievements since the application. They should also ensure their school sends an updated midyear report with the latest grades.

5.Question

What are the advantages of applying for early action instead of early decision?

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Answer:Early action offers a decision earlier in the application process without the pressure of a binding commitment, allowing families to compare financial aid offers from multiple institutions. Additionally, it can provide peace of mind and confidence for the applicant.

6.Question

Who might consider applying under Early Decision II?

Answer:Students who have been denied in the first round of early decision or early action, or those whose applications have been deferred, could consider applying for Early Decision II. This option may also appeal to students who find a strong match with another college offering EDII after reassessment.

7.Question

What is a crucial step families should take before committing to an early decision?

Answer:Families should carefully assess financial implications and ensure they understand the expected family contribution, keeping in mind that accepting an early

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decision may limit their ability to compare financial aid offers from other schools.

8.Question

How does socio-economic status influence early decision applications?

Answer: Critics argue that early decision applications can favor privileged candidates who have access to better resources, such as test preparation, thus creating disparities in the college admissions process.

9.Question

What message should families take away regarding the strategic use of early decision?

Answer: While early decision may seem advantageous due to higher admission rates, it's essential not to prioritize strategy over a reflective decision-making process. The best outcome is one where the child has thoroughly considered their fit with the college.

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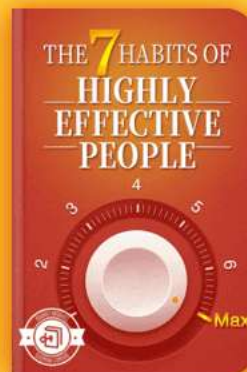
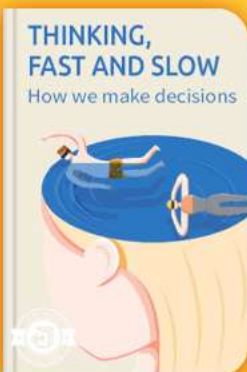


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Chapter 28 | G. The Fifth C Revisited: Managing Cost and Affordability| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of discussing financial matters during the college application process with your child?

Answer:Discussing financial matters can foster a sense of shared responsibility and ownership over the education investment. It prepares your child to understand the financial commitment required for college.

2.Question

How can financial aid forms like the FAFSA impact a student's college experience?

Answer:Filling out the FAFSA can provide access to federal aid such as grants, work-study programs, and loans, enabling a student to afford higher education that might otherwise be out of reach.

3.Question

What are the potential benefits of requesting a fee waiver when submitting college applications?

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Answer: Requesting a fee waiver can alleviate financial barriers, making it easier for students from low-income families to apply to colleges, thereby increasing their opportunities for higher education.

4.Question

Why is it important to fill out the FAFSA even if a family believes they will not qualify for need-based aid?

Answer: Filling out the FAFSA can still provide access to unsubsidized loans or other financial resources, which can help manage college costs.

5.Question

What are some characteristics of the CSS Profile compared to the FAFSA?

Answer: The CSS Profile is typically longer and more detailed, including requests for information about family assets and income, and it is used by many private colleges for additional financial aid.

6.Question

How can outside scholarships contribute to a student's funding for college?

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Answer:Outside scholarships can significantly reduce the financial burden of college tuition and related expenses, helping to increase the overall financial aid package for the student.

7.Question

What strategy can students use when writing essays for scholarship applications?

Answer:Students should leverage previous essays written for college applications, adapting them as necessary to address the specific prompts of scholarship applications while ensuring relevance.

8.Question

Why is timely submission of financial aid documents crucial for students?

Answer:Timely submissions ensure that students do not miss out on potential financial aid opportunities or meet deadlines that could impact their ability to enroll in college.

9.Question

How can parents assist their children in managing the stress of college applications and financial aid processes?

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Answer:Parents can support their children by staying organized, providing encouragement, helping with paperwork, and discussing any financial obligations to help alleviate stress.

10.Question

What can families do to prepare for the discussions around the sensitive topics raised in the FAFSA?

Answer:Families can be proactive by having open conversations about finances, underlining the importance of education investment, and preparing together for the detailed information needed on the FAFSA.

Chapter 29 | H. Some Thoughts on Pacing, Time Management, and the Parallel Universe Where Life in High School Goes On| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of pacing during the college application process?

Answer:Pacing is crucial as it helps manage the workload, reducing stress and preventing procrastination. By setting mini-deadlines leading

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up to the main application deadline, students can break the process into manageable tasks, making it less overwhelming.

2.Question

How can parents effectively support their child during this intense application period?

Answer:Parents can act as executive coaches, helping their child create a structured timeline with interim deadlines.

They should also offer a supportive ear to address fears and anxieties, encouraging their child to manage tasks without feeling judged or overwhelmed.

3.Question

What strategies should be employed to ensure the quality of the application essays?

Answer:Students should read their essays multiple times with different objectives: checking for varied word choice, sentence length, and clarity of main ideas. Reading essays aloud can also help catch errors that might be overlooked on screen.

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4.Question

Why is it recommended to have a buffer period before application deadlines?

Answer: Having a buffer of at least forty-eight hours before deadlines is advised to account for technical issues or unexpected circumstances, allowing students to submit their applications confidently and without last-minute stress.

5.Question

What role does self-care play during this application phase?

Answer: Self-care is essential for maintaining energy and focus. It helps prevent fatigue, which can lead to mistakes and frustration. Taking breaks for social activities, rest, or relaxation is necessary to ensure mental clarity and productivity.

6.Question

How can students manage competing academic and application deadlines?

Answer: Maintaining a master calendar that includes school assignments alongside application deadlines allows students

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to visualize their obligations, helping them prioritize and allocate time effectively.

Chapter 30 | I. Ready to Submit| Q&A

1.Question

How should parents support their child right after they submit their college applications?

Answer:Parents can support their child by being attentive to their emotional state, whether they're feeling relieved or experiencing second thoughts. It's essential to provide reassurances, help them let go of past worries, and encourage them to engage in the present moment. This is also a chance to help them understand the importance of patience during the waiting period.

2.Question

What strategies can help a child cope with the anxiety of waiting for college decisions?

Answer:Encourage your child to return to a regular routine, offering time to reconnect with activities they enjoy. Assist

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them in shifting their focus away from anxiety about decisions by suggesting they engage in hobbies, spend time with friends, or explore new interests.

3.Question

Why is it important for parents to also take care of themselves during the college application process?

Answer:Parents should take time to step back and recharge, as the application process can be stressful. Neglecting their own emotional and mental well-being may lead to burnout. Focusing on self-care allows them to support their child more effectively during the waiting period.

4.Question

What is a meaningful milestone in the college application process that parents and students should acknowledge?

Answer:The completion and submission of the last college application is a significant milestone. It marks the end of a long journey filled with hard work, and it's vital for both parents and students to celebrate this achievement.

5.Question

How can parents help their child focus on the present

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during this transition period?

Answer: Parents can encourage their child to be mindful of the current moment, rather than worrying about past choices or future outcomes. This may involve participating in activities together, engaging in conversations about their feelings, or simply enjoying downtime as a family.

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Chapter 31 | A. Back Inside the Admissions Office: Conversations About the Applicants, and Building a Class| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of the American college admissions process compared to other countries?

Answer:The American college admissions process provides students with flexibility and choice that is largely absent in other countries, such as China, where a single exam determines university admission, or in Great Britain, where restrictions limit students to applying to only one prestigious institution per year. This allows for a more personalized approach to college selection, despite its unpredictability and stress for applicants.

2.Question

Why is it important for students to continually engage with their college admissions portals after submitting their applications?

Answer:Students should check their admissions portals

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regularly, ideally once a week, to ensure that all necessary materials—such as test scores, recommendations, and transcripts—have been received. This proactive behavior is crucial because missing materials can delay or jeopardize their admission chances.

3.Question

How has technology changed the college admissions review process since the late 20th century?

Answer: Technology has transformed the admissions review process by allowing applications to be submitted digitally, enabling faster compilation and review. Admissions officers can now evaluate applications collaboratively in real-time, using advanced software and dual monitors, which significantly streamlines the process compared to the past when applications were physical documents that required manual sorting.

4.Question

What is committee-based evaluation, and why is it beneficial in the admissions process?

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Answer:Committee-based evaluation allows admissions officers to review applications in pairs or teams rather than individually. This collaborative approach enhances the quality of the evaluation, as officers can discuss and highlight important aspects of an applicant's profile, resulting in a more comprehensive and balanced assessment.

5.Question

What is demonstrated interest, and how can it influence the admissions decision?

Answer:Demonstrated interest refers to the ways applicants show engagement with a college, such as attending recruitment events or responding to communications. This interest can be a crucial factor in admissions decisions, especially if candidates are on the borderline of acceptance, indicating a likelihood to enroll if admitted.

6.Question

In what ways do admissions officers seek to build a diverse class at highly selective universities?

Answer:Admissions officers consider a range of factors to

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ensure diversity, including students' academic interests, backgrounds, socioeconomic status, and experiences. They aim to create a community that reflects various identities and perspectives, enriching the campus environment and enhancing the educational experience.

7.Question

How does legacy status factor into the college admissions process?

Answer:Legacy status can be a consideration in admissions, recognizing students with familial connections to the institution. However, it is one of many factors considered, and having legacy status does not guarantee admission, as universities strive to balance tradition with the need for diverse and talented applicants.

8.Question

How do admissions officers assess an applicant's merit?

Answer:Merit is assessed holistically, incorporating grades, test scores, recommendations, extracurricular activities, and personal essays. Admissions officers contextualize these

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elements within the applicant's environment to gauge their potential and achievements, rather than relying solely on standardized testing.

9.Question

What ongoing discussions are shaping the future of the admissions process?

Answer:Conversations around equity in admissions, particularly those addressing barriers faced by students of color and low-income students, are ongoing. Groups like ACCEPT focus on identifying inequities and seeking solutions, indicating a movement towards a more inclusive and fair admissions process that acknowledges systemic challenges.

10.Question

What can families do to support their child's college application journey post-submittal?

Answer:Families can provide emotional support during this potentially stressful period, encourage their child to stay engaged in school, and assist in monitoring the admissions

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portals to ensure all materials are submitted properly. Staying informed and maintaining a positive outlook can help alleviate anxiety during the waiting period.

Chapter 32 | B. Back to the Kitchen Table: Sorting, Weighing, and Analyzing the Colleges' Decisions| Q&A

1.Question

What should families do to prepare for the college decision timeline in April?

Answer:Families should create a detailed calendar that includes important dates for religious or cultural holidays, tax deadlines, family commitments, and the dates for college admission decisions. This planning helps ensure that they can participate in admitted student events without conflicts.

2.Question

How can parents support their child when receiving college admissions decisions?

Answer:Parents should engage in conversations with their

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child about how they want to receive the news, offer emotional support regardless of the outcome, and be a calming presence. It's important to listen, comfort, and allow time for processing emotions.

3.Question

What advice is given for handling good news from college admissions?

Answer:Families are encouraged to celebrate the acceptance with dignity, avoiding sharing the news on social media immediately, considering the feelings of peers who may have received disappointing responses.

4.Question

What should families do if their child is placed on a waiting list?

Answer:Families should discuss the decision with their child whether they want to remain on the waiting list and assist them in confirming their interest, ideally within forty-eight hours. Providing any updates or additional information can be beneficial.

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5.Question

How can parents help their child process rejection from a college?

Answer:Parents should recognize the emotional impact of rejection, allow their child to express their feelings, and offer reassurance. They should frame the experience in a broader context, drawing parallels to other life challenges, and remind their child of their worth beyond college decisions.

6.Question

What does the book suggest regarding the timing of college decision acceptance?

Answer:The book advises that students should not wait until the last minute to make their college decision before the May 1 deadline. Instead, it's emphasized that families should be thoughtful and supportive during this decision-making process leading up to the deadline.

7.Question

Why might college admissions letters vary in their delivery methods?

Answer:Different colleges have various traditions and

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operational methods; for instance, some may still send physical acceptance packets while others use online portals. The timing of these notifications is carefully managed to ensure a smooth process for staff handling large volumes of decisions.

8.Question

What does 'celebrating with dignity' entail according to the author?

Answer:'Celebrating with dignity' means acknowledging achievements privately and being sensitive to peers who may be experiencing disappointment. It suggests a respectful approach to sharing good news while being mindful of others' feelings.

9.Question

What emotional challenges might come after receiving college acceptance letters?

Answer:After receiving acceptance, individuals might feel an anticlimactic sensation, realizing that their life hasn't drastically changed despite achieving a significant goal.

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Parents can help navigate these feelings by reinforcing that growth and future aspirations remain the same.

10.Question

How should parents deal with their own emotional reactions to their child's admissions results?

Answer:Parents should take a moment to process their own feelings, resist the urge to react impulsively, and keep the perspective that admissions decisions are subjective and do not reflect their child's overall value or their parenting.

Chapter 33 | C. Your Child Is Back in the Driver's Seat, with Decisions to Make| Q&A

1.Question

How can my child approach their college decision-making process effectively after receiving admission offers?

Answer:Your child should take a reflective approach by revisiting the materials and insights they've collected during their college search. Begin by reviewing their initial thoughts on the type of college environment they desire, as captured in their index card. Encourage them to reassess their Five

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I's—identity, intellect, ideas, interests, and inspiration—and match these with the Four C's—culture, curriculum, community, and conclusions—of the colleges they've applied to. This involves evaluating how each college aligns with their personal aspirations, leading to a well-rounded decision rather than a reactionary one.

2.Question

What important reminders should I give my child as they make their final college decision?

Answer:Remind your child that their decision isn't just about where to attend but about where they will thrive. Encourage them to reflect on why they wanted to attend college in the first place and how each potential college supports those goals. Discuss the importance of taking time to gather and analyze information about each option, rather than rushing into a decision out of fatigue or anxiety.

3.Question

Why is it crucial for my child to avoid snap decisions in the college selection process?

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Answer: Snap decisions can lead to regret and misalignment with their true goals and values. College is a significant investment in their future, and a thoughtful evaluation of their options—factoring in both emotional and rational perspectives—will help ensure they choose an environment conducive to their growth. Taking time allows them to reflect more deeply on their priorities and prevent impulsive choices driven by desires to simply finish the process.

4.Question

What strategies can facilitate a constructive discussion between parent and child about college choices?

Answer: Facilitate discussions through guided questioning that encourages your child to articulate their thoughts and feelings, such as asking, 'Which aspects of each college resonate most with you and why?' or 'What are your top priorities in choosing a college?' Additionally, share your observations on their journey while acknowledging their autonomy in this decision-making phase. This supports a collaborative approach where they feel empowered rather

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than pressured.

5.Question

How can campus visits influence my child's final decision?

Answer:Campus visits are an invaluable opportunity for your child to experience the college environment firsthand. They can gauge the atmosphere, meet potential peers and professors, and visualize themselves as part of that community. Encourage them to ask questions during visits that delve into academic and social cultures, as these interactions can shed light on which school aligns best with their personal and academic expectations.

6.Question

What role does self-reflection play in the college decision process?

Answer:Self-reflection is critical as it allows your child to evaluate their own needs, aspirations, and how they have changed throughout the application process. It encourages them to align their choices with their evolving identity and

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future goals, making their final decision more meaningful and relevant. Engaging in this introspection provides clarity, ensuring they choose a college that complements their vision for personal and academic achievement.

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Chapter 34 | Activity #10: Your Child Revisits Their Priorities as the College Choice Looms| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important for a child to revisit their priorities before making a college choice?

Answer:Revisiting priorities allows children to reflect on their growth and changing perspectives.

Six to nine months can lead to significant development, making former values potentially outdated. This reflection helps them ensure their eventual choice aligns with their current interests and life goals, leading to a more fulfilling college experience.

2.Question

What are some key categories a child should consider when refining their college priorities?

Answer:Children should consider several categories:

Environmental factors (size, location, distance from home), Academic interests (fields of study, flexibility in academic paths), Student life aspects (social activities, extracurricular

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engagement), and the 'X factor' (community involvement opportunities, support services, local culture and entertainment).

3.Question

How can parents effectively support their child during this reflection process?

Answer:Parents can support by encouraging independence in this exercise while also posing thoughtful prompts that guide the child to deeper insights. Parents might suggest discussing the reflections afterward, fostering an open dialogue that respects the child's autonomy yet provides valuable parental perspective.

4.Question

What should parents and children do after completing the reflection activity?

Answer:After reflection, they should bring out their current list of college options and evaluate these choices based on the newly refined priorities, ensuring their decisions reflect their personal growth and current aspirations.

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Chapter 35 | Activity #11: Mapping the Choice| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important to create a clean and uncluttered grid for mapping college choices?

Answer:A clean grid helps promote clearer decision-making by providing an organized way to visualize and compare various factors significant to each college.

2.Question

How can students effectively fill in the college choice grid using the Five C's and I's concept?

Answer:Students should reflect on how their identity, intellect, ideas, interests, and inspiration (the Five I's) intersect with each of the Five C's—culture, curriculum, community, conclusions, and cost for each college.

3.Question

What emotions might arise during the college decision-making process, and how should parents address them?

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Answer: Emotions such as anxiety or unease about leaving home or choosing a school may surface. Parents should encourage open conversations about these feelings and listen to their child's concerns deeply.

4.Question

What role does cost play in the college decision-making process?

Answer: Cost can be a determining factor for many families and may introduce tension. Students should note any financial aid offers and net prices to inform their choices and alleviate financial concerns.

5.Question

How can parents help their children use the time they have before making a college decision?

Answer: Parents should remind their children that they have time to reflect before making a decision and that using this time for thoughtful deliberation, along with breaks and self-care, can bring clarity.

6.Question

Why is it important for students to avoid rushing their

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final college choice?

Answer: Rushing can lead to decisions based on strong emotions rather than careful considerations. It's essential to take time to weigh all factors and ensure a well-informed choice.

7.Question

What advice is given about handling uncertainties in the college choice grid?

Answer: Students should note any gaps or uncertainties in their grid with questions that need further information, facilitating proactive discussions or research.

8.Question

In what ways might students' interests overlap in the Five C's categories?

Answer: Interests might overlap under culture (e.g., desire for Greek life), community (e.g., civic engagement), and curriculum (e.g., academic flexibility), reflecting their desire for a holistic college experience.

9.Question

How can students assure their decisions reflect their

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personal growth aspirations?

Answer: Students should be encouraged to view college as an opportunity for growth, embracing the unknown and challenging experiences rather than retreating to their comfort zones.

10.Question

What is the significance of a thoughtful decision-making process for both students and parents?

Answer: A thoughtful process ensures alignment between the student's values and the college's offerings, while also fostering a collaborative, supportive relationship between parents and children during this critical life transition.

Chapter 36 | D. Another Round of Due Diligence: Supporting Your Child as They Weigh Their Final Choices| Q&A

1.Question

How should parents support their child during the final decision-making process for college choices?

Answer: Parents should engage in open and honest conversations about their child's feelings and

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concerns, as well as their own. They might consider accompanying their child on campus visits while respecting their need for independence, or they can provide support through online resources if unable to travel. It's important to assess and discuss mental health support and academic resources available at each institution.

2.Question

What are the emotional dynamics for first-generation parents when their child is choosing a college?

Answer:First-generation parents may experience heightened anxiety about independence and safety, feeling worried about their child moving away. Providing reassurance that their sacrifices have led to great opportunities helps navigate these emotions.

3.Question

What qualities should be assessed when evaluating colleges during the final decision phase?

Answer:Parents and students should inquire about support

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services such as mental health resources, academic tutoring, campus safety, student engagement with faculty, and overall campus culture. Understanding the unique offerings of each institution is crucial to finding the right fit.

4.Question

What practical steps can a child take when visiting colleges?

Answer:During campus visits, students should adopt a journalistic approach: ask current students about engagement opportunities, assess the campus environment, and observe how students balance academics and social life. They should take their time and refrain from making immediate decisions.

5.Question

How can families factor financial aid into the college decision-making process?

Answer:Families should carefully review financial aid packages, considering the total cost of attendance and any unexpected expenses that may arise, ensuring that the financial aspect aligns with their long-term goals and budget.

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6.Question

What should students keep in mind when looking for clarity in their college choice?

Answer:Students should recognize that a 'defining moment of clarity' is unlikely. They should be prepared for the decision-making process to take time, allowing for reflection after campus visits before finalizing their choice.

7.Question

Why is it important to inquire about mental health support at colleges?

Answer:With rising mental health concerns among college students, understanding the campus's prioritization of mental health resources and access can significantly impact a student's well-being and academic success.

8.Question

What should parents remember about their role in the final college decision?

Answer:Parents need to support their child in this process, while recognizing that it is ultimately the child's decision. They can guide and ask important questions but should also

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allow their child to explore and express their own preferences.

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Chapter 37 | E. Factoring Financial Aid into the Final Decision| Q&A

1.Question

What should families consider when reviewing a financial aid package?

Answer:Families should carefully evaluate the components of the financial aid package, including need-based aid (grants and scholarships), work-study opportunities, and loans. It's essential to compare the 'cost of attendance' (COA) and understand how much financial aid helps reduce that cost.

2.Question

How can families compare different financial aid offers?

Answer:Using resources like the 'Financial Aid Comparison Worksheet' from ScholarMatch, families can create a visual comparison of each institution's offers regarding costs, grants, scholarships, and other financial aid components. This organized approach facilitates informed decision-making.

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3.Question

What advice did Ariana Campos give regarding interactions with financial aid offices?

Answer:Ariana emphasized the importance of persistence in contacting the financial aid office. She suggested that maintaining communication can make the process more personal and helps staff to feel motivated to assist.

4.Question

How can families advocate for a better financial aid package?

Answer:Families may need to contact the financial aid office if they believe their award does not meet their financial circumstances. This could include providing documentation of competing offers or sharing new financial information. It's important to be prepared for differing responses based on the institution's policies.

5.Question

What role might a college counselor play during the financial aid process?

Answer:A college counselor can provide guidance and

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support while families navigate financial aid offers. They can help interpret financial aid letters and strategize any appeals or inquiries regarding aid.

6.Question

What are the potential long-term financial implications of student loans for graduates?

Answer:On average, graduates who receive financial aid may graduate with around \$30,000 in student loan debt, typically requiring monthly payments of about \$350 over ten years. It's important for families to consider these future responsibilities when evaluating the total cost of education.

7.Question

What should families know about nonrefundable deposits in relation to financial aid?

Answer:A nonrefundable deposit confirms a student's intention to enroll and can range significantly in amount. For those receiving substantial financial aid, there's an opportunity to request a waiver for this deposit, while for others, it will simply be deducted from their total cost of

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attendance.

8.Question

What should families discuss if their child is still on a waiting list?

Answer:If a child remains on a waiting list, families should have an open conversation about the implications, potentially considering backup plans or alternatives in case an acceptance does not come through.

9.Question

What considerations might be relevant for families thinking about a gap year?

Answer:Families need to assess the implications of a gap year, including how it might affect the college application process, financial aid availability, and the overall academic trajectory.

Chapter 38 | F. If Your Child Remains on a Waiting List| Q&A

1.Question

What should my child do after being placed on a waitlist for college acceptance?

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Answer: Your child should quickly notify the college of their interest in remaining on the waitlist.

Additionally, they should complete any online forms provided to update their application with new information such as grades or extracurricular achievements, which will be directly added to their application.

2.Question

How can my child show continued interest to the college while on the waitlist?

Answer: Your child can express their ongoing interest in the college through the required update form or a brief email, stating how much they value the opportunity and why they would choose to attend if offered a place.

3.Question

What should my child consider if they are still on a waitlist as important deadlines approach?

Answer: As deadlines near, particularly by the end of April, your child must decide to secure a spot at another institution

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where they have been accepted. Waiting too long might mean forfeiting their deposit at the other school.

4.Question

What happens if my child is offered a spot off the waitlist after committing to another college?

Answer:If your child gets off the waitlist and wishes to attend that college, they should inform the first college of their decision to withdraw. However, they should be aware that they will likely lose their deposit.

5.Question

What is the timeline for waitlisted students to receive final decisions from colleges?

Answer:Most colleges finalize their first-year class by July 1, and those who remain on the waitlist will be officially informed if the waitlist is closing at that time.

6.Question

How can my child best prepare for the possibility of being in limbo while on a waitlist?

Answer:Encourage your child to stay proactive by keeping up with academic performance, participating in new

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extracurricular activities, and remaining in good communication with the colleges they are considering.

Chapter 39 | G. For Those Students Considering a Gap Year| Q&A

1.Question

What considerations should students take into account when deciding to take a gap year?

Answer:Students should consider their personal reasons for taking a gap year, such as cultural or religious commitments, military service, community service, or entrepreneurial ventures. Additionally, they should evaluate their financial needs, the benefits of real-world experience, and the potential impact on their college readiness and career direction.

2.Question

How does research support the decision to take a gap year?

Answer:Research indicates that students who take a gap year tend to have higher rates of advancement from the first to the

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second year of college, as well as higher graduation rates, suggesting that the experiences gained during the year can provide a valuable perspective and preparation for higher education.

3.Question

What are some organizations that offer gap year programs?

Answer:Several organizations provide gap year programs, including for-profit companies and nonprofits like Global Citizen Year, which offers immersive international experiences and scholarships for those who qualify based on need.

4.Question

What is the process for deferring college enrollment for a gap year?

Answer:To defer college enrollment for a gap year, a student must first accept an offer of admission from their chosen college or university, then formally request in writing to defer their enrollment, explaining their reasons and plans for

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the gap year.

5.Question

What financial aid options are available for students considering a gap year?

Answer:Students can often use the same FAFSA form they completed for college financial aid to apply for funding to support their gap year activities. Additionally, scholarships may be available from organizations that specialize in gap year programs.

6.Question

What might be some reasons why students feel burned out before starting college?

Answer:Students may feel burned out due to the pressures of academic performance, college admissions stress, and general fatigue from the demands of their high school experience, leading them to seek a rejuvenating break before embarking on their college journey.

7.Question

How can a gap year lead to personal growth and new skills?

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Answer: A gap year can provide unique opportunities for personal growth as students engage in diverse experiences such as volunteering, travelling, or starting a business, all of which can develop skills in leadership, adaptability, and cultural awareness.

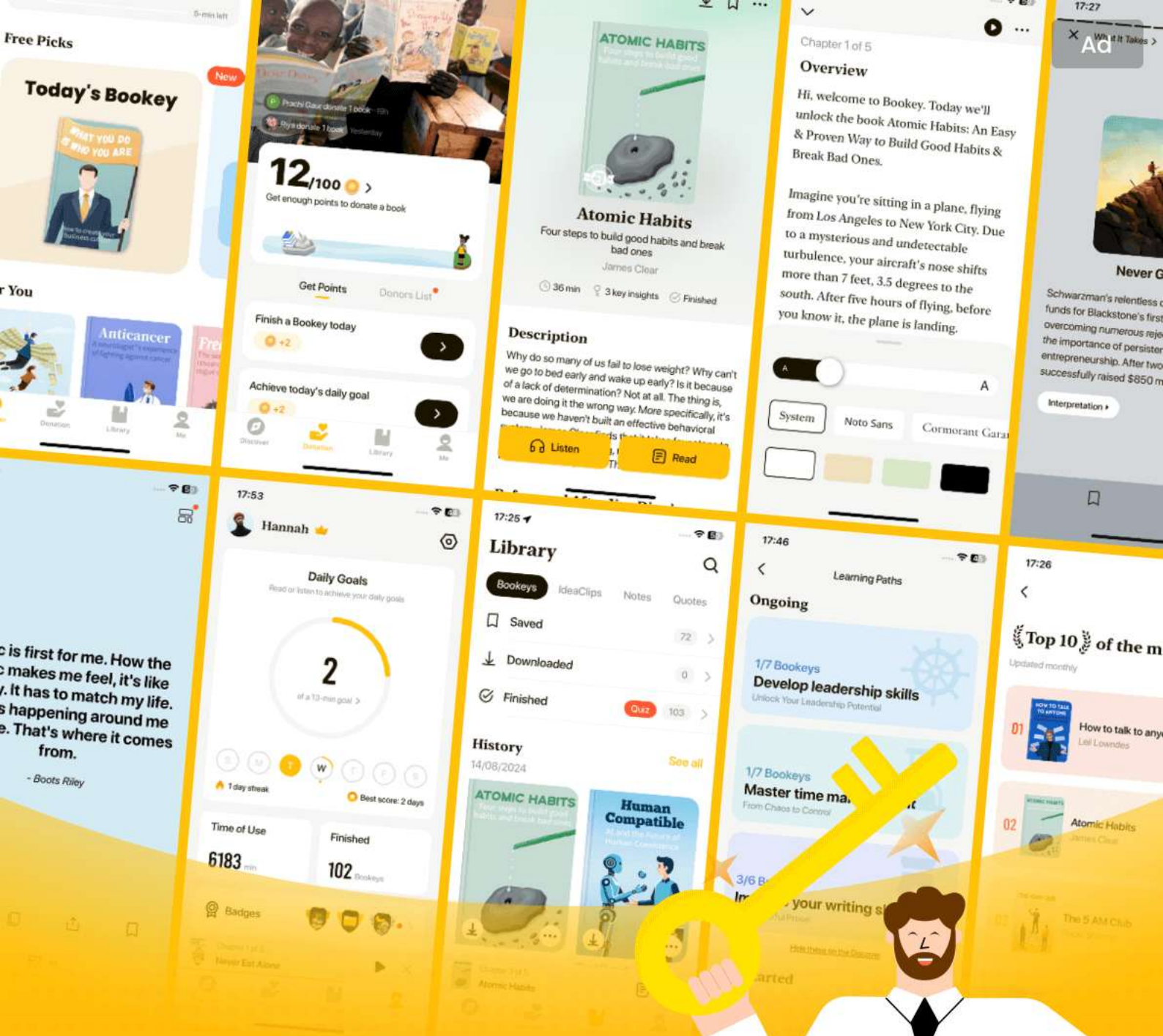
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Chapter 40 | Activity #12: Narrowing the Field| Q&A

1.Question

What is the most effective way for a child to begin narrowing down their college choices?

Answer:Start with a visual method, such as using a grid to categorize and rank colleges based on criteria that matter most to the child, like curriculum, financial aid, and community. Utilize a traffic light system (green for strong choices, yellow for neutral, red for reservations) to make distinctions clearer.

2.Question

How should emotions be managed during the college decision process?

Answer:Be mindful of both your child's and your own emotions regarding cost and choice, ensuring open discussions about feelings. If stress arises, encourage taking breaks to maintain a calm mind, allowing clearer decision-making.

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3.Question

What criteria should a child consider when evaluating the academic offerings of colleges?

Answer:Beyond just checking if their desired major is available, they should consider the breadth of academic programs, the general education requirements, and the ability to take electives that interest them.

4.Question

Why is it important to avoid last-minute decisions on college acceptance?

Answer:Waiting until the last moment can lead to technical issues like system overloads, and the stress surrounding deadlines can cloud judgment, potentially resulting in regret over hastily made choices.

5.Question

What steps should a child take when they feel overwhelmed by the decision process?

Answer:They should pause, take breaks, and reflect on their choices without pressure. A helpful technique is to visualize themselves as a student at each college to assess their

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feelings about each option.

6.Question

How can parents help their child balance their input during the college decision process?

Answer:Parents should provide their perspective while allowing the child to have ownership over their choices.

Acknowledge the child's autonomy in making their decision while being supportive and involved.

7.Question

What final actions should a child take after making their college choice?

Answer:After deciding, they should visualize their future at the college and then confidently communicate their decision, taking time to reflect on it to avoid any regret and embrace the excitement of their new journey.

Chapter 41 | I. The Moments Immediately After the Decision| Q&A

1.Question

What should you encourage your child to do right after making their college decision?

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Answer: Encourage your child to celebrate their decision but also to take some time for themselves before sharing it on social media. It's important for them to process their emotions privately.

2.Question

Why might a child feel feelings of letdown or anticlimax after deciding on a college?

Answer: These feelings are common due to the societal pressure and high expectations surrounding the college process, which can create a sense of anticlimax once the decision is made.

3.Question

How should parents handle their child's second-guessing after they make a college decision?

Answer: Parents should reassure their child that second-guessing is normal and help them remember the careful thought that went into their choice.

4.Question

What should a parent do if their child expresses deep regret about their college decision?

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Answer: If regret intensifies, parents should explore whether the anxiety is about the specific choice or about college itself. They might consider involving a college counselor in the discussion.

5.Question

What advice can parents give to their child if they struggle with acceptance about not getting into their dream school?

Answer: Parents should help their child accept their decision and emphasize the importance of embracing the opportunities at the chosen school. They should prepare for the transition and make the most of the upcoming experience.

6.Question

What should parents do if their child feels they made the wrong choice in selecting a college?

Answer: Determine the root of their anxiety—whether it's about the choice itself or a general fear of attending college. If necessary, involve a college counselor for additional support and reassurance.

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Chapter 42 | A. On the Importance of Your Child's Finishing High School Strong| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it crucial for students to remain focused during the final weeks of high school?

Answer:Remaining focused during the final weeks of high school is crucial because it strengthens their academic standing and ensures compliance with the college's admission requirements, which typically require students to maintain good academic performance until graduation.

2.Question

What are the possible consequences of a decline in academic performance after a student has committed to a college?

Answer:If a student's academic performance declines after committing to a college, they risk having their admission offer rescinded. This can happen if their final transcript shows significant drops in grades or if they fail to graduate.

3.Question

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How can parents help their children stay engaged during the end of their high school careers?

Answer: Parents can help by encouraging students to participate in academic, extracurricular, and community activities, while also reminding them of the importance of maintaining their commitment to their education as they conclude high school.

4.Question

What key document should students review with their parents, and why?

Answer: Students should review their enrollment agreement with their parents to acknowledge their commitment and responsibility to uphold the academic and behavioral standards set by the college.

5.Question

How does social media impact a student's admission status?

Answer: Social media can impact an admission status negatively if students post inappropriate content that might

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be shared with admission offices, potentially jeopardizing their accepted status.

6.Question

What steps should a student take if their academic performance takes a downturn unexpectedly?

Answer:If their performance declines, students should communicate with their college's admissions office promptly, usually providing a written explanation of the circumstances to prevent jeopardizing their admission offer.

7.Question

What is the role of the college counselor in a student's final year of high school?

Answer:The college counselor's role includes uploading the final transcript to the admissions portal, confirming the student's graduation status and grades, which are critical for the finalization of their admission.

8.Question

What proactive measures can students take to secure their admission status?

Answer:Students can maintain good academic performance,

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engage in responsible community behavior, and avoid risky behavior on social media to secure their admission status.

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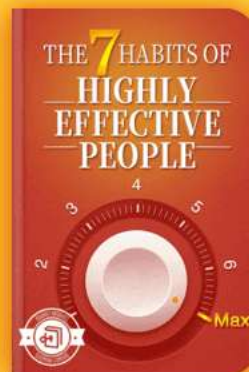
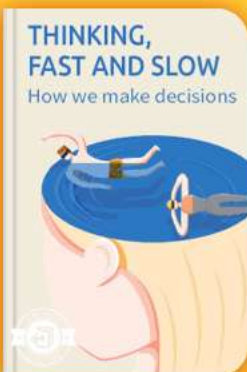


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Chapter 43 | B. Decisions and Actions Between Your Child's High School Graduation and Their Arrival at College| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of setting up a student identification and portal after high school graduation?

Answer:Setting up a student identification and portal is crucial because it serves as your child's main gateway to access various academic services, register for classes, obtain a student ID card, and receive official communications from the university. This initial step lays the groundwork for their entire college experience.

2.Question

How can participating in social media groups benefit incoming college students?

Answer:Joining Facebook and other social media groups allows incoming students to connect with their peers, share experiences, gather information about orientation activities, and form a sense of community before even stepping on

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campus. It fosters early relationships and support networks, which can ease the transition.

3.Question

What considerations should students make when choosing their roommate?

Answer:Students should consider lifestyle habits such as sleep patterns, cleanliness, and study habits when choosing a roommate. Filling out a roommate survey can help match them with someone compatible, leading to a more harmonious living situation.

4.Question

Why is it important to ensure financial aid is applied before attending college?

Answer:Ensuring financial aid is applied is critical because it directly affects your child's ability to register for classes. Any outstanding tuition may prevent them from enrolling in their desired courses, making this a vital step in the transition process.

5.Question

What immunizations and health records should be

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prioritized before college?

Answer: Students must provide proof of required immunizations and health records, such as recent physical exams, before they can register for classes. Planning appointments early is essential to meet these requirements on time.

6.Question

How can students find out about academic support services at their college?

Answer: Students should explore the college or university's health and wellness and support services, which may include academic advising, mental health resources, and financial literacy programs, to ensure they are aware of the help available to them.

7.Question

What role does an academic adviser play in a student's college journey?

Answer: An academic adviser assists students in understanding academic requirements, selecting courses that

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fulfill their degree requirements, and navigating the university system. They can provide guidance tailored to the student's interests and goals.

8.Question

Why should students participate in orientation activities before classes start?

Answer:Orientation activities are designed to acclimate students to campus life, introduce them to resources, and help them meet fellow classmates. Engaging in these activities can ease anxiety and foster a sense of belonging.

9.Question

How can students seek accommodations for learning differences in college?

Answer:Students who require academic accommodations should proactively contact the college's appropriate office, provide necessary documentation, and discuss their needs, ensuring they have the support required for a successful educational experience.

10.Question

What emotions might students and parents experience

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during the transition to college?

Answer: The transition can evoke a range of emotions such as excitement, anxiety, sadness, and pride for both students and parents. It's important for families to communicate openly about these feelings to navigate the change together.

Chapter 44 | C. Conversations About Laying a Foundation for Success| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of the 'Momentum Year' in a student's college experience?

Answer: The 'Momentum Year' refers to the crucial first year in college, which heavily influences a student's ability to transition successfully to subsequent years. Studies show that those who advance from the first to the second year are significantly more likely to graduate—whether within four or six years. Thus, creating a solid foundation in this period can have lasting impacts on a student's educational path.

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2.Question

How can students build relationships with faculty and peers during their first year?

Answer:Students should actively seek out professors and establish relationships by attending office hours and participating in campus programs that foster connections. Engaging in conversations with faculty outside classroom settings helps students feel more connected and supported within the campus community.

3.Question

What role does time management play in a college student's success?

Answer:Effective time management is critical in college where students have substantial unstructured time compared to high school. Students should learn to organize their schedule, break assignments into manageable tasks, and seek resources if they struggle. This helps minimize stress and enhances academic performance.

4.Question

What types of extracurricular activities should students

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consider during their first year?

Answer: Students should engage in extracurricular activities to build a sense of community and widen their social circles. Participating in clubs or organizations helps combat homesickness and enriches their college experience beyond academics.

5.Question

How can students take care of their health and well-being in college?

Answer: Maintaining a balanced lifestyle through adequate sleep (7-9 hours), nutrition, and regular exercise (30 minutes daily) is essential for college success. Students should utilize available campus resources such as fitness programs and nutrition consultations to help establish these healthy habits.

6.Question

How can students navigate the financial aspects of college, including budgeting and work?

Answer: Students should create a realistic budget considering their income from part-time work, school expenses, and

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discretionary spending. It's essential to balance work commitments with academic demands to avoid negatively impacting GPA. Work-study programs offer a great opportunity to earn while studying.

7.Question

How should students cope with academic challenges and failures?

Answer:Students should view academic challenges as opportunities for growth and learning. Embracing setbacks and seeking help from professors and academic resources can foster resilience. It's vital to remind them that struggles are a common part of the learning process.

8.Question

What support is available for mental health challenges faced by college students?

Answer:Colleges often provide comprehensive mental health services including counseling, peer support, and stress management programs. It's important to encourage students to seek help if they experience anxiety, depression, or any

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mental health challenges.

9.Question

How can parents support their child's transition to college successfully?

Answer:Parents can play a vital role by initiating conversations about success definitions, encouraging relationship-building, maintaining open lines of communication, and understanding their child's experiences concerning academic and personal challenges.

10.Question

What is the significance of 'imposter syndrome' among first-generation college students?

Answer:Imposter syndrome can cause anxiety and feelings of unworthiness among students who may doubt their place in college. It's crucial to reassure them of their capabilities and remind them that they were chosen to be there for a reason, encouraging them to embrace their journey with confidence.

Chapter 45 | D. Drop-off, Departure, and Check-in Points Thereafter| Q&A

1.Question

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How can parents effectively communicate with their college-bound children during the transition period?

Answer: Parents should establish clear ground rules for communication, discussing frequency and methods of contact. They can use technology to keep in touch but should also give their child the space to handle their independence and challenges.

2.Question

What should parents remember about their child's new college schedule?

Answer: Parents should understand that their child's routine will be vastly different from high school; they may have classes at odd hours and need to adapt to new responsibilities, which may not allow for family dinners or consistent schedules.

3.Question

What role can parents play when their child discusses college classes and activities?

Answer: Parents can act as sounding boards for their child,

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listening to their thoughts and concerns about classes and extracurricular activities while encouraging them to make decisions independently.

4.Question

Why is it important for parents to observe changes in their child during the first visit home after college?

Answer:Parents should be attuned to changes in their child's opinions, behavior, and sleep patterns after their first semester at college, recognizing these as signs of growth and independence while responding calmly.

5.Question

What strategies can parents use to check in with their college students?

Answer:Parents can schedule regular check-in times while also allowing for periods of space. They should be attentive to their child's mood and be prepared to have deeper conversations based on their observations.

6.Question

What can family weekends at college offer to parents and students?

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Answer: Family weekends can provide a valuable opportunity for parents to reconnect with their child, understand their college life, and meet their friends, enhancing the parental perspective of student life.

7.Question

What should parents do if their child is unable to come home for Thanksgiving?

Answer: Parents should be understanding if their child cannot return home for Thanksgiving, recognizing that distance and class schedules may impact their ability to visit.

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Chapter 46 | E. The (Potential) Transfer Conversation| Q&A

1.Question

What should parents consider when their child expresses discontent with their current college choice?

Answer: Parents should first assess the underlying reasons for their child's desire to transfer by asking specific questions related to the environmental, academic, student life, and 'X factor' aspects of their college experience. They must consider changes in their child's preferences or circumstances since their initial decision, using past reflections from activities that guided their college search.

2.Question

When discussing the possibility of transferring, what are some pivotal questions parents can ask their children?

Answer: 1. Environmental: What aspects of the college's location or size are no longer appealing to you and why? 2.

Academic: How do you feel about the academic environment? Are students competitive or disengaged? 3.

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Student Life: Have you formed meaningful friendships, and are you engaged in activities that bring you joy? 4. X Factor: Is the unique niche or opportunity that attracted you to this college still of interest? If not, why?

3.Question

How can a parent help their child if they are unhappy at their current college?

Answer:Parents can guide their child to develop an action plan while allowing time to explore possible solutions at their current college, such as joining new clubs or seeking academic support services. They should encourage self-reflection on whether the concerns can be addressed before considering a transfer.

4.Question

What might indicate that a child is seriously considering a transfer?

Answer:Strong indications include a persistent sense of unhappiness, repeated conversations about dissatisfaction, a lack of engagement with friends and activities, or feeling that

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their academic needs are unmet despite available resources.

5.Question

What should parents do if their child is determined to explore transfer options?

Answer:If a child is set on transferring, parents should assist in researching prospective colleges, transfer application processes, and the implications on financial aid. They can also help facilitate a discussion about what the transfer might achieve for their child.

6.Question

Why is it important to differentiate between running from something versus running toward something in the context of considering a transfer?

Answer:Understanding whether a child is running from something undesirable or toward a clearly defined goal can provide insight into their motivations and aspirations. This distinction helps in guiding them more effectively in their decision-making process.

7.Question

What is the purpose of the reflective exercises mentioned

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for parents and their children?

Answer: The reflective exercises serve to reassess the factors that influenced their initial college decision, reinforcing a clearer understanding of what is truly important to the child in their college experience.

8.Question

What options should parents be aware of if their child chooses not to return to campus?

Answer: Parents should be informed about options like taking a leave of absence or withdrawal, along with understanding the potential impact of these decisions on academic standing and financial aid.

Chapter 47 | Activity #13: Back to the Future: Revisiting Those I's and C's from Your Child's First Round of College Decision-Making| Q&A

1.Question

What is the significance of understanding that many students transfer colleges rather than drop out?

Answer: It illustrates that transferring is a common and often positive step in a student's academic

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journey, allowing students to find a better fit for their educational needs and goals.

2.Question

What does Marie Bigham mean when she says, 'Transfer is not failure'?

Answer: This statement highlights that changing colleges can be a strategic decision to improve one's educational experience and success, rather than a sign of inadequacy or defeat.

3.Question

How can students benefit from reflecting on what they know now compared to a year ago?

Answer: This reflection allows students to recognize their personal growth, clarify their academic values, and make more informed decisions regarding their college paths.

4.Question

Why is it important for a child to keep their transfer application process somewhat private?

Answer: Keeping the process private can reduce pressure and anxiety; it protects the child from potential disappointment if

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they do not get accepted, or if they choose to remain at their current college.

5.Question

What are the two main pillars of the transfer application process?

Answer:The two main pillars are the need for appropriate documentation (such as transcripts and recommendations) and maintaining strong academic performance in current college courses.

6.Question

Why is the transfer application essay so crucial?

Answer:The essay serves as a vital platform for students to communicate their reasons for transferring, express how the new institution aligns better with their educational goals, and provide insight into their personal journey.

7.Question

How can reviewing existing college credits impact a student's decision to transfer?

Answer:Understanding which credits will transfer is key; it can affect how many additional courses a student will need to

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take to graduate, influencing whether the move to a new institution is strategically beneficial.

8.Question

How should a child evaluate their transfer options when receiving acceptance letters?

Answer:They should compare each college's academic offerings, the transferability of their credits, the overall fit with their goals, and weigh the benefits against their experiences at their current school.

9.Question

What insights might a student gain from the transfer application process even if they decide to stay at their current institution?

Answer:The process can bring clarity to their values and academic goals, as well as highlight the things they appreciate or wish to change in their current environment, leading to a more focused and purposeful college experience.

10.Question

What should a student consider when crafting a new college list for transfer applications?

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Answer: They should focus on a concise list that aligns with their current interests and academic goals, seek guidance from resources available at their current institution, and leverage their experiences to find a better fit.

Chapter 48 | F. Another Potential Transfer Conversation: From Community College to a Traditional Four-Year College or University| Q&A

1.Question

What are some important steps a community college student should take if they plan to transfer to a four-year college?

Answer: Students should determine the necessary steps early in their community college experience, such as registering for appropriate classes that qualify them for a bachelor's degree. Researching transfer opportunities, contacting college counselors, and utilizing resources like transfer coordinators and established agreements between community colleges and four-year institutions is crucial.

2.Question

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Why is it significant that 55 percent of bachelor's degree earners initially attended community colleges according to the statistics from the 2014-15 academic year?

Answer: This statistic highlights the viability of community colleges as a foundational step towards earning a bachelor's degree, showcasing that many successful students use this pathway to achieve their educational goals. It emphasizes the importance of recognizing the diverse routes to higher education.

3.Question

What are some resources parents and students can utilize when considering a transfer from community college?

Answer: Parents and students can reach out to high school counselors, community college transfer coordinators, and admission officers at prospective four-year institutions.

Additional resources include the book 'Building Transfer Student Pathways for College and Career Success' and websites like the National Institute for the Study of Transfer Students and the Community College Research Center.

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4.Question

How should students prepare for a potential restart of their education after a pause?

Answer:Students should assess their previous credits, research potential transfer institutions, and contact relevant personnel at their community college or prospective schools to understand the requirements for their intended program of study. Determining a clear path demonstrates commitment to their educational journey.

5.Question

What can be the impact of communication with former counselors or advisors during the transfer process?

Answer:Reconnecting with former counselors or advisors can provide personalized guidance, support, and insights into the transfer process. Their experience and knowledge of pathways can help students navigate options that are often complex and varied.

6.Question

In what ways can the websites suggested in the chapter assist students?

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Answer: These websites offer a wealth of information regarding transfer processes, resources for students and educators, and links to additional helpful organizations. They serve as pivotal tools for understanding the landscape of transferring from community college to four-year institutions.

7.Question

What role do articulation agreements play in transferring from community college to four-year institutions?

Answer: Articulation agreements outline the transfer policies between community colleges and four-year institutions, ensuring that students smoothly transfer credits towards their bachelor's degree. This dedicated pathway simplifies the academic transition and supports students in planning their course selections effectively.

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Alex Walk

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The College Conversation Quiz and Test

Check the Correct Answer on Bookey Website

Chapter 1 | A. The “Why College?” Conversation| Quiz and Test

- 1.The lifetime earnings potential of a bachelor's degree holder is approximately \$2.4 million more than those with only a high school diploma.
- 2.Students must create a solid plan for community colleges as their graduation rates are generally high.
- 3.Military service completely cancels out educational opportunities for veterans.

Chapter 2 | Activity #1: Jotting Down a Few Key Attributes on an Index Card| Quiz and Test

- 1.The exercise encourages parents and children to reflect on the attributes of a college experience that may appeal to them individually.
- 2.During the activity, parents should focus on their own college experiences and preferences rather than those of their child.

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3.The goal of the exercise is to immediately resolve any disagreements about the college selection process.

Chapter 3 | C. Rules of the Road: Establishing Guardrails for Your Role as a Parent| Quiz and Test

- 1.Parents should create communication guidelines for discussing college with their children to avoid overwhelm.
- 2.It is advised for parents to share all details regarding their child's college process with extended family and friends.
- 3.Parents should only discuss college choices during stressful times to ensure the conversation's intensity matches the importance of the topic.

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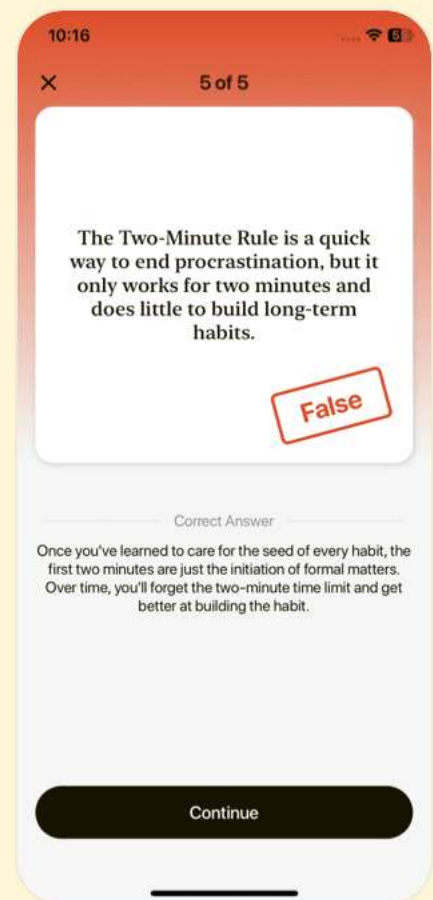
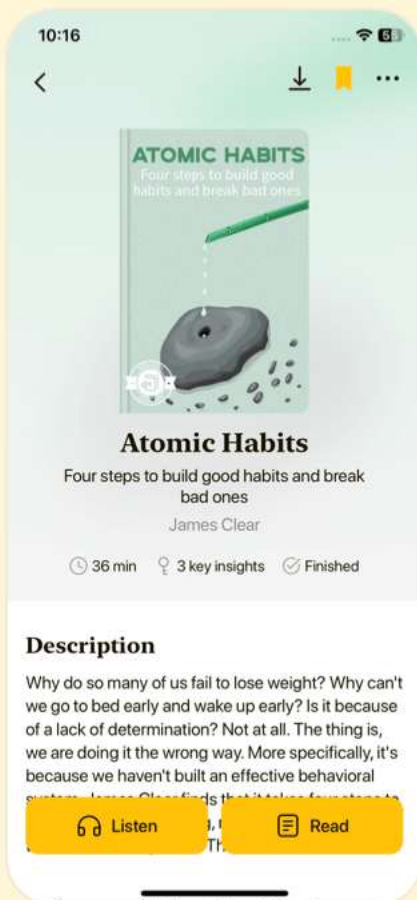


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Chapter 4 | Activity #2: The Five I's| Quiz and Test

- 1.The Five I's activity includes a focus on identity, intellect, ideas, interests, and inspiration.
- 2.The insights gained from the Five I's activity are not useful for college applications.
- 3.Encouraging your child to reflect on their interests is not part of the Five I's activity.

Chapter 5 | E. Behind the Admissions Office Door: A Brief Primer on the Holistic Admissions Process (And the Ultimate Audience for Your Child's Application)| Quiz and Test

- 1.Colleges use a holistic admissions process that only considers test scores and GPAs when evaluating students.
- 2.Parents can help their children understand the alignment between their academic profiles and the profiles of accepted students at potential colleges.
- 3.The Common Data Set provides information about test score bands for all admitted students, including insight into the middle 50 percent of scores.

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Chapter 6 | Activity #3: The Four C's| Quiz and Test

- 1.The Four C's framework includes Culture, Curriculum, Community, and Connections.
- 2.It's important to assess the campus community by recognizing physical spaces that foster interaction among students.
- 3.Investigating a college's historical context is unnecessary when evaluating its mission and values.

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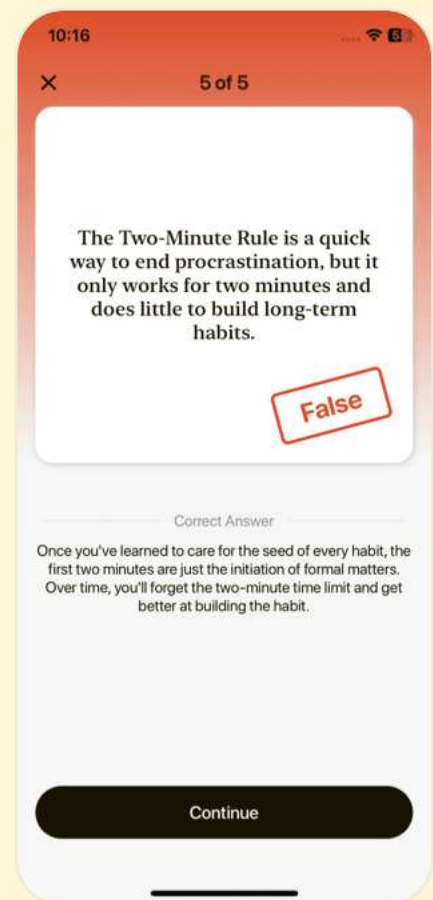
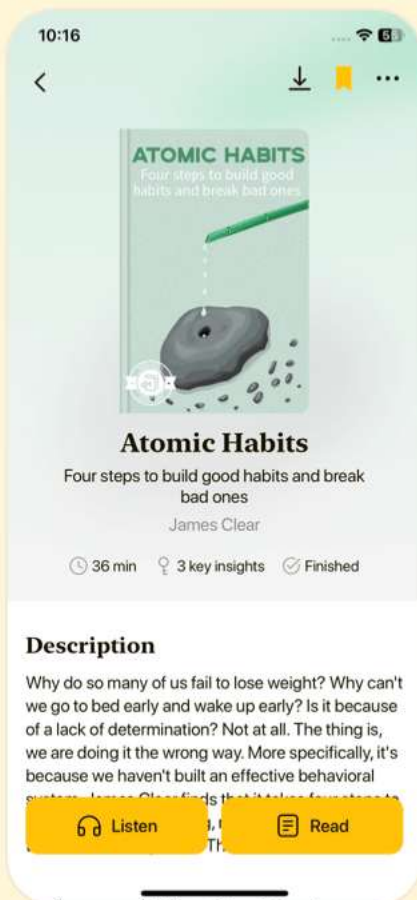


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Chapter 7 | B. A Word About Fit (And Please Note: It Won't Be Perfect)| Quiz and Test

- 1.The concept of 'fit' is essential in the college selection process, and it's expected to find the perfect college for every student.
- 2.Students should identify and rank their desired college attributes, similar to the home-buying process, which may require compromises.
- 3.Parents should discourage their children from considering colleges that are located far from home due to concerns such as safety and financial impact.

Chapter 8 | C. Adding Other Voices to the Conversation| Quiz and Test

- 1.The College Conversation should only involve parents and children.
- 2.Engaging with a college counselor is important for keeping track of college-related dates and expectations.
- 3.Community-based organizations (CBOs) provide no support for students from underrepresented backgrounds.

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Chapter 9 | D. The Fifth C: Cost| Quiz and Test

1. Families should discuss financial considerations before creating a college list.
2. It is advisable to keep the financial discussion private among parents and the child to avoid distractions.
3. All colleges provide merit-based financial aid to every student who applies.

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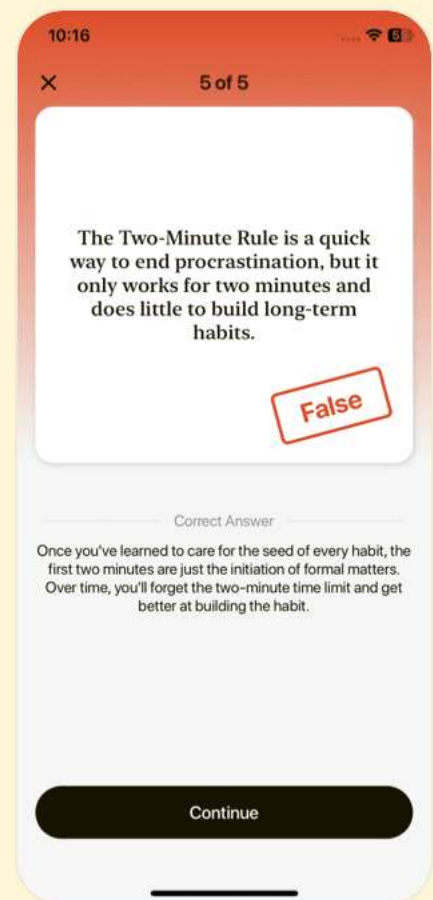
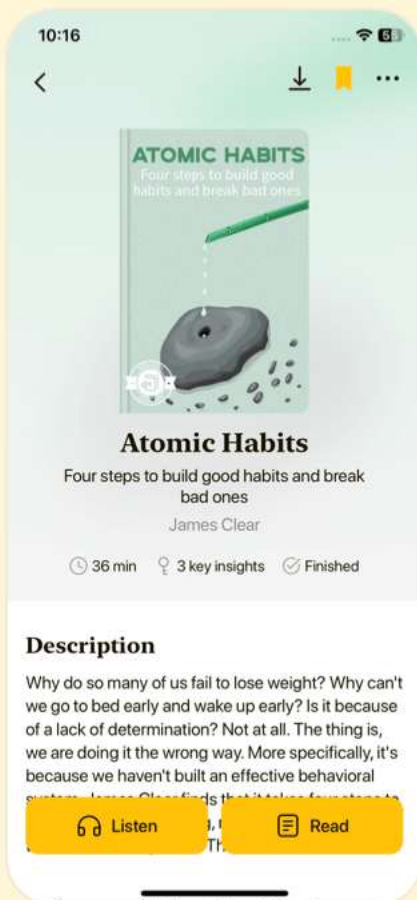


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Chapter 10 | E. Helping Your Child Build a College List| Quiz and Test

- 1.The average number of applications submitted via the Common Application is five.
- 2.Students should aim to prepare applications for twenty colleges to maximize their chances of acceptance.
- 3.A 'Likely' college, or safety school, is one where the student's scores are lower than the seventy-fifth percentile of admitted students.

Chapter 11 | Activity #4: The College List| Quiz and Test

- 1.Creating a college list should be done collaboratively between parents and children.
- 2.The legal pad or spreadsheet used for drafting the college list should include only one category for schools.
- 3.Using the five C's is an advisable practice for evaluating individual colleges during the research process.

Chapter 12 | F. Conversations About Learning Style| Quiz and Test

- 1.Understanding your child's learning style is not

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important when considering potential colleges.

2.Larger college institutions may overwhelm some students, while smaller colleges feel too intimate.

3.Academic support services available on campus are irrelevant to a student's success in college.

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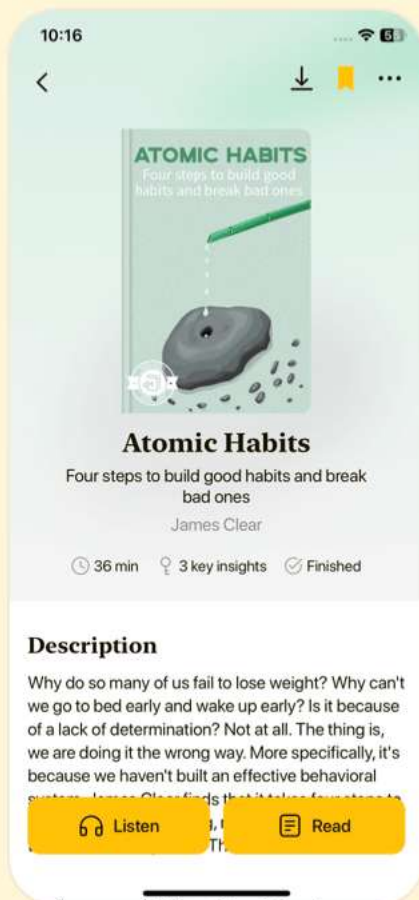


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Chapter 13 | G. Some Thoughts on Standardized Testing| Quiz and Test

1. Standardized test scores hold comparable weight to high school course rigor and grades in the holistic admissions process.
2. A growing number of selective institutions do not require SAT or ACT scores because they believe it enhances the admissions process for underrepresented students.
3. Research shows that taking standardized tests more than three times will significantly improve students' scores.

Chapter 14 | H. Your Child's Background (And How It Might Factor into Their Search)| Quiz and Test

1. Colleges often use affirmative action to build a diverse student body by considering race in admissions.
2. Parents should discourage their children from exploring how colleges value diverse perspectives in the admissions process.
3. It is essential for students from minority backgrounds to understand the experiences of others from similar

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backgrounds when considering a college.

Chapter 15 | I. Interests and Talents Developed Over Time| Quiz and Test

- 1.A child's interests and talents can guide their college search.
- 2.Students should contact multiple faculty members within a department to gather more information about college programs.
- 3.Prospective athletes do not need to follow any guidelines when contacting colleges about sports.

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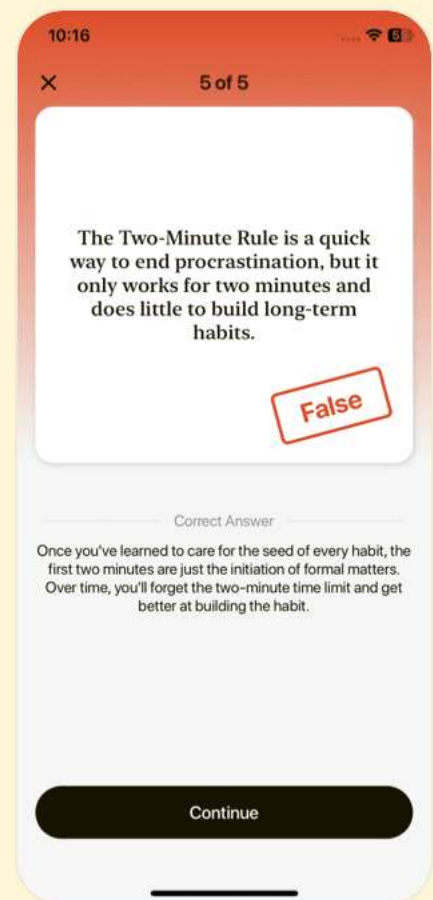
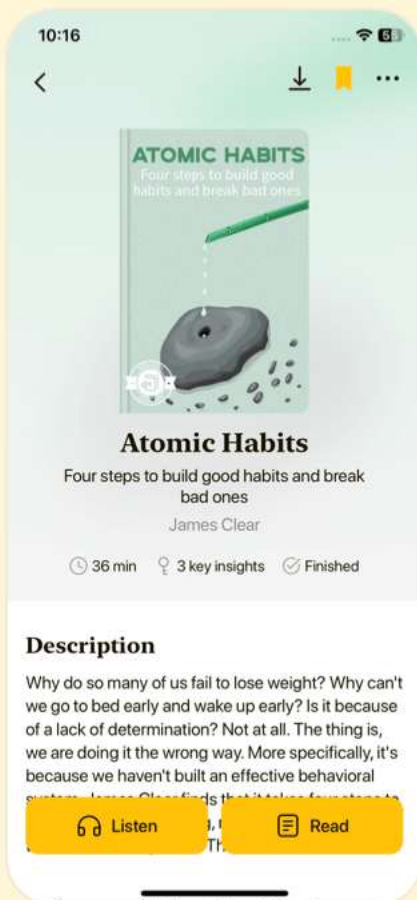


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Chapter 16 | J. The College Visit| Quiz and Test

- 1.College visits are important for students to envision their future at an institution.
- 2.Only distant colleges should be visited; nearby colleges are not relevant for the college decision process.
- 3.Creating a strategic itinerary for college visits is unnecessary for the admissions process.

Chapter 17 | Activity #5: Planning a College Road Trip| Quiz and Test

- 1.Planning college visits should be done solely by the parents without the involvement of the child.
- 2.It is recommended to limit college visits to two schools per day to allow for proper reflection and exploration.
- 3.Participating in summer programs at colleges guarantees an advantage in the admissions process.

Chapter 18 | A. Refining the List| Quiz and Test

- 1.The admissions calendar for college applications begins on August 1 and ends in February of the senior year for all institutions.

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2. Families should categorize potential colleges into aspirational, sweet spot, and likely options to refine their college list.
3. Eliminating schools from the college list is a sign of failure in the decision-making process.

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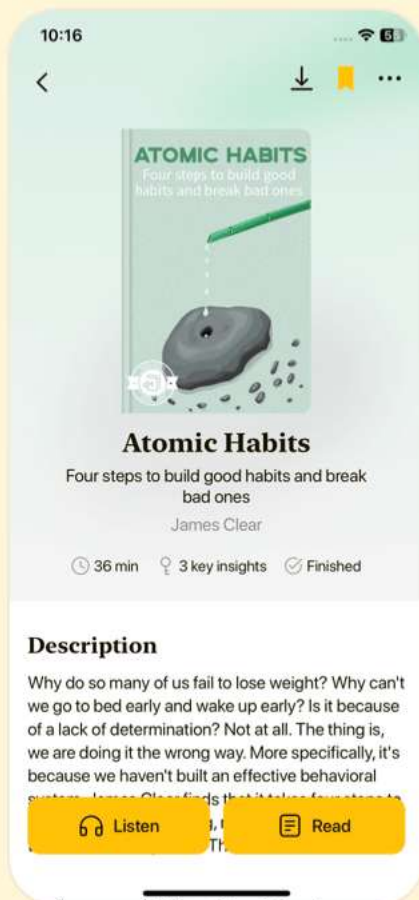


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Chapter 19 | Activity #6: Creating a College Application Requirement and Deadline Tracker| Quiz and Test

1. Understanding and adhering to college admissions deadlines is crucial for success.
2. Students can use any format for tracking their college application requirements and deadlines, including any random method they choose.
3. The college application process is solely about submitting required documents without any opportunity for self-reflection.

Chapter 20 | B. The College Application as a Reporting Mechanism, and a Moment for Your Child to Take Stock| Quiz and Test

1. The college application serves as a storytelling tool for students.
2. Parents should dominate the essay writing process in their child's college application.
3. Students need to monitor their email regularly for communications from colleges regarding their applications.

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Chapter 21 | C. Your Child Assembles the Parts: Opportunities to Render Their Experiences| Quiz and Test

- 1.The college application process consists solely of academic components such as transcripts and test scores.
- 2.Admissions committees evaluate each application thoroughly and consist of individuals from diverse backgrounds.
- 3.Quality of extracurricular activities is less important than the number of activities a student lists in their application.

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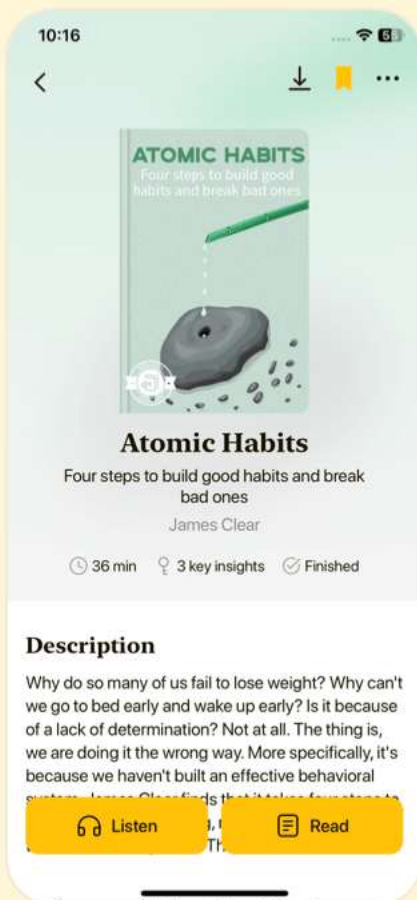


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Chapter 22 | Activity #7: Your Child Catalogs Their Activity List| Quiz and Test

1. Your child should document their activity list in a format that does not mirror the application requirements.
2. It is essential for your child to include emotional context and vivid descriptions in their activity list rather than just listing facts.
3. Creating a portfolio is mandatory for all college applicants.

Chapter 23 | D. Conversations About the Essays: Your Child Frames Their Story| Quiz and Test

1. The essay section is the first part your child completes in their college application.
2. Colleges evaluate essays primarily for writing ability and personal storytelling.
3. The Common Application for the Class of 2025 includes six specific essay prompts for applicants.

Chapter 24 | Activity #8: Your Child Looks into Their Rearview Mirror| Quiz and Test

1. Students are encouraged to reflect only on grand

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experiences to identify significant moments for their college essays.

2.College essays should be exhaustive memoirs detailing every aspect of a student's life.

3.Students should embrace complexity in their narratives to showcase the multidimensionality of their identities.

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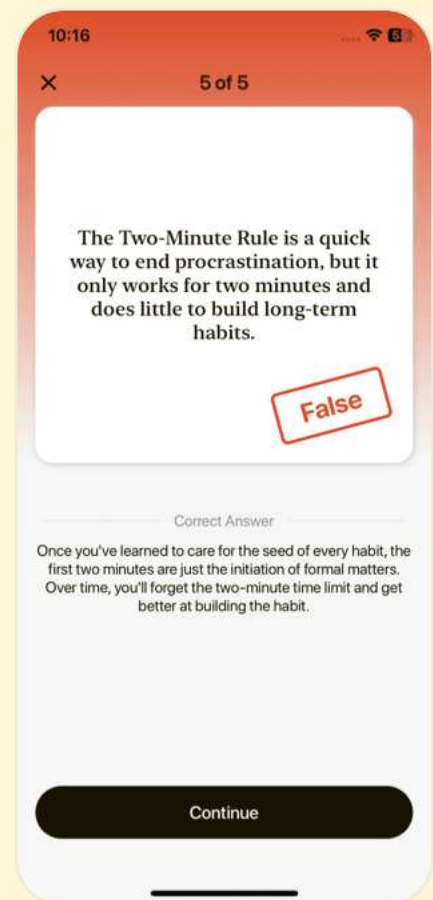
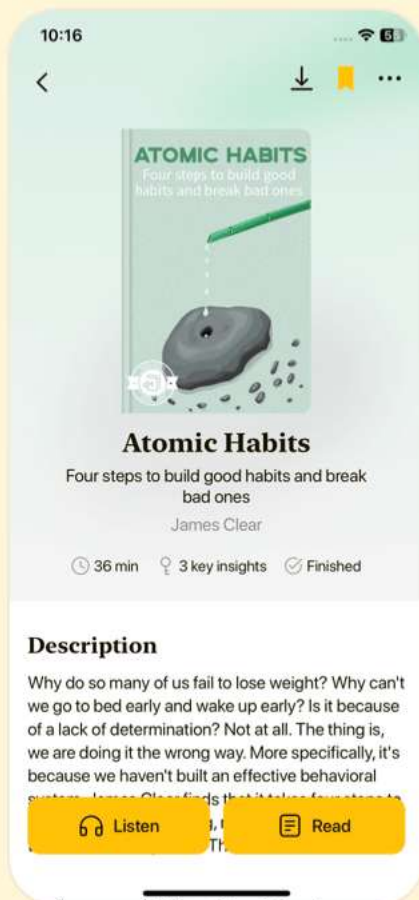


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Chapter 25 | E. Application Plans| Quiz and Test

- 1.Colleges with rolling admission evaluate applications on a first-come, first-served basis starting typically on September 1.
- 2.Early Action allows students to apply only to one college at a time.
- 3.Early Decision requires students to sign an agreement that confirms they will withdraw all other applications if accepted.

Chapter 26 | F. Assessing Whether an Early Application Plan May Be Best for Your Child| Quiz and Test

- 1.Students should align their college preferences with their identity and the culture of potential institutions when considering early applications.
- 2.Parents are discouraged from seeking advice from college counseling when making decisions about early applications.
- 3.Students do not need to worry about application requirements and deadlines when applying early.

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Chapter 27 | Activity #9: A Preflight Checklist for Those Considering Flying Early| Quiz and Test

1. Parents should play a passive role in the early college application process, allowing students to navigate it independently.
2. Admission rates for early decision applicants are typically lower than those for regular admissions due to less competition.
3. Exploring early action or rolling admissions allows students to have more flexibility compared to binding early decision applications.

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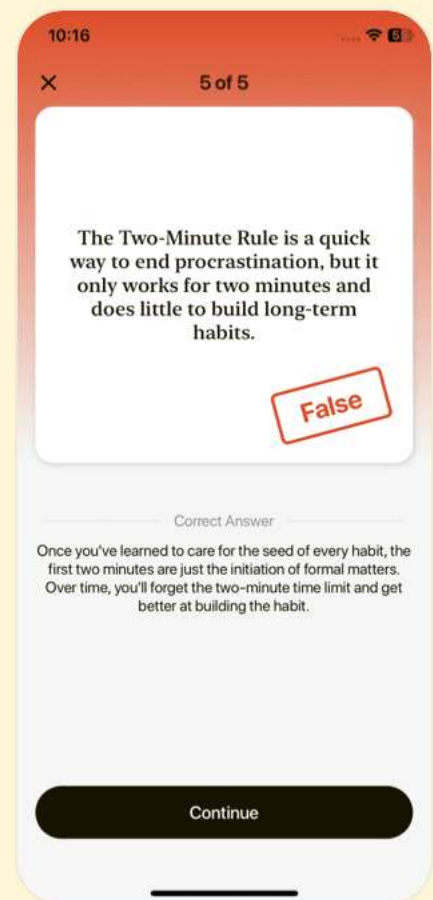
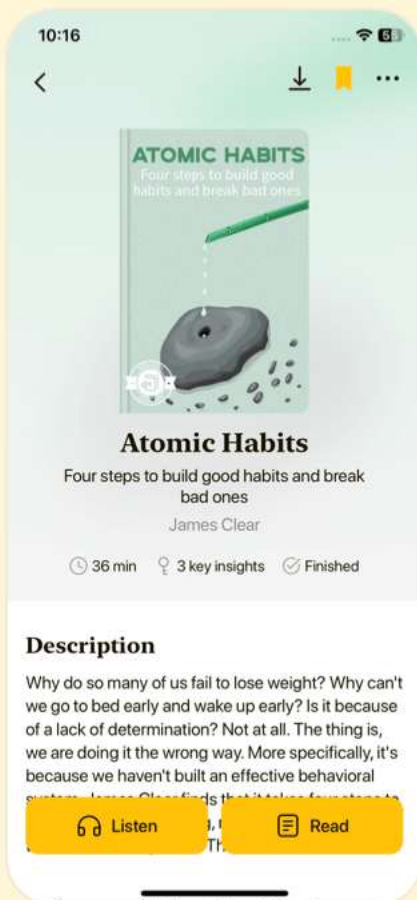


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Chapter 28 | G. The Fifth C Revisited: Managing Cost and Affordability| Quiz and Test

- 1.Colleges charge application fees that can range from \$25 to \$100.
- 2.Students are not able to request fee waivers for college application fees.
- 3.The FAFSA can be submitted starting October 1 of the student's senior year and is crucial for determining eligibility for federal aid.

Chapter 29 | H. Some Thoughts on Pacing, Time Management, and the Parallel Universe Where Life in High School Goes On| Quiz and Test

- 1.It is crucial to reflect on the progress made in college applications as deadlines approach.
- 2.Students should view application deadlines as moments to cram instead of as milestones.
- 3.It is important to integrate time for self-care during the college application process.

Chapter 30 | I. Ready to Submit| Quiz and Test

- 1.Parents should encourage their children to focus

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on the past while waiting for college decisions.

2.It's important for parents to listen and provide reassurance to their children during the college application process.

3.Submitting the last college application is an insignificant milestone for families.

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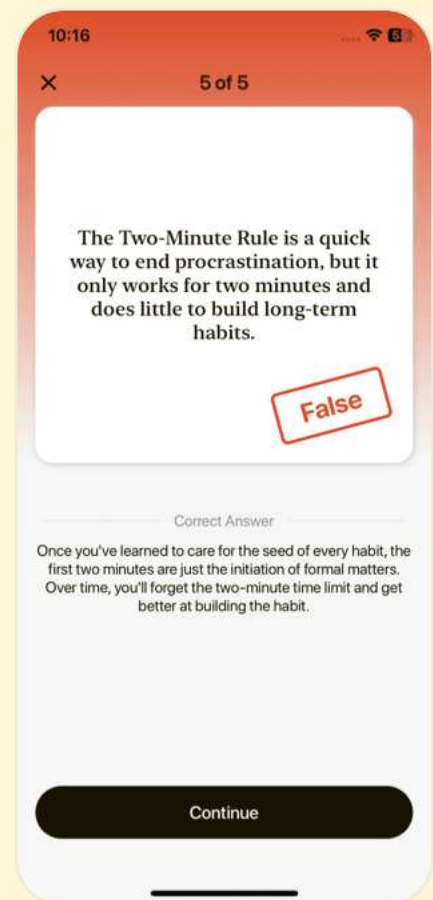
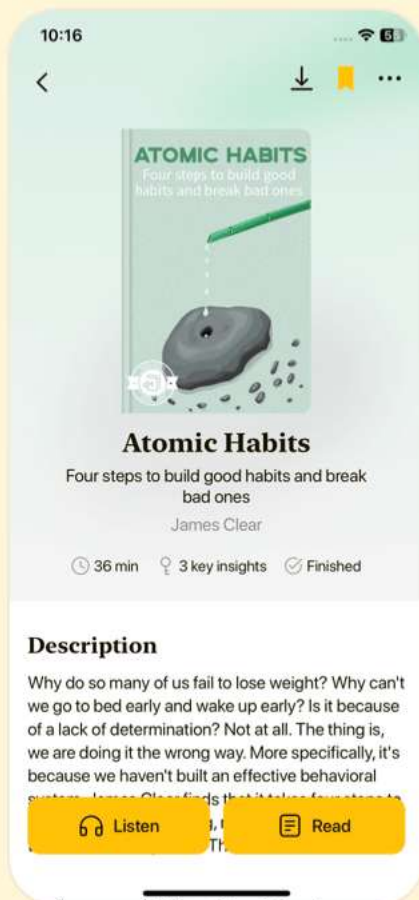


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Chapter 31 | A. Back Inside the Admissions Office: Conversations About the Applicants, and Building a Class| Quiz and Test

1. In the U.S. college admissions process, students are allowed to apply to multiple institutions, which is a feature not commonly found in centralized admissions systems in other countries.
2. Admissions officers solely evaluate academic scores and standardized test results when reviewing applications, ignoring personal essays and recommendations.
3. The admissions process only focuses on creating a prestigious class without regard to diversity or background considerations.

Chapter 32 | B. Back to the Kitchen Table: Sorting, Weighing, and Analyzing the Colleges' Decisions| Quiz and Test

1. The deadline for college enrollment decisions is May 1.
2. Colleges only notify students of their admissions decisions through traditional mail.

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3. Parents should help their children analyze their admissions results cooperatively and positively.

Chapter 33 | C. Your Child Is Back in the Driver's Seat, with Decisions to Make| Quiz and Test

1. Students should make their final college selection immediately after receiving admission decisions.
2. Revisiting materials and exercises from the college search can help students remember how they arrived at their choices.
3. Gathering additional information, such as campus visits, is not necessary once admission decisions are made.

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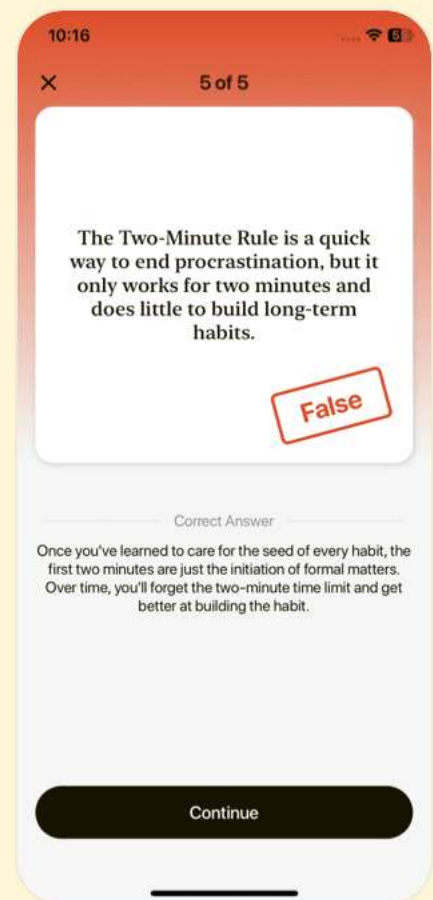
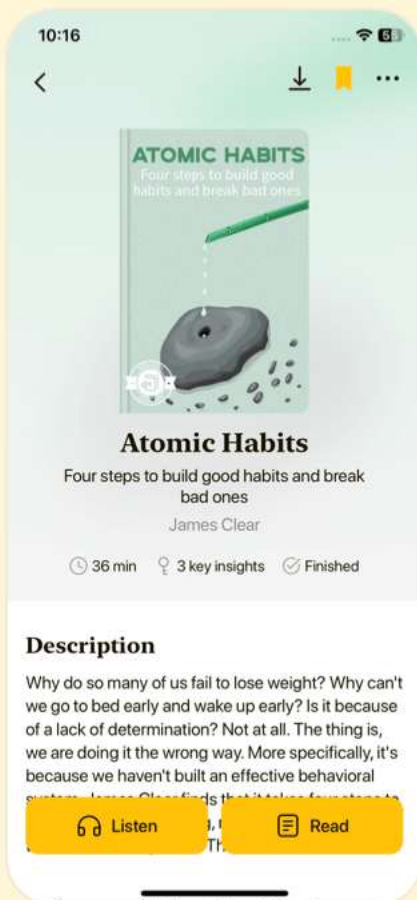


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Chapter 34 | Activity #10: Your Child Revisits Their Priorities as the College Choice Looms| Quiz and Test

- 1.The activity encourages children to focus on specific colleges while reflecting on their college preferences.
- 2.Students are encouraged to evaluate their priorities including environmental factors, academic interests, and student life.
- 3.Activity #10 promotes engaging in a moment of meditation and introspection about personal growth.

Chapter 35 | Activity #11: Mapping the Choice| Quiz and Test

- 1.The activity encourages documenting thoughts and reflections on chosen universities.
- 2.The Five I's (identity, intellect, ideas, interests, inspiration) are used to assess how concepts intersect with the Five C's.
- 3.The process of mapping college choices should be emotionally neutral and only focus on cognitive assessment.

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Chapter 36 | D. Another Round of Due Diligence: Supporting Your Child as They Weigh Their Final Choices| Quiz and Test

1. Parents should always visit the colleges their child is considering before making a final decision.
2. Gathering information on academic and mental health support services is important for student well-being.
3. Students should make their college decision quickly to avoid stress and uncertainty.

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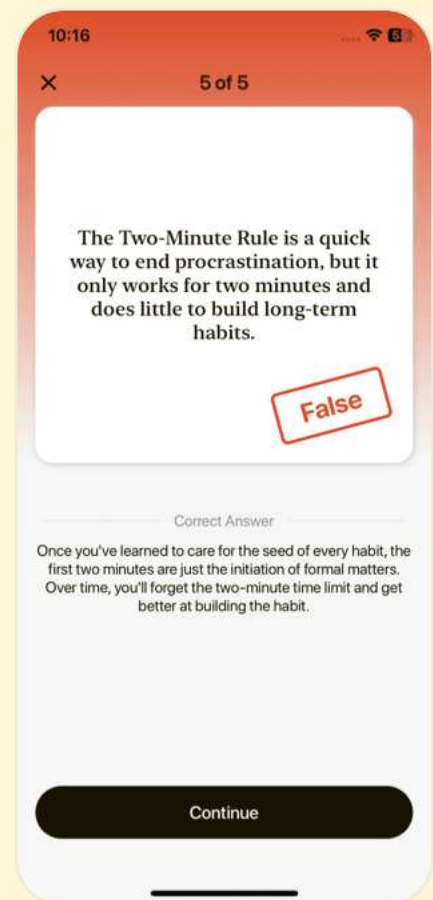
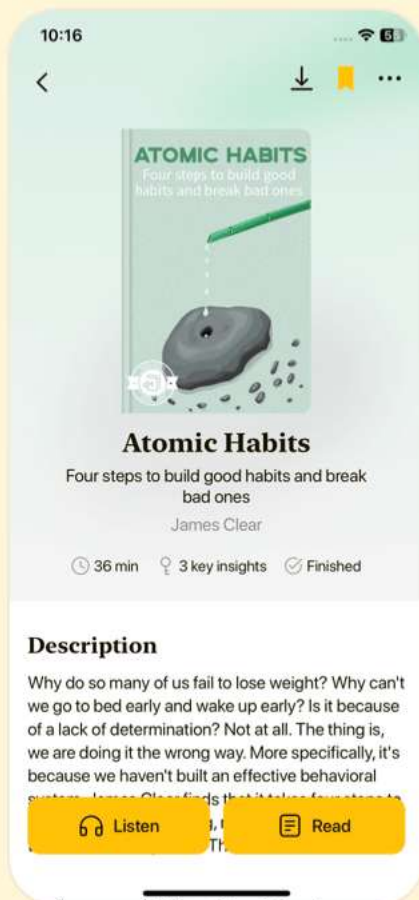


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Chapter 37 | E. Factoring Financial Aid into the Final Decision| Quiz and Test

1. A financial aid package typically includes need-based aid such as scholarships and grants.
2. Families should avoid contacting financial aid offices as it may not result in increased aid.
3. Families do not need to worry about a nonrefundable deposit when securing their child's intention to attend college if they are receiving financial aid.

Chapter 38 | F. If Your Child Remains on a Waiting List| Quiz and Test

1. Parents should not inform the college about their child's interest in the waiting list spot after being placed on it.
2. Colleges will consider additional letters sent to admissions teams when making decisions about waiting list students.
3. The waiting list for colleges can remain active until the end of June.

Chapter 39 | G. For Those Students Considering a Gap Year| Quiz and Test

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1. A gap year is typically taken during the summer after high school before starting college.
2. Students who take a gap year are likely to have higher rates of college persistence and graduation compared to those who don't.
3. Students can start their gap year before they have accepted an admission offer to college.

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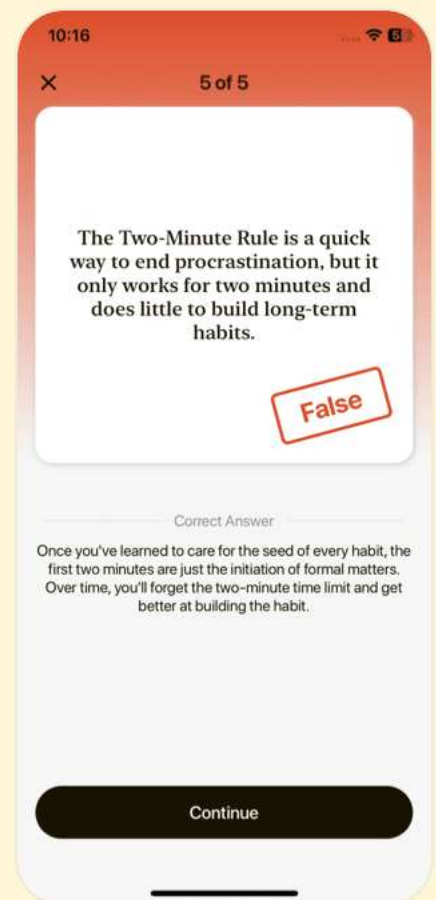
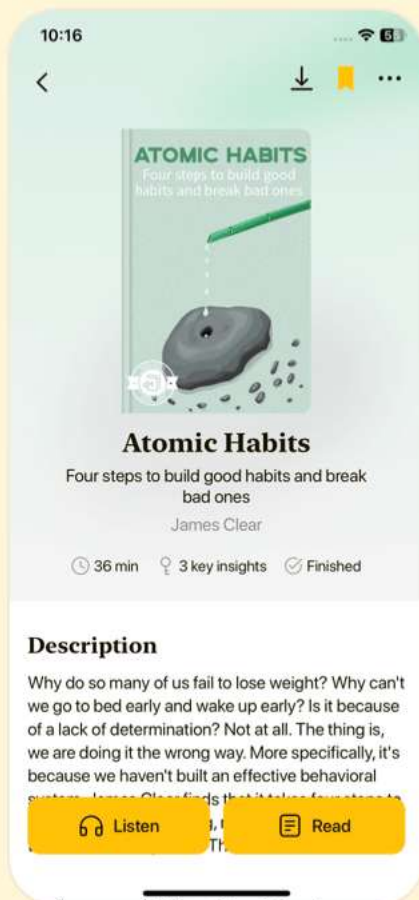


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Chapter 40 | Activity #12: Narrowing the Field| Quiz and Test

- 1.The decision-making process for selecting a college should be conducted in a quiet environment to avoid distractions.
- 2.Parents should not involve their children in the college selection exercise as it may hinder their independence.
- 3.Using a financial aid worksheet is not necessary during the college selection process.

Chapter 41 | I. The Moments Immediately After the Decision| Quiz and Test

- 1.After making a college decision, it is important for your child to celebrate and take a moment to reflect privately.
- 2.Your child will never feel a sense of letdown or anticlimax after making a college decision.
- 3.If your child expresses doubt about their college decision, it is unnecessary to involve their college counselor for support.

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Chapter 42 | A. On the Importance of Your Child's Finishing High School Strong| Quiz and Test

1. Finishing high school strong is not important for students as they approach graduation.
2. Parents should encourage their children to remain engaged in academic, extracurricular, and community experiences during their final weeks of high school.
3. The final transcript submitted to colleges does not affect admission status and students can fail without consequences.

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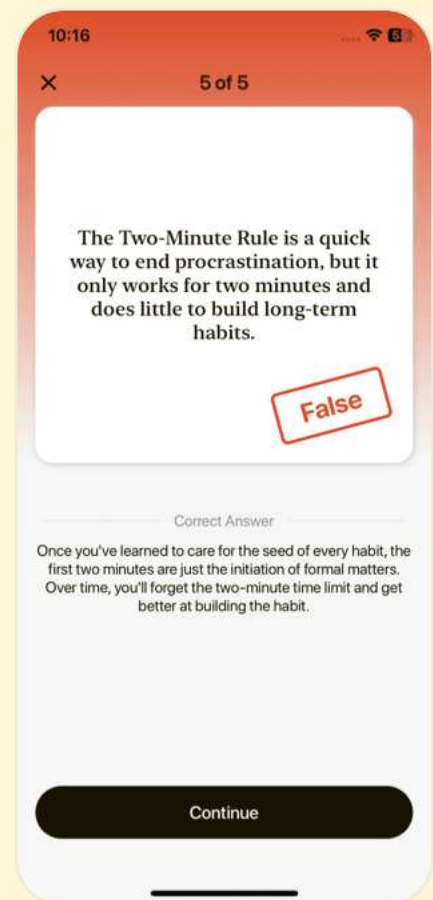
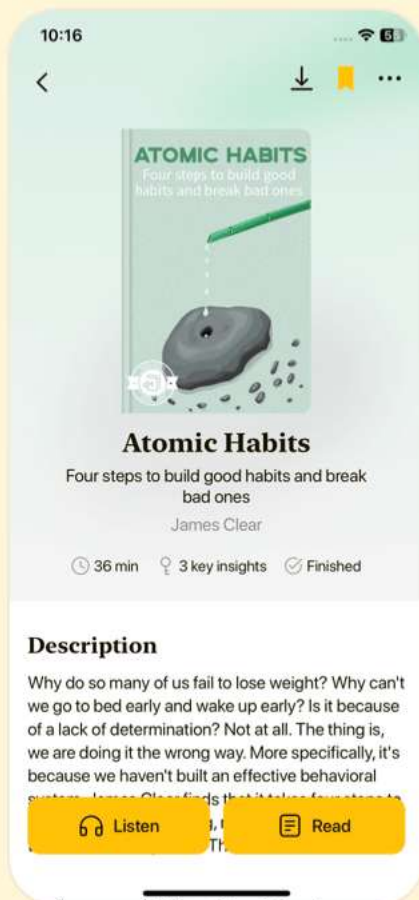


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Chapter 43 | B. Decisions and Actions Between Your Child's High School Graduation and Their Arrival at College| Quiz and Test

- 1.Students should establish access to a student ID and email after high school graduation and before college arrival.
- 2.Health insurance options are not important for incoming college students and can be ignored during the preparation phase.
- 3.Engaging with an academic adviser is crucial for understanding course registration and academic policies before classes start.

Chapter 44 | C. Conversations About Laying a Foundation for Success| Quiz and Test

- 1.The first year of college is often referred to as the 'Momentum Year' and it is a crucial time for educational continuity.
- 2.Participating in extracurricular activities is not recommended for college students.
- 3.Maintaining healthy habits like proper sleep and nutrition

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is important for academic success.

Chapter 45 | D. Drop-off, Departure, and Check-in Points Thereafter| Quiz and Test

1. Parents should expect their child's college schedule to be similar to their high school routine.
2. Establishing mutual expectations about communication can help ease the separation during college transition for parents and children.
3. Parents should avoid checking in frequently during the early days of their child's college life to promote independence.

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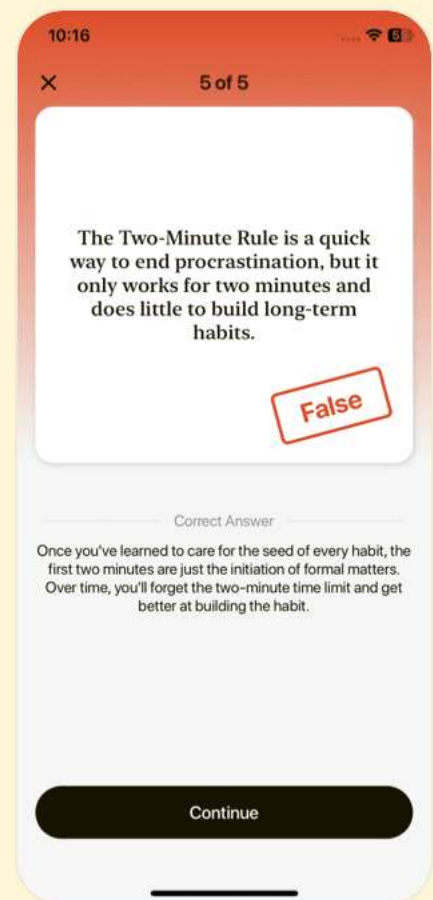
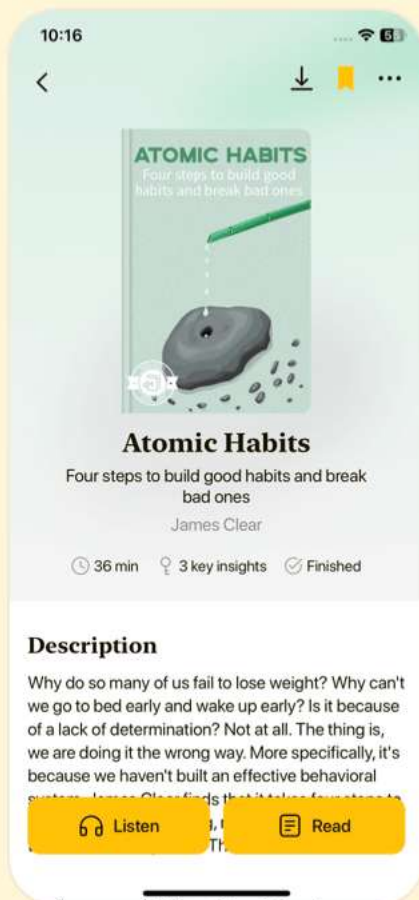


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Chapter 46 | E. The (Potential) Transfer Conversation| Quiz and Test

1. Parents should assume their child's dissatisfaction with college means they made the wrong choice initially.
2. Discussions about transferring should occur during winter break to allow time for an action plan.
3. It is essential for parents to discourage their kids from considering transferring, regardless of the situation.

Chapter 47 | Activity #13: Back to the Future: Revisiting Those I's and C's from Your Child's First Round of College Decision-Making| Quiz and Test

1. About 40% of students graduate from their initial college.
2. The transfer process does not require a reflection on personal growth and updated priorities.
3. The college search for transfers should be streamlined due to time limitations as full-time students.

Chapter 48 | F. Another Potential Transfer Conversation: From Community College to a

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Traditional Four-Year College or University| Quiz and Test

1. 50% of bachelor's degree graduates in the 2014–15 academic year had initially attended a two-year institution.
2. Students should plan early to determine their academic goals during their community college experience.
3. Students do not need to research transfer options if they decide to pursue a bachelor's degree after a break in their studies.

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